

ROLLED



Delores Swallows

Rolled

A Debt to Pay

by Delores Swallows

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When Janine allows Adam to talk her into visiting a casino to celebrate five years together, she never imagines that a night that starts with so much fun and flirting could end in such despair and debt. Adam doesn't just lose all the money they'd saved, he takes out credit they cannot afford to pay back.

They work extra hours and struggle for a month to save up enough for the first payment. Then, it appears, the casino manager has another way the struggling couple could make the interest payments.

Outraged, Janine immediately rejects the indecent proposal. But, despite the sleaziness of the suggestion, she's flattered someone would be prepared to consider giving up that sort of money just for... her, and the thought of allowing a complete stranger to use her body pushes buttons she didn't know she had.

And why does Adam seem so keen she should do it...?

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Rolled

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Chapter One

Janine's heart raced as she watched the ball going round the roulette wheel. Adam squeezed her hand and she glanced at him; he had his eyes on the prize. They'd win over three hundred pounds if the ball landed in a black pocket—almost as much as Janine's average weekly earnings at the hairdressers. The ball landed on number 15, which was black. Janine squealed and Adam grinned, punching the air.

He gripped her waist. "Tonight's our night. I can feel it."

Janine laughed. "Oh yeah?"

"Yeah. I know I'm going to be lucky—I've got the buzz."

She moved closer, raking her fingers down his arm through the material of his jacket. She hadn't seen him this excited in a while. "Hmm, if you're feeling *that* lucky, maybe we should just go home to bed."

Adam's blue eyes danced with excitement. "Why don't we stay here for a little while longer? Then we can cover the bed in cash and I'll spread you out over the top of it."

The idea of being naked and surrounded by money, with Adam pounding her with his hard, lean body, turned her on. "That sounds like something I might enjoy."

He laughed and kissed her neck. "You will. Maybe we'll win enough for a holiday, then we can go to Monte Carlo and spread cash all over the bed there, too."

She laughed, his enthusiasm infectious.

"Come on, let's try the craps table next." He led her by the hand through the crowd of well-dressed men and turned to her. "It looks like there's a stag do, or something. A lot of the young guys seem to know each other."

"A stag party?" She pushed her chest out a little. "Ooh—lucky me."

He laughed. "They're only allowed to look, okay?"

She'd never accompanied Adam to the casino before, and he'd warned her it would be mostly men, and that there was a strict dress code. For this reason, Janine had pinned her hair up and wore a short, figure-hugging black dress, sheer nylons and black high-heeled shoes with an ankle strap. From the appreciative looks she got, it would appear the little black dress was still very much *en vogue*.

He led the way through the people around the craps table. The men crowded round behind them, invading Janine's personal space. One guy stood uncomfortably close, his thigh pushing against her backside.

The men all placed bets and Adam was invited to shoot first. Janine hadn't a clue what the rules were, but Adam seemed to know what to do. He held the dice in his closed hand and raised it to her mouth. "Blow them for luck, babe."

She smirked, knowingly. *'Did you give him a cut and blow?'* had become Adam's regular taunt. She pursed her lips and blew gently on his fingers.

Some of the men murmured as she did so, and she heard someone say something about her blowing them.

She turned to them and gave a mock-frown. "Behave yourselves."

They laughed and joked in return as Adam threw the dice. The men on the stag night were making it quite a pleasant evening.

Janine watched the small cubes bounce off the dimpled rubberised wall of the table and roll until they finally settled. There was a cheer from some of the men, and a groan from others.

She stared at the dice, confused. One showed a five and the other a two. She looked up at Adam and shook her head. "Have you won?"

"Yeah. That's a natural."

"Huh?" Janine heard somebody behind her whisper about her being a natural.

Adam laughed. "Pass line bets win, and Don't Pass line bets lose."

Janine hadn't a clue what he was talking about, but Adam picked up the dice again and presented his closed fist for another lucky breath. The men behind her urged and cajoled until she laughed out loud, looked into

Adam's eyes and pouted her lips. She blew on his hand, then leaned forward and touched her lips to his fingers.

A cheer broke out around her, and somebody said, "You don't need to understand the rules when you can blow like that, love."

Janine laughed and turned towards the man who'd shouted. She blew him a kiss, getting a raucous laugh from his friends.

She watched with a detached bewilderment while the men cheered and booed any combination of numbers the dice rolls came up with. There seemed to be absolutely no logic to any of it. Strangers offered their hands for her to blow on, and most seemed very happy with whatever effect she had on their luck. A waitress appeared with a tray of drinks, and Adam took one for himself and handed one to Janine. More dice were rolled, more drinks appeared, and Janine found herself in a whirl of chatter and fun. Adam concentrated on his gambling, and some of the men seemed to be standing closer to her than they needed to, but she was enjoying herself and didn't mind. She flirted, she laughed, she drank, and she wallowed in the attention she got. When one of the guys offered his open hand with the dice resting on his palm, she was so caught up in the mood that she kissed the tip of finger suggestively, looking up at him with big brown eyes. A roar of approval rang out from the crowd.

A little later she saw Adam sign a slip of paper and a guy dressed in shirt and waistcoat handing him a pile of chips. She imagined them walking arm-in-arm down the streets of Monte Carlo under a clear blue sky.

She'd drunk a lot of champagne and needed to find the toilets. Once there she used the loo, washed her hands and touched up her dark berry lip gloss. As she made her way back to the craps table, she almost collided with a big guy who was talking to one of the waitresses. Janine saw him at the last second and just managed to stop, but he'd already jerked his arm out of the way and spilled his drink down his jacket sleeve.

"Oh no, I'm so sorry." Janine used her hand to wipe the spilled drink from his sleeve.

He smiled, as if slightly amused by her pointless attempt to dry-clean him using her fingers. "No harm done."

She let go of his arm. "I'm such a klutz. At least let me buy you another drink to replace the one I made you spill."

He laughed. "Thank you, but that's not necessary." He bent to whisper in her ear. "I've got an agreement with the management, and I don't have to pay for any drinks which get spilled by beautiful women."

Janine blushed at the compliment.

"Tell you what," he said, guiding her by the elbow towards the bar. "Why not let me get us *both* a drink."

Janine glanced over towards the craps tables but couldn't see Adam because of the crowd. "Er... I'm actually here with my boyfriend..."

"I'm only offering you a drink." He followed her gaze towards the craps table. "And I assume he's busy at the moment."

She laughed. "Okay, thank you."

The guy offered her a stool at the bar. "What are you drinking?"

She saw him glance at her legs as she climbed up onto it. "I was drinking champagne, but I can have—"

"Champagne, please Davy. And I'll have the usual."

Janine watched the man as he ordered their drinks. He was tall and broad, maybe early forties. He wasn't particularly good-looking—his cheeks were pock-marked from what had probably been quite severe teenage acne—but he had something about him. His blue eyes were intense and piercing—as if they could see right into you, and there was a confidence about his demeanour she found attractive.

He passed her the drink, then touched his small tumbler of clear liquid against the lip of her flute. "Cheers."

She smiled. "Cheers, and thank you." She nodded at his drink. "I'm impressed that the barman knows your usual drink. You must come here a lot."

A lazy grin crossed his face. "Yeah, I'm here most nights."

"Wow. Do you always win?"

He laughed. "I usually come out on top. How about you and your boyfriend? Are you winning?"

"I hope so."

The guy took out his phone and read a text, then sighed. "I'm sorry, but I need to be somewhere. I hope you enjoy the rest of your evening."

"I will. Thanks for the drink, and I'm sorry about your jacket."

"It was only water, don't worry about it."

Janine watched him walk across the casino, then she headed back to the craps table. The group of men parted to make way for her. She noticed they were less jovial than earlier; maybe some of the stag crowd had moved away to try their luck at other tables. Adam was staring down as someone else's throw of the dice bounced off the moulded wall of the table, his expression grim. As the dice settled, the croupier said something about *Don't Pass* and Adam sighed, his eyes closing and his head dropping forward until his chin rested on his chest. Other people around the table groaned, and the guy who'd thrown the dice held up his hand in an apology.

Adam caught her eye and offered an assuring smile, but she knew he was trying to hide his disappointment. Tonight was supposed to be special; they'd been together for exactly five years, and had decided to celebrate. They'd saved up six hundred pounds over the last few months, which may have been enough for a last-minute trip to somewhere like Majorca, but Adam had suggested they have dinner at a nice restaurant, then go to the casino.

They'd had several arguments in the earlier years of their relationship about Adam's gambling, but that'd been in the past. Agreeing to the casino night rather than a short break was her way of showing her trust: a reward for leaving his bad habits behind him.

Adam held the dice and turned to her, offering his hand to her mouth. She gently blew on it, then kissed his finger. She noticed the other men didn't offer the same encouragement as they'd done earlier. When the dice finally settled, Adam punched the side of the table and turned away in disgust.

Janine moved close and stroked her hand down his side, slipping her fingers inside his jacket. "Come on, let's have a rest for a few minutes, maybe a drink or—"

"I think we should try blackjack. There's something not right about the way the dice started landing." He was fidgety, restless.

“Well I could do with a coffee, and maybe you should have one too—just to take a short break and assess how much we have left.” She tilted her head to one side, trying to cajole him.

He pulled away, but gave her hand a light squeeze. “You go for a coffee and I’ll go and watch the blackjack table for a while, get the lay of the land.”

“Okay, but don’t start playing until I get there. I want to see how all this casino thing works, okay?”

He nodded while backing away, then strode towards the far side of the casino.

Janine headed back to the bar where the big guy had bought her a drink a few minutes earlier.

Davy the barman smiled as she approached. “Same again?”

She laughed and shook her head. “No, I’m getting a bit tipsy. Could I have a black coffee, please?”

“Of course. I can get it sent over to you, if you wish.”

“No—I’ll take it here, thanks.”

By the time Janine had finished her coffee and found Adam, he was playing blackjack. Though he had an impressive stack of chips in front of him, his face was sombre.

“Hey,” she rubbed his back. “I thought you were going to just watch for a while.”

He glanced over his shoulder at her, then back at the cards. “I did—for ages. I thought you’d got lost or something.”

She nodded at the pile in front of him. “Looks like the cards are better than the dice, though.”

He snorted. “Yeah, we’ll see.”

Janine was a little surprised at his mood. The casino trip had been his idea, so he should at least be enjoying himself. Judging from the pile of chips in front of him he’d done okay. Though perhaps the buzz people got from gambling was a nervous kind of thrill, and they weren’t supposed to look like they were having fun.

She stepped next to his side and watched the cards. She understood blackjack a little more than she did craps: at least, she understood that the players' cards had to add up to closer to twenty-one than the dealer's. After watching a few hands being dealt and played, Janine soon got bored. She began to wish she'd insisted on a weekend away, rather than a single night watching Adam play games she could barely even follow.

She placed her hand on his arm. "I'm going for another drink. Do you want anything from the bar?"

He shook his head, not taking his eyes off the cards being dealt.

Janine hesitated for a few seconds, and when it became obvious he wasn't even going to bother looking at her, she headed back to the bar.

Davy seemed happy to see her. "What'll it be?"

"Bacardi and coke, please Davy."

"Coming right up."

There was nobody else waiting to get served, so after she'd paid for the drink she smiled. "Can I ask a question?"

"Sure." Davy leaned onto the bar, his head level with hers.

"Do people who gamble ever smile?"

He laughed. "I suppose it depends if they're winning or not. Why?"

She shrugged. "My boyfriend seems to be winning, but he's kind of nervous and irritable."

"Yeah, my ex-girlfriend was like that. Maybe it's his time of the month."

Janine burst out laughing and slapped his arm. "Don't be nasty."

Davy straightened up and shrugged. "If he's winning, does his mood matter?"

"No, I suppose not."

He moved off to serve other people who'd come to the bar and Janine sat and sipped her drink for a few minutes. As she studied the other people at the tables, most seemed to be laughing and enjoying themselves—although there were a few older men who looked very serious. She thought about what Davy had said and started to worry; maybe Adam wasn't winning after all.

Janine headed back to the blackjack table and arrived there just in time to see the guy in the waistcoat passing Adam another pile of chips after he'd signed for them. A coldness spread through her stomach.

"Adam, what's going on? Where are these chips coming from?"

He glanced in her direction, but didn't meet her eye. "They're just something to help me get back on track."

"Back on track? What does that mean?"

"We just need to—"

"Adam, how much of our money have you got left?"

He sighed impatiently. "I'm working on it, okay? Just give me a bit of peace and quiet while I play the next few hands."

Janine noticed others at the table staring at them. She was tempted to clip Adam round the ear, but didn't want to make a scene. The dealer dealt the cards to the players and himself, keeping one of his own face down. Adam had a queen, and two other players also had a face card. The dealer had a six. When the second cards were dealt Adam got another face card, and he finally smiled.

He looked at Janine. "We're back in the groove. I think it's time to up the stakes."

"I'd prefer if we took it a bit slower at—"

"Come on—'speculate to accumulate', that's what they say." He raised his eyebrows, ran his hand down her back and gave her bum a squeeze. "I'm feeling the luck's coming back. We've still got to win enough to spread over the bed, remember?"

Relaxing a little, Janine watched in silence for the next few hands. Adam won the first, lost the second and third, won the fourth, then lost the following four. His mood got darker with each deal.

She stroked his arm. "Maybe we should go back to the roulette—"

His look of irritation made her stop mid-sentence. Janine turned away and headed back to the bar, already accepting tonight had been a waste of five hundred pounds. She should've insisted they used the money for a holiday somewhere. A weekend in Paris, Rome, Amsterdam or Prague would have been so much better than a night getting scowled at in a casino.

Even if Adam won a fortune now, there's no way she'd be lying naked on top of a bed for him after his snapping and moodiness.

"Pernod and lemonade please, Davy."

He nodded. "I like a woman who's never predictable."

She laughed and climbed up onto the stool. "You know what they say—a change is as good as a rest."

His eyes twinkled. "Yeah, variety's the spice of life, so I'm told."

Janine watched his bum as he poured her drink. If Adam was going to be a complete twat, then she could cheer herself up by flirting with the barman. "So, how did you end up working behind a bar in a casino?"

"Too clumsy to be a croupier, too nice to be a bouncer."

She laughed. "Yeah, and the bouncers aren't allowed to smile, so we'd never get a chance to see those dimples of yours."

"Exactly."

They spent the next twenty minutes or so chatting and flirting when Davy wasn't serving other customers. When she put her empty glass on the bar, she found she wasn't ready to go back and find Adam still grumpy. She started looking at the bottles on the shelf.

Davy saw her and laughed. "So, what's next?"

"Give her a double brandy, on the house."

Janine turned at the sound of the voice. It was the man she'd almost collided with earlier.

He nodded a greeting as he stood beside her. "I think you're going to need it."

She frowned. "Why am I going to need a double brandy?"

"I've just found out that your boyfriend's losing money he hasn't got."

Pieces fell instantly into place; the guy was here every night because he worked here—which was why he was only drinking water. Her stomach went cold and her throat tightened. "What do you mean? He's only gambling with the money he brought with him."

The man nodded towards the bar. "Get your drink and follow me."

Janine took the drink from Davy, who looked concerned for her. She followed the big man across the casino and through a door, down a short corridor and then into an office. Adam sat in one of two chairs opposite the big desk; a man in a dark suit stood silently behind him. When Adam saw Janine he started to get up, but the suited guy rested a hand on his shoulder and stilled him.

“What’s going on?” Janine asked Adam.

“What’s going on,” said the big man, “is that your young man here has run up rather a large debt.”

She shook her head. “How can he have done that? We brought almost five hundred pounds with us, and that’s what he’s using to play with.”

“I wish that were true.” He picked up three slips of paper from his desk and read them. “I have to admit, I’m not very happy with my staff. I should have been notified before the last of these loans was approved.”

Janine’s heart dropped. “Loans?” She remembered the guy in the waistcoat passing Adam chips, and him signing for them. How could she have been stupid enough to think they were his winnings? “I didn’t know he could get a loan from here.”

“Babe, I can exp—”

“Shut up, Adam!” Janine felt her face flush. The words had come out louder than she’d intended, but she was angry. This wasn’t the first time he’d gambled away money he couldn’t afford to lose. Shortly after they’d moved into their flat, she’d had to borrow money from her parents to avoid missing mortgage payments. But all that drama was supposed to be buried years back in their past together. She couldn’t believe she’d agreed to this ‘treat’ for him. *Idiot*.

She regarded the man behind the desk. “How much is it?”

The man in the suit stepped forward and placed some chips on the desk. The big guy quickly counted them, then looked up at Janine. “A little over four grand.”

She dropped into the chair next to Adam’s. “Four thousand pounds?”

He nodded. “Four thousand, two hundred and fifty, to be precise.”

She glared at Adam, who wouldn't hold eye contact. "But he had over five hundred pounds in his pocket..."

"Then he's lost getting on for five grand tonight." The man stared at Adam, who had his eyes to the floor, his face pale.

Janine took a large gulp from her glass, the liquor burning her throat. "So, what do we do now?"

"That's up to you two, really. I just need to make you aware of the conditions of the credit he signed for." The man held one slip of paper up and squinted. "He's Adam Lloyd, and you're Janine McNab, is that correct?"

A new chill ran through her body. "He's taken the loan out in *my* name?"

"Joint names, but if you're telling me you weren't aware of him doing so, then I'll write a statement for your lawyer, if you wish."

"Lawyer?" Janine's voice was barely above a whisper.

He nodded. "This is a large amount of money, and if you're saying he used your name on a credit slip without your permission, then he's committed a crime. No court would hold you liable for the debt, and he would probably face criminal prosecution."

Janine turned again to glare at Adam, but he kept his eyes averted.

The big guy behind the desk stood up and walked to a cupboard in the corner, returning with a bottle of brandy and a glass. He poured himself a drink, then held the bottle up to ask if Janine wanted a refill. She held her arm out and watched the amber liquid pour into her glass.

The guy put the bottle on his desk and leaned back in his chair. "Is it okay for me to call you Janine?"

She nodded.

"Janine, my name's Stephen Bromley, and I'm the manager of this casino. I'm also on the board of directors of Bromgrave Finance, the credit broker for your loan. What I suggest you do is go home and discuss how you're going to pay off this debt."

Janine's mouth became dry, so she took another gulp of brandy.

The man sipped his own drink, then put his glass down. “You should know that the terms and conditions of this loan are—as you might expect—less competitive than normal ones.”

Janine wasn’t surprised. “Higher than a bank’s?”

He nodded, his expression almost apologetic. “The interest rate is *considerably* higher than any bank—or credit card, for that matter.”

Her mind thrashed and flailed as she remembered all those adverts for payday loans she’d seen on TV, with interest rates of anything up to two thousand percent. “How much more?”

Bromley held her gaze. “Interest payable on this loan will be about six hundred pounds per month.”

The air left her lungs, but she couldn’t find the energy to inhale. She wanted to strangle Adam.

Bromley looked like he actually felt sorry for her. “As the capital begins to be paid off, that figure will come down. But my advice to you is to get to the high street branch of your bank and arrange a loan through them.”

Janine had sobered up very quickly. The effects of the champagne, Bacardi and Pernod were long gone, and the brandy’s only effect was to stop her from shaking. Adam’s credit rating was zero. He’d been refused cards from everywhere he’d applied; they’d only managed to get the mortgage on their flat because Janine’s parents had agreed to act as guarantors.

Bromley rose behind his desk. “Maybe you can call in to discuss it sometime during the week, after you’ve been to see your friendly bank manager.”

Not wanting to admit how slim their chances of getting a bank loan were, Janine simply nodded and got shakily to her feet, clutching her handbag until her knuckles hurt. In danger of crying with sheer rage, she marched out of the office without waiting for Adam. She sensed him hurrying after her but headed straight for the exit, passed the doormen and stepped out into the street. She checked her watch: almost two in the morning. She looked round for a taxi.

“Jani—”

“Fuck off!”

He reached his hand out and she slapped it away.

“I said fuck off. Don’t talk to me, and don’t you *dare* try and fucking touch me.”

“Jan—”

“Shut up. I don’t want to hear your excuses or your bullshit. You had no right—no *fucking* right to borrow money. The fact you did it using my name shows what an absolute twat you really are.”

Adam stepped close and tried to put his arms around her, but she slapped him hard across the cheek. He stepped back, his eyes wide with shock.

Janine hadn’t brought a coat and she shivered. Even though it was July, it was too cold to walk home. “Do you have any money for a taxi?”

Adam checked his pockets, pulled out some change. Janine opened her bag and purse; she had thirty quid. She turned and headed up the side road toward the busier street, Adam trailing in her wake.

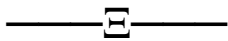
Just around the corner there were three taxis waiting. Janine walked to the closest one and pulled open the back door. Adam got in the other side. She gave their address and sat in silence. The driver obviously picked up on their mood because he didn’t try to make small talk during the journey. When he pulled up outside the former Victorian textile mill that housed their flat, the meter showed twelve pounds. Janine gave him a twenty and didn’t bother waiting for change.

Their apartment was on the middle floor of the three-storey building and she trudged up the steep steps, glad she didn’t have to make it all the way to the top. She was bone tired. Once indoors, she gathered a pillow, sheet and blanket, which she tossed onto the floor next to the sofa in the lounge, then glared at Adam before closing the bedroom door.

She quickly removed her shoes, tights and dress, and pulled on a t-shirt. Stepping back into the living room, she saw Adam hadn’t moved from just inside the front door, a dazed expression on his face. She walked straight to the bathroom and washed off her makeup, brushed her teeth and used the loo. Then she went back to the bedroom, not bothering to look in Adam’s direction as she passed him.



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Chapter Two

The next morning, Janine got up before eight. Her back and neck were sore—probably a result of being tense all night.

Needing a bit of space and some fresh air, she grabbed her leather jacket and left the flat without really knowing where she was going.

It was a bright morning, so she walked down the deserted street and headed for the canal. Once the main transport system for the local industry, the canals had been rejuvenated in recent years with block-paved towpaths and nice bars and cafés opening up along the route. After ambling along for a while, Janine stopped at one of the cafés and sat at an outside table with coffee and a pastry.

She was still angry at Adam, but also angry at herself. She should have known from his face and body language that he hadn't been winning all those chips she saw being delivered. Besides, whoever heard of having to sign for your winnings? What made her feel worse was that she'd left him gambling while she'd been flirting with the barman. It was like giving an alcoholic a clipful of cash and leaving them in a wine bar. But no matter how much she blamed herself, she couldn't get past the fact that he'd used both their names on the loan.

Watching all the other couples enjoying their Sunday morning strolls, Janine felt lonely and isolated. She and Adam had been one of those couples just yesterday morning, their lives ahead of them and a good night out to look forward to. She closed her eyes and pinched the bridge of her nose, trying to decide what to do. She knew what just about every single one of her friends would say—"leave him!" Sure, she could find a small, cheap flat for herself, take out a bank loan for half of the debt and go to see Bromley. She felt sure he'd accept her money and remove her name from the outstanding debt, and then Adam alone would be liable for his half and *all* of the interest.

The trouble was—now that she'd calmed down—Janine knew this would be little more than desertion. Adam obviously had a problem. He'd had this problem when she first met him, and she'd loved him in spite of it. The fact he'd lied about being over his problem was probably something she should have been able to see through, which sort of turned half of the blame back onto her. So, shouldn't she help him, rather than abandoning him?

Janine ordered another coffee, this one to go. Polystyrene cup in hand, she slowly wandered along the canal towpath, enjoying the warm sun on her face. She saw a heron on the opposite bank, its eyes focused intently into the water as it waited for a fish to swim close enough to snatch.

After walking for another mile or so, she headed back towards the flat, bracing herself to talk to Adam. She'd fallen in love with him when she was a teenager. Even though he'd done something stupid and selfish, she couldn't let that ruin everything they'd done together in the last five years.

By the time Janine got back to the flat it was lunchtime. Adam looked better now he'd showered and changed into a pair of shorts and t-shirt. He'd tidied the living room, the bedding now in a neat pile in the corner by the window. Maybe he expected to be banished from the bedroom indefinitely.

Janine dropped her jacket on an armchair. "Well, this isn't how I thought our anniversary weekend would turn out." She'd intended her remark to sound casual; it came out as an accusation nonetheless.

Adam closed his eyes and pressed his fingers to his forehead. Then he seemed to crumble. Tears appeared on his cheeks and he dropped down onto the sofa, his breathing ragged. He was actually crying.

"Ad—"

"I'm sorry, I'm sorr..." He sniffed and wiped his face with the back of his hand.

Janine sat on the sofa next to him, placing her arm around his shoulder. "Adam, don't cry."

He sobbed for a while before finally opening his eyes and looking at her. There were tears on his cheeks and snot running out of his nose.

She took a tissue from her pocket and wiped his face.

“I... I thought I’d be able to win it back...”

“Isn’t that what everyone thinks?” This time she managed to keep her voice calm, consoling.

“Yeah, but it was going okay. Then the dice suddenly changed—I’m sure they were loaded.”

“I don’t think you can blame the dice. Were the cards dodgy as well?”

Adam stared down at his feet, nodded slowly. “I wanted for us to... You know, have a good time.”

She waited until he looked up into her eyes. “I didn’t need you to win to make it a good time.”

“No, I know. But I wanted, like, you know...” He took a breath, shrugged. “You looked so fucking sexy, and all the men in the stag party were staring at you, lusting after you. I wanted to get you home and slowly peel that dress off...”

“Adam, you could have lost all of the money we took with us and still done that. I don’t need the bed to be covered in cash to enjoy sex. We’d had a lovely meal, and if we’d left the casino when our money had gone, it would have been alright.”

He closed his eyes, took a deep breath. “I wish I’d known that last night.”

She put her hand on his bare knee, leaned close to whisper. “If you’d kept enough money for fish and chips on the way home, I may even have given you a blowjob in the taxi.”

Adam snorted and hastily dabbed his lip with the tissue. But then he frowned again. “I’m really sorry, Janine. I don’t know what I was thinking.”

Squeezing his leg, she shushed him. She leaned close and kissed his cheek. “Everyone does stupid things, but we *have* to learn from them.”

He turned to her, his eyes wide and earnest. “I promise I’ll never do anything like that again.”

Anger made way for the overwhelming urge to forgive him. She smiled and took his hand in hers.

Adam leaned forward and kissed her. His fingers gripped her hand and he kissed her again, more urgently. His cheeks were still damp from the tears.

A different kind of dampness developed inside Janine as she kissed him back. She was desperate for closeness, but still tense from their fight. She bit his lips, then moaned when he reacted by groping her breast. Raking her hands down his chest, she pushed him back on the sofa.

Adam slipped his hand between her legs, his fingers pushing the hard seam of denim against her engorged outer lips. Janine stood, kicked off her boots then quickly removed her jeans and panties while Adam pushed down his shorts, releasing his already-hard cock. Placing a knee on either side of him, she guided him into her sex.

He groaned as she forced herself down, taking his entire length inside her. His hands held her hips, rocking her back and forwards on his cock.

Janine gripped the top of the sofa backrest and bucked her hips, grinding herself on him, sending his cock deep inside with each forward thrust.

Adam pushed her top and bra up, pinching her nipples as soon as her boobs were released. Crying out, she pulled him by the hair, crushing his face to her chest. When his mouth closed round her nipple she grunted, and then an orgasm slammed through her pent-up body with a fierceness that made her scream.

Scratching at the back of his neck, Janine pushed down into his lap and bucked her hips as she rode the waves ripping through her. Adam cried out when she bit his shoulder, but then she heard him whimper and sigh as he let go inside her, flooding her with his own release.

They moved together slowly, both shaking during the come-down. Make-up sex was the ultimate way to get rid of tension, and Janine's body relaxed for the first time in the last twelve hours.

Sitting up, she stroked Adam's face, his cock still inside her but now depleted. She leaned close and whispered in his ear, "We could have done that last night and been five grand better off."

He closed his eyes and sighed.

Janine climbed off him and went to the bathroom to clean up. By the time she got back, Adam had pulled his shorts up and held out her jeans and panties.

Janine took them. “Thanks.” Once dressed, she sat down in the armchair opposite him and leaned forward. “There’s something I need to ask.”

His face became serious. Worried. He nodded, his eyes wide.

“Why did you use both our names on the loans?”

“I...I don’t know.”

Janine wasn’t sure she believed him. “Did you think trying to saddle me with half of your debt would mean I couldn’t just walk away when I discovered you were still gambling?”

He closed his eyes, and she could see him biting his lower lip.

“We’re already tied into a joint mortgage. Your financial problems are my financial problems.” She watched his shoulders drop as he exhaled long and hard. She hated pressing the point—especially after such great make-up sex—but couldn’t let his selfish behaviour go yet, either. “Adam, it’s important you understand how wrong it was to do that.”

He finally looked at her. “I didn’t want—”

“As Bromley pointed out, you committed a crime by adding my name.” She let her words sink in before continuing. “I’m still here because I love you.”

He nodded, his eyes brimming with tears. “Thank you. And I love you, too. I’ll do anything—”

“You’re going to have to do something. We don’t make enough money to make payments on the loan and pay our mortgage. So we need to come up with a plan.”

Adam sat forward. “I’ll volunteer for any extra shifts or overtime at the factory, but I’ve also had another idea.”

“Oh?”

“You know Ian, from work?”

Janine nodded.

“He does taxi-driving a few nights a week for his uncle. I’m going to see if they need any more drivers. He reckons he gets almost as much from Friday and Saturday nights driving the taxi as he does working all week at the factory.”

Janine considered this; the metal frame fabricators where Adam worked hadn’t offered any overtime for a couple of years, so the only extra shifts he could realistically hope to get were covering for people who were ill or on holiday. If he could work a few nights a week as a taxi driver, it would be a big help.

“What do you think?”

Janine nodded enthusiastically. “It’d be good if you could get a few hours taxi-driving. But just for a while; I don’t want to spend every Friday and Saturday night sitting at home on my own.”

“Yeah, sure. I’ll text Ian in a bit, ask him to put a word in for me.”

Janine stood up. “I’ll try and get a few extra hours at work, too. And maybe I could ask to see if any of my mates want me to do their hair at home. It’d be cheaper than they’d pay in a salon, and cash in hand for me.”

Adam nodded. “Okay, sounds like a plan.” A mischievous grin creased his face. “Maybe you could start charging the guys more for the cut and blow you give them.”

“Bastard.” Janine threw a cushion at him, glad they were going to be working together to get through this.

* * * *

Adam’s friend Ian helped him get the taxi-driving job, and on his first night—a Tuesday—he brought home less than twenty-five pounds.

Janine tried to hide her disappointment. “It’s a start.”

Adam nodded, his face grim. “I’ve got to show I can manage okay before they let me work the weekends, when it’s busy. But they said there are a few early morning runs to the airport if I want them.”

“What about the factory?”

“I can do the runs before I go to work. People flying off on holiday often need to be at the airport for five in the morning.”

Janine didn't want to point out that if they'd avoided the casino and gone on holiday themselves, there'd be no need for putting all these hours in. “You can't work yourself to death, you know.”

He slipped his arms around her waist, pulling her close. “I got us into this mess, and I'm going to get us out of it.”

She rested her head on his shoulder, relieved to see him showing the sort of commitment needed by both of them. “We'll get through this.”

Adam smiled and cupped his hands around her bum cheeks, pushing his crotch against her. “If I'm working myself to death, you're going to have to make it worth my while.”

Janine slapped his arm and pulled away from him. “After what you did, you're lucky I don't ban you from my body until the debt's fully paid off.”

His smile disappeared and he turned away.

Although she hadn't meant to be cruel, Janine wanted him to remember who'd got them into this mess.

Over the next few days, Janine performed three hair-colourings, and Adam did two early-morning airport runs and a full Thursday evening shift in the taxi.

Janine sat on the sofa counting out the money. She laid the last note onto the pile. “A hundred and seventy quid. That's not bad considering we've only been doing it a couple of weeks.”

Adam nodded, but his expression suggested he'd expected more.

She saw him stifle a yawn and felt slightly guilty that her extra income had been earned in the comfort of her friends' houses. She'd apply the dye, they'd have a cuppa and chat for half an hour, then Janine would rinse and dry their hair. Adam, on the other hand, had twice gotten up at four in the morning to drive to the airport before a full shift at the factory, and also worked a four-hour evening during which one of his passengers had been drunk and aggressive, only agreeing to pay the fare when his friends had calmed him down.

“Come on,” she coaxed him up from the sofa. “Since this may be our last Friday night to ourselves for a while, let’s go out for a drink.”

“I thought we were saving up.” His voice was flat. Sarcastic.

Janine glared at him. *Yes, and whose fault’s that?* “You’re right. Let’s stay in and watch a film.”

Adam stood. “I’m going to bed. I’m knackered.”

Janine stared open-mouthed as he headed to the bathroom. She checked her watch and saw it was only a little after nine. She waited until he’d finished in the bathroom and gone into the bedroom before she turned on the TV. One of the *Bourne* films had just started, so she curled her legs up beneath her and settled in to enjoy the action.

When she got into bed two hours later, Adam was fast asleep.

* * * *

Janine went to work on Saturday morning as usual. She’d left Adam asleep in bed, not wanting to wake him since he’d been so tired. One of the other girls had gone on holiday so she’d volunteered to work the full day, rather than her usual morning shift. When she arrived home just before six, all she wanted to do was sit in the bath and rest her feet.

Adam sat on the sofa watching TV. He looked up with a frown on his face. “I thought you’d be home hours ago.”

“I’m covering for Eloise this week. I did tell you about it.” Janine was annoyed at him for making her feel guilty about being at work. “I’m also going to be covering her late Thursday shift as well.”

“Great.” He turned back to look at the TV, his expression miserable.

Slamming her bag onto the armchair, Janine leaned into his line of sight. “We need the money, remember?” With that, she stomped off to fill the bath then went into the bedroom to remove her clothes.

A few minutes later she lowered herself into the hot water, still tense and angry about Adam’s spoilt kid behaviour. She didn’t mean to keep throwing the fact they needed to find more money in his face, but sometimes he acted as if it was her fault they were hardly seeing each other.

Adam popped his head round the door a little later. "I'm sorry for being grumpy earlier."

Janine sighed. "And I'm sorry for snapping. I should have texted to remind you I was working late, but I never got the chance. I've been on my feet from nine 'til half-five without a break. It took me an hour and a half to eat my sandwich, only getting time for one bite between each customer."

Adam nodded, looking suitably contrite. "Shall I make us some chicken pasta?"

"That would be lovely."

While Adam made dinner, Janine washed her hair in the bath then dressed in leggings and a vest top. They ate at the breakfast bar in their kitchenette.

Janine didn't want to spoil their evening, but there were things she wanted to ask. "I think we should go and see Bromley sometime this week, so we can start paying off the money we owe."

Adam nodded, chewing and swallowing before he could answer. "Yeah, I suppose."

She waited, but Adam took another mouthful of pasta to show he had nothing more to add. They finished dinner in relative silence, then Adam moved to the sofa and turned the volume up on the TV. There was some program he seemed to want to see, and Janine spent the evening half-watching while surfing the web on her phone. She headed off to bed at eleven and fell asleep before Adam joined her.

On Sunday morning Janine intended suggesting they both go for a walk by the canal, but it started raining before they'd even finish breakfast. The grey day set the mood indoors; each time she tried to start a conversation, Adam gave short answers with none of the light-heartedness he usually brought to all their chats.

Throughout the rest of the week, they barely saw each other until the Friday night, when Adam got home at ten after running a family home to Blackburn from the airport. He grinned as he held up a four-pack of lager and a bottle of Cava. "They gave me a twenty-quid tip, so I frittered most of it away on booze."

Janine laughed. "I hope it's chilled."

“They both are.”

She got up and headed towards the kitchenette. “Do you want a glass?”

He shook his head and popped a ring-pull, taking a slug from the beer-can before removing his jacket.

Janine set her glass on the coffee table and Adam removed the cork and poured for her. For what felt like the first time in ages, they cuddled while they watched TV, and chatted between programs. After a couple of glasses, she felt more relaxed than she had since their ill-fated trip to the casino. She managed to drink the entire bottle.

When they got in bed, Adam stroked a hand down Janine’s leg under the quilt. She sighed and closed her eyes, enjoying his soft fingertips tracing over her thigh. This closeness was something she’d missed.

He brought his head close and kissed her ear, brushing his tongue along her lobe in the way she liked it. “I went to see Bromley today.”

Janine opened her eyes, surprised. “What? Why? I thought we’d agreed to go together.”

He kept his hand moving on her thigh as he spoke. “I nipped out at lunchtime. Thought it’d save us time over the weekend.”

Not wanting to spoil the mood, Janine hid her annoyance. “Did he give you any paperwork?”

Adam moved his hand a little higher, and she automatically opened her legs wider. “No, he said it’s still being drawn up. The payments aren’t due to start until the end of the month.”

He inched his hand higher and began stroking her crotch through the thin material of her thong. She stopped caring about his visit to Bromley and moved her pelvis slowly up and down to get the friction she craved.

When he pushed with a little more force, the cotton gusset slipped between her slick outer lips and she groaned. He continued to slowly stroke and prod through the material for a little longer before pulling it to one side and slipping two fingers deep inside her.

“Ah...” Janine arched her back and pushed herself further onto his fingers, loving the feeling of them deep inside her.

He leaned over her and took a nipple into his mouth, sending electric tingles through her body. He pumped his arm and finger-fucked her.

Janine whimpered and started thrusting her hips in rhythm to meet each push of his fingers.

He bit her ear. "I think you made quite an impression on Bromley." His voice was a husky whisper. He pushed his tongue into her ear again.

Janine moaned, more interested in what he did with his fingers than what he said. She reached over and gripped his cock, which felt nice and hard. She moved her hand up and down his shaft, squeezing it. "I think you should put this inside me now."

Adam chuckled in her ear, then moved his thumb over her clit as he continued to finger-fuck her. "Would any cock do?"

She was too revved up for teasing games. "Unless you have a bigger one in your drawer, I'm going to have to make do with this..."

Adam removed his fingers and she quickly slid off her panties. Sliding on top of her, he positioned his cock at her entrance and held himself up on his arms, smiling down into her face. "Bromley made an interesting comment in his office today."

"Oh?" Janine moved her hands down his back and gripped his firm buttocks, trying to pull him into her.

Adam nodded while sliding the tip of his cock through her outer lips. "Mmm. He mentioned something about us coming to an arrangement over the interest payments..."

Janine dug her nails into his backside until he finally slid his cock home, making her sigh. "Oh, yeah..."

Adam kept himself raised above her on his arms, fucking her with slow, deep strokes. "I think Bromley would like to be where I am now."

She laughed and clenched herself around him. "I guess there are a few men who'd like to be doing this to me."

He pushed into her a little harder. "All your *cut and blow* customers?"

She half-closed her eyes flirtatiously. "Maybe..."

“But would they pay three hundred quid for it?” Adam grinned, but his eyes suggested he was being serious.

Janine felt the first tingles of her orgasm and started grinding against his pelvic bone. “Maybe I’d let them do it for free if they made me feel good.”

“That’s because you’re easy.”

Janine gritted her teeth and pulled him down on top of her, putting her mouth to his ear. “I’m going to come soon.”

He gripped her hips and pulled her up to meet his thrusts. “I’ll race you to the finish line...”

Janine closed her eyes and concentrated on the sensations she felt. Her nipples were being stimulated as his chest moved against hers. She could feel her sex stretching and closing as his cock slid in and out, and the constant friction of his pelvic bone on her clit carried her up to the point of no return.

Before the swelling wave inside her had chance to break, Adam grunted and his cock twitched. He was coming, and she clung to him as she tumbled into her own spiral of ecstasy.

Adam dug his fingers into her bum cheeks and held her tight while he unloaded inside her. She greeted his gift with whimpers and moans, her body shaking with the final ripples of her orgasm. They clung to each other until their bodies finally stilled and Adam rolled off.

Janine rolled onto her side to face him, kissed his neck. “I’ve missed this.”

“Me too, but it’s hard when we’re both spending so much time working.”

Whose fucking fault’s that? Janine bit her lip, rubbed his shoulder. “We should always find time for ourselves.”

He nodded, then turned onto his side to face her. “You’re right.”

“So, tell me about seeing Bromley.”

He raised his eyebrows. “Well, he seemed to be quite taken with you.”

She laughed. “What makes you think so?”

“Like I said, he seemed quite keen to come to some arrangement over our interest payments.”

“Oh really. Does he want me to work as a topless croupier when there’s a stag party in the casino?”

Adam laughed and moved his hand to her breast, squeezing her nipple. “I’m sure he’d like that.”

“Or maybe I could stand on the roulette table, naked except for a pair of red shoes, and spin the wheel with my four-inch stiletto heel.”

Adam seemed to like her ideas. “Or you could sit on the craps table and let everyone roll the dice between your legs.” He frowned, shook his head. “No, we might lose too many dice that way.”

“Cheeky bugger!” She pushed her finger into his stomach, making him flinch.

“Actually, he seemed to be more interested in spending half an hour in private with you.”

Janine stared at him, waiting for the punchline. It didn’t come. “You *are* joking.”

He narrowed his eyes. “Don’t pretend you didn’t notice the way he looked at you when we were in the casino.”

“Of course I didn’t notice. I was too busy trying not to shit myself in his office when I found out what a twat you’d been.”

Adam looked suitably shamed. “Yeah, I know that. But you looked really hot that night, and Bromley obviously noticed. And remembered.”

She glared at him. “Tell me what really happened.” She imagined him walking through the plush casino in his work clothes. She hoped he’d taken his overalls off.

“Bromley seemed surprised to see me—said he wasn’t expecting to hear from us until the end of the month. But when we started talking, he mentioned waiving the interest payments if we could come to an arrangement involving you and him.”

“I hope you told him to go fuck himself with a big spiky cactus.”

Adam laughed. “I didn’t use your poetic language, but I said we’d pay the interest with regular cash. I explained there’s no way you’d go for

that arrangement.”

Janine thought about what had been discussed in her absence, not sure whether to be flattered or disgusted. Maybe she was flattered *and* disgusted, but mostly she felt angry at what Adam had said. She poked him hard in his stomach.

“Ow. What’s that for?”

“You told him *I* wouldn’t go for that arrangement?”

“Yeah.”

She prodded him again. “It would have been better if you’d said *we* wouldn’t go for that arrangement, because otherwise it sounds like you’d have no problem with me prostituting myself.”

“Eh? No, I mean, yeah, that’s what I said.”

“Hmm.” She glared, unimpressed that she’d had to clarify how he should have termed their refusal.

Adam stroked his hand down her waist and over the swell of her hip. “I thought you’d be flattered that he’d fancied you enough to suggest it.”

Janine closed her eyes and enjoyed Adam’s hand stroking her. She thought about giving herself to another man for money, just letting him use her body. When she rolled onto her tummy, Adam’s hand slipped between her legs. The juices of their sex had seeped down there, leaving the crevice hot and slick.

He rolled on top of her and slipped his flaccid cock between the cheeks of her bum.

As he pushed against her, Janine squirmed. His cock swelled and she’d be happy to go again if he could manage it. She began thrusting her hips, rubbing her clit against the sheet as Adam’s cock slid through the valley of her backside.

His mouth was back at her ear. “Seems to me, you like the idea more than you’re letting on…”

“No I don’t, but I like the idea of you fucking me again, like this.” She pushed her bum up against his groin, felt his cock stiffen.

“I think the idea of it’s turning you on...” He nibbled the nape of her neck.

He reached down to guide himself inside her and she raised her pelvis to give him easier access. As he pushed slowly inside, Janine let out a long, grateful sigh.

Adam started to fuck her slowly, his hands on her hips, pulling her down to meet his thrusts. “You like that?”

“Hmm. Take your time and keep doing me like this, nice and slow.”

He pushed deeper but maintained the same rhythm. Reaching one hand round her body, his fingers closed around her nipple.

Janine whimpered and pushed herself back onto him a little harder, loving the feeling of his cock inside her. She slid her knees up the bed a little to raise herself up off the mattress by a few inches.

Adam readjusted himself to accommodate the new position and pounded her harder.

Although she’d never admit it to him, Janine imagined she was being fucked by someone else. Someone who just wanted her body. No strings, no emotions. No agenda except for the simple pleasure of using her body as a way of getting off. Suddenly her orgasm arrived from nowhere, setting lights flashing behind her eyelids.

Adam suddenly knelt up on the bed and banged her with force as she contracted around his cock. He let out a grunt as he reached his own release, his fingers digging painfully into her hips.

When they’d both got their breath back, Adam withdrew and lay on his side of the bed. Janine went to the bathroom to clean up, a little uneasy that the thought of being used had brought on her climax.

Once back in bed, she lay her head on Adam’s chest and he turned the light off. They lay in silence for a couple of minutes, but something he’d mentioned earlier played on her mind.

“Why three hundred pounds?”

Adam turned his head. “Huh?”

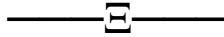
“Earlier tonight you asked if any of the customers who fancied me would pay three hundred pounds to be in your place.”

He paused for a second. “Well, that’s the figure Bromley mentioned.”

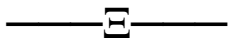
“But the interest on our loan is six hundred pounds per month.”

Adam took a deep breath. “Yeah, he said he’d want to see you every two weeks.”

She scoffed, offended. “Cheeky bugger! If he wants to fuck me, tell him it’ll be six hundred pounds a time.” The words were out of her mouth before she knew it, propelled by anger and alcohol. She was mortified. Before Adam could retort, she turned her back on him and lay quietly until he fell asleep.



Ψ



Chapter Three

Neither of them mentioned Bromley's offer the following morning. While Janine showered and dressed, Adam made toast and coffee. They both left the flat at the same time, kissing before he headed to their car and she set off on the short walk to the salon.

Working in a unisex hairdressers meant there were at least half a dozen men visiting the salon on most days, and Janine was used to being watched as she worked. Although the men always tried to be discreet about giving her body the once-over, there were too many mirrors for her not to notice their ogling. She used to get annoyed by it, but later acknowledged it as a thing that men do. They were just admiring the view without being lecherous.

A male customer arrived early for his appointment and had to wait for over fifteen minutes. As Janine chatted to the woman whose bob she was working on, she noticed the guy's eyes gazing at her backside and legs. For reasons she couldn't explain, she found herself enjoying the attention. It aroused her. She wanted him to fancy her, to lust after her. Wanted him to fantasise about using her body.

Janine licked her lips and giggled at something her client said. She bent at the waist to emphasise the curve of her bum in the tight skirt, stood on tiptoes to enhance her calf muscles, then leaned back and ran her fingers through her own hair so that her boobs pressed against her loose top. The man waiting for his haircut watched every move. She wondered if he'd pay to have sex with her.

She conjured a fantasy.

She's naked while cutting his wet hair, leaning her body against him as she reaches up to trim the top. The hair clippings land on her arms and breasts, sticking to her. Their eyes meet and she pulls him from the chair. She kneels on the seat, gripping the arm rests. He stands close behind her, and she watches in one of the mirrors as he undoes his zipper. His cock is

big and hard. She lets out a grateful sigh as he slides it in, her hands gripping the chair arms as he fucks her slowly.

“I can do your eleven o’clock if you like.”

She ignores everything but the sensations in her pussy. She wants the guy to keep fucking her. It feels good as he sinks all the way inside her, and she’s pushing herself back to meet each thrust of his—

“Janine!” Eloise grabbed her arm.

“Sorry, what?”

Her colleague laughed. “I’m free, so I can do your eleven o’clock now if you like.”

Janine looked at the guy, then back at Eloise. “If you don’t mind, that’d be great. Thanks.”

A little embarrassed, Janine smiled at the woman in her chair and shook her head. “Sorry, what were you saying?”

* * * *

By the end of the week, Janine and Adam had both put in more hours of work to earn extra cash. They sat in their flat on Friday evening, both tired. On the coffee table in front of them was a pile of money, which Janine counted.

As she added the last five pound note she looked up into Adam’s eyes. “I make it seven hundred and fifteen.”

“Yeah, that’s what I counted it as. Next month should be even better, because I’ll have done a few weekend shifts by then.”

Janine nodded. An uncomfortable silence developed and she couldn’t bring herself to look at him. Bromley’s suggestion hadn’t been mentioned since the previous weekend’s passion, but she’d spent a lot of time thinking about it.

Adam eventually broke the silence. “So...” He took a deep breath. “I can take this to Bromley and tell him we’re paying the interest plus £115 towards the debt itself. That will leave us a balance of £4,135 to pay.”

She nodded slowly, bit her bottom lip. She could hear her pulse raging in her ears.

Adam looked at her and they held eye contact for a few seconds. “Or...”

She swallowed. “Or I could do what Brom—”

“I don’t want to put any pressure on you.”

Janine stared at him open-mouthed. She’d thought he’d say *I don’t want you to do that*. But no, her long-term boyfriend apparently had no problem with her turning to prostitution.

“He’s happy to pay six hundred.”

“What? How the hell would you know that?”

He looked startled at her question. “I phoned him earlier in the week, after what you’d said the other night in bed.”

“You *phoned* him?”

“Yeah. I told him you’d said he’ll have to pay six hundred quid, not three.” He seemed genuinely pleased, like he’d negotiated a good deal.

“You are such a dick. Sometimes I feel like I hardly know you at all.”

“You were up for the idea last—”

Janine leaned back and shook her head, disbelieving. “Adam, we were in bed having sex. I thought it was part of the foreplay. *Dirty-talk*, you know? I didn’t expect you to phone him and haggle over the price.”

“But you liked the idea—”

“I liked the idea of *us* having sex. My enthusiasm in bed was because I was turned on, and I wanted sex with you.”

Adam glanced at the small pile of cash and shrugged his shoulders. “Well, like I said, we can still pay it all using the money.”

Janine glared at him, still shocked that he’d phoned Bromley to say she’d let him fuck her if he doubled the fee. How did that make her look?

Adam took a folded piece of paper from his jeans back pocket and opened it up, flattening it on the table. “If we stick to plan A, next month should be better as I’m going to be given a shift on either a Friday or

Saturday night. So we'll probably have about nine hundred quid, which means we'll be able to pay three hundred off the loan."

She could see various calculations scrawled in his handwriting on the sheet. He'd evidently been working out the figures.

"If we can repay three hundred pounds of capital a month, then we'll have cleared the debt in fourteen months."

Janine thought about spending another fourteen months working as many hours as she'd done over the last few weeks. "And how much interest will we have paid by then?"

He looked at his sheet and frowned. "I'm not sure, because he said the amount we pay should come down as the capital gets paid off. But based on the £600 figure, we'll be paying over eight grand."

"Eight *thousand* pounds?"

He nodded. "Fourteen months at six hundred a month comes out at eight thousand four hundred. But if it comes down as we pay off capital, then the interest payments could be less. Like I said, I'm not sure how to calculate it accurately."

Janine closed her eyes and tried to work out the numbers, but maths had never been her strong point. "So, with the interest *and* capital, we're going to be paying almost thirteen thousand pounds."

Adam looked at his crib sheet. "I struggled figuring out how the interest would work out, but yeah—I make it twelve thousand, six hundred and fifty quid."

"How long would it take us to pay off the loan if we..." *allow Bromley to fuck me.* Janine swallowed. "How long if we pay nine hundred a month?"

"Five months. We'd have paid it off by Christmas."

Janine counted out the months on her fingers. *August, September, October, November and December.* She thought again about them both working an extra fifteen hours every week for the next fourteen months. Her mind wandered back to her fantasy about the man in the salon using her body.

Adam cleared his throat. "What are you thinking?"

She looked up into his eyes, her heart drumming inside her. “I’d only have to see him five times, right?”

Adam nodded.

“So if we’d save £8,400 by not paying any interest—”

“He’d effectively be paying you £1,680 a time.”

Janine was disappointed that he’d already worked out the amount. The figure surprised her, though. Would Bromley really pay that much money just to sleep with her? Would anyone?

She took a breath. “How would you feel if I slept with him?”

“Fine.”

She glared at him.

He back-tracked. “I mean, I’d be jealous, obviously. And I’d rather it wasn’t necessary.”

Janine kept quiet, but couldn’t deny being flattered that a man fancied her enough to give up that amount of money to have sex with her.

Adam looked at the cash on the table. “But it’s not like you’ve never had other men before.”

“*What?*” Was he accusing her of cheating?

He looked up into her eyes. “You know, you weren’t a virgin when we met, so it’s not like I’m the only bloke you’ve ever slept with.”

She couldn’t understand this line of reasoning. “Are you saying it’d be different if you were the only man I’d ever slept with?”

“Yeah, probably. But—you know—there’s been others, so it’s not like you’ve never done anything with somebody else.”

“I haven’t slept with anyone else in the five years we’ve been together.”

He nodded. “Yeah, and neither have I. But I mean...” He shrugged. “It’s not like I’m the only one.”

Why would Adam have been more protective if he’d been the one who’d taken her virginity? She wasn’t sure how this made her feel, but she didn’t have time to think about the implications. “But you’d accept the fact that another man would be having sex with me?”

“I told him he’d have to use a condom.”

She stared at him, too stunned to reply.

“I mean, I told him you were on the pill and that, but that he’d have to wear a rubber.”

She couldn’t believe how oblivious and insensitive he was being. “You actually discussed my method of contraception with the man you’re pimping me out to?”

“What? No, I just said I didn’t want him coming inside you because —”

“*Adam!*” Janine stood up and paced the floor. “You are fucking unbelievable.”

He looked up, eyes wide and mouth open.

“*You* got us into this mess, so why don’t *you* sleep with Bromley?”

He smirked. “He doesn’t fancy me.”

Janine wanted to punch him. “I don’t care. Let him fuck you up the arse. Give him a blowjob. It’ll be okay, because I’ll tell him to wear a condom.”

Adam leaned back on the couch and exhaled. “Like I said, we can pay it all in cash. I thought you liked the idea.”

“Why would you think I liked the idea of becoming a prostitute?”

“Because of the way you reacted in bed when I mentioned it. Because of how wet you were, and how quickly you came. How hard you came. Your contractions were so strong, it actually hurt my dick when you climaxed.”

She stared at him, astonished. He’d never displayed this sort of insight during the previous five years, so how could he suddenly know what she wouldn’t admit, even to herself?

He smiled. “Tell me the idea doesn’t turn you on.” He watched her closely.

Janine felt naked under his gaze. She swallowed, thought briefly about her fantasy in the salon—this time with Bromley standing behind her as she knelt on the chair. “It’s flattering to think another man would pay a lot of money—”

“Forget about the money. I’m talking about the idea of being with another man.”

She blinked. “If I wanted another man, I’d choose one I fancy.”

“But this isn’t about fancying him, or even liking him. This is simply an act of letting a stranger use your body.”

A shiver ran down her spine.

Adam’s eyes narrowed; he’d seen her reaction. “Like I said, it’s your decision.”

She held her breath as their eyes locked, then slowly exhaled and licked her lips. “It has to be *our* decision, because it affects us both.”

“How d’you mean?” His vacant expression suggested that not only had he failed to see her sarcastic dig at his behaviour in taking out the loan in joint names, he also saw no downside to his girlfriend having sex with someone else as repayment for a debt.

Janine sighed. “What I mean is, would our relationship still be okay afterwards?”

Adam nodded, as if trying to convince her. “It’ll be less intimate with the condom. You know, his cum won’t be going—”

“*Adam!*” She shook her head, closed her eyes and thought of another way to phrase it. “What I mean is, you can’t throw this back in my face in the future, or use it against me in an argument.”

“No, ’course not.” He shook his head. “I mean, I wouldn’t.”

Janine took a deep breath, then nodded. “Okay, I’ll do it.”

He watched her for a few seconds, then nodded once.

Although he’d had the decency not to smile, she could see the relief in his eyes. He wanted this. In that moment, Janine knew that whatever had been special about their relationship was dead.

Putting the money back into the envelope, Adam leaned back and flicked the TV on. Janine went to the bathroom and stared at herself in the mirror. Fantasising about giving yourself to a stranger and actually going through with it were not the same thing. She hoped she’d be able to do it.

After half-watching a film for an hour or so, Janine headed up to bed a little after ten. In the dark, she thought about what she’d agreed to do.

She had a tingling sensation in her stomach. Squeezing her thighs together, she felt wetness pooling inside her sex. Her mind knew it was wrong, but her body seemed to like the idea.

* * * *

Janine got up and left for work without waking Adam. He'd be working late tonight doing his first taxi-driving shift at a weekend, so she decided to let him rest. At the salon she chatted to clients and her colleagues the same as usual, but found her mind kept drifting to what she'd agreed to do with Bromley. She felt nervous about the act itself, which seemed silly because she could just lie back and think of the money. But would she be able to do that? The thing that worried her the most was what other people would say if they ever found out. She'd be called a whore, and it'd be an accurate label.

Many women had found themselves forced into doing exactly the same thing but, deep down, Janine knew she wasn't actually being forced at all.

No, she couldn't claim this was a last-ditch attempt to save herself from a lifetime of poverty and hardship. The decision hadn't been financial—at least not entirely. She liked the idea of letting a stranger ride her. It turned her on. Another thought occurred: was she unconsciously punishing Adam? Could this be her way of getting back at him for using her name on the debt? No, he'd made it obvious he didn't object to it. Janine had to accept that the reason for going along with it was to satisfy her inner slut.

When she got home that night, the flat smelled of pizza.

Adam sat on the couch with a large takeaway box on his knee and a bottle of Coke in his hand. "Hiya. Thought we'd eat early—I hope that's okay?"

She dropped her bag and coat on the chair and sighed. "Perfect—I didn't get chance to eat lunch today."

He turned the box so she could get a slice, then pulled another bottle of Coke from a carrier bag by his feet, passing it to her.

She took the bottle and picked up a slice of pizza. “Thanks. Are you ready for your first Saturday night?”

“Yeah. Ian reckons it’s fairly steady ’til ten, then after eleven it gets hectic until about two in the morning.”

“Are you going to be okay? I knew you’d be working late, that’s why I didn’t wake you this morning.”

He smiled and nodded. “Thanks, I’ll be fine.”

Janine knew he’d planned to take the money to the casino today, but couldn’t bring herself to mention it first. She took another bite of pizza.

“I went to see Bromley as planned...”

She had a mouthful of pepperoni, so nodded for him to continue.

“I said we’d agreed all of the money should be put toward the debt itself, and he could get the interest payment whenever it suited him.”

Janine swallowed, her heart banging in her chest. “What did he say?”

“He seemed pleased with the decision.”

Janine waited, butterflies in her stomach. “So...?”

“He’s going to text me the exact time, but he’ll come round sometime tomorrow.”

“Here? He’s coming to our flat?” She’d never imagined they’d be using their apartment.

Adam nodded, his expression suggesting her question surprised him. “Did you think he’d want to have you on the desk in his office?”

“No, but I didn’t expect it to be in our bed, either!”

“What difference does it make?”

Janine inhaled and closed her eyes, resigned to the fact he would never understand. “Yeah, you’re right. If you don’t mind him using my body, why should you mind him using our bed?”

“What? I thought we’d agreed—”

“Forget it—here’s fine.” She thought for a few seconds. “Where are you going to be?”

He looked round their living room. “Here.”

“You’re going to sit here while another man has sex with me through there?” Janine nodded towards the bedroom door.

“Yeah. I thought you’d prefer me to be around—”

“What, listening to the bed springs creak?”

An uncomfortable silence settled over them. Adam checked his watch.

Janine softened her voice. “What time does your shift start?”

“I’ll have to leave here in ten minutes.”

She stood and walked to the kitchenette. “Do you want a coffee before you go?”

“Yeah, cheers.”

While they drank their coffees they chatted about her day in the salon, and he kissed her cheek when he left. Standing alone in the flat, Janine felt suddenly very tired. She walked into the bedroom and looked around; she’d have to clear some stuff away before tomorrow. Bromley probably wouldn’t care about an untidy room, but she would.

She decided to have a bath to unwind. While the tub filled, she picked up the clothes from the bedroom floor and put them away. She also removed the bottles of perfume from the dressing table and dusted the surface before putting them back. Earrings and bracelets were put into her jewellery box, and the four pairs of shoes left scattered on the floor were tidied into the wardrobe. In the kitchenette she poured herself a glass of wine, then went for her bath.

Lying back in the piping-hot water, she closed her eyes and tried to imagine what tomorrow would be like.

* * * *

Janine opened her eyes and saw Adam sleeping soundly beside her. She checked her phone; a quarter to eight. She’d finished the bottle of wine before hitting the sack at around midnight, but had no idea what time Adam had arrived home. She silently climbed out of bed, pulled on her robe and went to make herself a cup of coffee. She’d just started drinking it when

Adam came out of the bedroom wearing only a t-shirt and boxers, his hair sticking up in all directions and the shadow of stubble on his face.

She held up her cup. "Fancy a coffee?"

"Yeah, cheers." He walked to the couch and collapsed onto it, obviously still tired.

Janine poured his coffee and carried both their cups to the couch and sat next to him. "How was last night?"

"Busy, but good. I reckon I should get over ninety quid. I got over twenty in tips alone."

"That's great. What time did you finish?"

"Got back here about half-two."

Janine sipped her coffee. "Do you want some toast, or anything?"

He shook his head. "No thanks." He checked his watch, then his face turned serious. "Bromley's coming round at eleven."

They looked at each other for a few seconds before he broke eye-contact and took another drink from his cup.

She wondered how he felt. *Does he care?* She tried to identify her own emotional state: nervous mostly, but with a definite shiver of excitement. It felt surreal; in three hours' time she'd be having sex with somebody they owed money to, and Adam would be listening to her do it.

Janine finished her coffee and went back into the bedroom. She opened the window and made the bed, then pulled on a pair of black leggings and a grey t-shirt. In the bathroom she brushed her teeth, cleansed her face and tied back her hair. When she walked back into the lounge area, she sat on the armchair and pulled on a pair of trainers. She could sense Adam watching her.

She looked up at him and sighed. "I don't want to sit and fidget for three hours, so I'm going to go for a walk and grab a coffee."

"Want me to join you?"

He was being considerate, but she wanted to be alone. "No, it's fine. Why don't you sit there and rest after your late night?"

"Okay."

It was a beautiful morning, and quite a few people were walking by the canal. She saw couples walking hand in hand and wondered about their relationships. Would the tall guy in the blue t-shirt allow another man to sleep with his pretty blonde girlfriend for money? A voice inside Janine's head twisted the question round. *Does his pretty blonde girlfriend fantasise about being used by another man?*

Janine stopped at the same café as before and ordered a coffee, but couldn't contemplate eating because of the butterflies in her stomach. She skim-read the news on her phone without really taking in any of the information. By the time she'd strolled back to the flat it was after ten. Washed, shaved, and dressed in jeans and a t-shirt, Adam sat on the couch watching something about Formula 1 racing.

He muted the TV and looked up at her. "You okay?"

She nodded. "Are you?"

"Yeah." He frowned and shrugged.

Janine couldn't help thinking that his show of reluctance was simply that: a show. She looked round the flat, then down at herself. "I suppose I'd better get changed before..."

Adam didn't reply.

Once in their bedroom, she wondered what she should wear. In normal circumstances—that is, if she'd been meeting a man for their first date—she'd wear something nice, with makeup and perfume. But this wasn't a usual first date; this was an appointment for sex.

Janine had no intention of wearing makeup or perfume, but she couldn't wear leggings and trainers, either. She removed her trainers, leggings and t-shirt and regarded herself in the mirror wearing her white bra and panties. Her body looked good, nicely tanned after a warm summer. Eventually she chose a dark blue skirt and a light blue cotton top. She pulled on a pair of flat black shoes because she didn't want to be barefoot when he arrived, though she couldn't explain why.

She removed her ponytail and brushed her hair, then walked through to join Adam. They sat in an uncomfortable silence for ten minutes. They both jumped when the intercom buzzed, and they stared at one another for long seconds before Adam got up to let him in.

By the time Bromley had walked up the stairs and knocked on their apartment door, Janine had got off the couch and stood in the middle of the room. Adam opened the door and stepped back to let him in.

Bromley wore a white polo-shirt and dark chinos. He looked different without his suit—younger. He was bigger than she remembered, much broader across the chest than Adam.

He nodded at Adam, then looked at Janine and smiled. “Hello, Janine.” He sounded friendly, relaxed.

“Hi.” She looked down at the floor, unsure of what else to say. She didn’t think ‘*Do you want a coffee before you fuck me?*’ would be appropriate.

Bromley looked around the flat, then at Adam. “Are you staying here?”

Adam’s expression looked like that of a rabbit caught in headlights. “Er, yeah, I thought I’d—”

“Suit yourself.” Bromley looked at Janine and raised his eyebrows.

She glanced at Adam and looked back at Bromley. Then she turned and walked slowly towards the bedroom door, her legs shaking with each step. Bromley followed her and closed the door behind him. They stood three feet apart and looked at each other, Janine’s heart threatening to break out of her chest. Bromley’s eyes really were an intense shade of blue. She found herself gripped by nervousness.

“D-d’you want me to take my clothes off?”

He held her gaze for a couple of seconds, then shook his head once. “You’ll be fine like that. We can just pull your skirt up.”

Janine swallowed, then nodded. She reached up her skirt, slipped her hands into the waistband of her panties and pulled them down her legs. As she stepped out of them, she kicked off her shoes.

She sat at the foot of the bed and back-crawled up until she lay in the middle. Watching Bromley’s face, she slowly inched her skirt up to reveal more of her legs. She stopped when the hem reached mid-thigh, not wishing to flash her crotch at him.

He looked down at her legs, nodding his head appreciatively.

Janine could see the bulge in his trousers, and a shiver ran through her.

Bromley took his phone from his trouser pocket and held it up. “Janine, I’m going to have to ask you to confirm what we’re doing here today is not against your wishes, so that I can record it.”

She frowned, puzzled. “What?” Was this something else Adam and Bromley had already discussed?

“I want you to confirm on film that what’s about to happen is consensual.” His voice sounded quiet and calm.

Her mind raced. Was this some kind of scam to get proof of her prostituting herself? Could he use the film against her, maybe threaten to get her arrested for solicitation? “I don’t understand—”

He lowered his phone. “All I’m doing is protecting myself.”

“But my boyfriend knows about this, so why would—?”

“You might trust him, but I certainly don’t.”

She realised that Bromley suspected this may be a scam that she and Adam had plotted; pretend to be a willing partner, then threaten to go to the police with the rape allegation unless he cancelled the debt. She saw his point and nodded at his phone. “Turn it on, then.”

He pressed the button and held it up, filming her.

“My name is Janine McNab. I am about to have sex with Mr Bromley, and the decision to do so is my own. He has my permission to have sex with me.” She took a breath and waited until he lowered his phone.

“Thanks. I’m sorry, but I needed to protect myself.”

In other words, he didn’t trust her, either.

Janine noticed that Adam had left a condom on the bedside cabinet. He must have bought it especially for the occasion, because they hadn’t used them in years. She reached over for it. “Well, speaking of protecting yourself...” She dropped the foil square on the bed between her feet. “You’re going to need to wear this.”

Bromley bent forward to pick it up. “Ah yes.” He looked into Janine’s eyes for a few seconds, then allowed his gaze to wander down her

body.

She felt a rush of adrenaline course through her veins. When his eyes moved back up to her face, she held his gaze and slowly pulled the skirt higher.

He glanced down and licked his lips. Keeping his eyes on her sex, he unfastened his belt and unbuttoned his trousers. With his boxers still covering the bulge of his cock, he used his teeth to rip the foil of the condom wrapper. As he pushed his trousers and shorts down to mid-thigh level, his cock sprung out in front of him.

Janine stared at it; it was huge. Longer than Adam's, and significantly thicker.

His smirk suggested he'd noticed her reaction.

Janine slid her heels up the bed until her legs were bent, then let them fall open invitingly.

Bromley rolled the condom down his cock, the sheer rubber only reaching three quarters of the way down his shaft. Kneeling on the bed between her feet, he placed a hand next to her head. With his other hand he traced a finger through the outer lips of her sex and grinned. "I've brought lube, but I don't think we'll need it today."

She hated herself for being so wet. She turned her head to one side and stared at the wall, reminding herself this was only to clear the debt.

Chuckling at her reaction, he placed the tip of his cock at her entrance and gently moved it through her slick folds, coating it with her juices. Then he pushed slowly inside her.

Janine took a sharp intake of breath as she felt herself stretching to accommodate the dome of his cock. It was thicker than anything she'd had before. She gritted her teeth, but didn't make any sound.

With a final press it slid all the way in, and her breath escaped her lungs. Holding his upper body above hers on straight arms, he fucked her slowly. His massive cock ploughed in and out of her tight channel, and she could feel every ridge and vein. She closed her eyes and forced herself not to move with him, not wanting him to see her enjoying it.

Something inside her head kept nagging at her about the video he'd just made; he could show it to everyone he met and they'd all know Janine

had become a whore.

Bromley moved faster, pushed a little further into her, the tip of his cock prodding her cervix. His breathing had changed: gotten ragged and heavy.

Janine opened her eyes and turned her head to look directly into his face. He was getting close, and she'd managed to stay detached. She kept her face blank as she stared into his blue eyes.

His lips pulled back, his lashes fluttered and as he gave a final thrust, he grunted.

She resisted the impulse to roll her hips and clench to milk him dry because if she did she'd probably come, and she didn't want that to happen. For all of her fantasising about being used, Janine had been determined to stay aloof; to let him use her for his pleasure, not hers. But she knew she'd relive what had just happened when alone in bed, and that would be when she'd allow herself to come.

He held the condom on his cock as he withdrew.

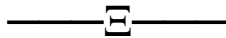
Janine pushed her skirt down her legs and twisted on the bed, getting off at the side to avoid standing next to him. She straightened her clothes and finger-combed her hair.

"Where shall I put this?" Bromley had tied a knot in the condom and dangled it from his fingers. His trousers were already fastened.

Janine looked at it, flooded with the results of his pleasure. She took a tissue from a box on the dressing table and passed it to him. "Wrap it in that, then drop it in the bin there," she said, nodding towards the waste bin in the corner.

After Bromley had disposed of the condom, Janine opened the door and stood back so he could walk out before her.

Ψ



Chapter Four

Janine kept her eyes cast to the floor as she followed Bromley into the living room. In her peripheral vision she saw Adam stand up from the couch.

He cleared his throat as he approached them. “Everything okay?”

She thought it a stupid question. Was he asking if she’d performed her duty satisfactorily for the price paid? As if Bromley could answer with her in the room...

With the silence persisting, she looked up. Both men were staring at her, and she realised Adam had been talking to her when he’d asked if everything was okay.

“Yeah, fine.”

Janine suddenly worried that the men would shake hands in a mission accomplished gesture, but Adam simply opened the door.

At the threshold, Bromley turned to Adam. “Right, see you next month.” Then he looked directly at Janine and nodded a farewell.

She half-smiled then looked back at the floor.

Adam closed the door and the pair of them stood in awkward silence for about ten seconds. Thankfully, he didn't approach and try to cuddle her.

Finally, she looked up at him and inclined her head towards the bathroom. "I'm going for a shower, then maybe we could drive out of the city and walk in the country somewhere?"

He looked surprised but then nodded. "Yeah, that'd be good."

Janine walked into the bedroom, quickly removed her clothes and pulled on her robe. By the time she reached the bathroom, Adam was watching TV from the sofa. She locked the door and turned on the shower over the bath. Then she dropped her robe and regarded herself in the mirror; her cheeks were a little flushed, and her nipples were dark and extended.

She stepped into the shower, let the water soak her hair and stream down her face. With eyes squeezed shut, Janine thought about the implications of what had just occurred. She'd achieved a financial gain by allowing a stranger access to her body. She'd been fucked for money. What would her friends say? Or her parents?

More importantly, what must have been going through Adam's mind while she and Bromley were in the bedroom? What had he thought about while another man fucked her?

For some strange reason, she wondered if Davy, the casino barman, knew about her arrangement with Bromley. As if that mattered.

She'd begun to wash herself on autopilot. Her hands were lathered with shower gel and she slowly massaged her breasts, dragging her thumbs over the nipples. A shiver ran down her spine. Keeping her eyes closed, she pinched and tugged at the taut buttons while her mind replayed the image of Bromley rolling the rubber onto his cock. Onto that big, thick cock which he'd then brought close...

Janine moved one hand slowly down over her stomach, knowing what she was about to do, what her body needed her to do. Her labia were swollen: puffy, engorged and ultra-sensitive. She slipped her middle finger between the lips of her sex and her breath caught. Bromley's cock had parted these as it pressed inside, pushed them wider than they'd ever been before.

Her legs trembled with excitement, with need. She added her first and third fingers and pushed them a little further, then rested her palm against her mons. Janine dropped her head back so that the water sprayed directly into her face. She rocked her hand slowly. The first contact of her wet palm gliding over her clit triggered the orgasm, sending sparks of pleasure up and down her spine. Her entire body twitched and she opened her mouth in a silent scream of ecstasy. Water filled her mouth, ran out over her lower lip. She stabbed her hand in and out like a frenzied murderess, finger-fucking herself roughly, prolonging her pleasure by setting off aftershocks deep inside her core. Her legs threatened to collapse so she gripped the vertical chrome bar supporting the showerhead.

Turning her head out of the spray, she took a deep breath and remembered the feeling of his cock sliding all the way inside her, filling her completely. She slid her fingers out and placed one either side of her clit, then rocked her hand to and fro. Another orgasm crashed through her. This time she couldn't prevent the moan from escaping her lips as she dropped onto her knees in the bath. Her hand seemed to have a mind of its own and wouldn't stop probing and flicking at her sex, activating further explosions of delight throughout her body.

As the water cascaded down onto her back, Janine finally withdrew her hand. She felt guilty for masturbating while thinking about Bromley using her, but she'd been desperate for release.

When the strength returned to her legs, she turned off the shower and climbed out of the bath. She dried herself and dressed in the bedroom. After quickly drying her hair, she pulled on socks and ankle boots and went to the living room.

Adam looked up and smiled. "You look nice."

"Thanks. Shall we go?" She avoided looking directly into his face, unsure if it was because of what she'd done with Bromley or what she'd done in the shower afterwards.

They travelled in relative silence, Adam driving and Janine looking out of the window. She could sense him glancing at her every few minutes.

"So, was it okay?"

She took a deep breath and let it out slowly. She turned to face him. “I know you’ve probably got a hundred questions, but there’s not much to tell.”

He nodded and kept his eyes on the road.

She sighed. “I lay on the bed and both of us kept our clothes on. I lifted my skirt, he undid his trousers. He put on the condom you provided, then he got on top of me. I stared at the bedroom wall until he’d finished.”

There was a short silence while he digested the information.

“Did you come?” His voice cracked a little.

“No, Adam, I didn’t come.”

He nodded and they finished the journey in silence.

His final question amplified her guilt about masturbating in the shower.

For the following two and a half hours, they walked around moorlands, where more than fifty years earlier, two very evil people had murdered and buried innocent children. Janine knew she wasn’t evil but had to concede she wasn’t innocent, either.

They stopped at a pub for dinner on the drive back from Saddleworth Moor, and Adam didn’t mention Bromley or what had occurred earlier that day. Instead, he revealed that Barney, his boss at the factory, had broached the subject of him doing some further education.

“What, like night school?”

Adam shook his head. “They’re looking into me doing it day-release, one day a week.”

Janine had left school at sixteen and knew nothing about higher education. “Would you want to do that? I remember your mum telling me you hadn’t wanted to go to uni.”

He laughed. “I wanted to be earning money, not spending another three years in a classroom to come out with a certificate and a debt of about thirty grand. But Barney reckons it’d look good on my assessment form when they’re considering people in the workshop for promotion to a supervising role.”

“That’d be fantastic.”

“Yeah...” Adam’s shrugged. “The extra money’d be nice, but it’s not going to happen anytime soon. So I guess I’ll be carrying on with the taxi-driving for the foreseeable.”

“It’s only for a few more months.” She tried to sound upbeat.

“Yeah, I know. How about the extra cuts and stuff you’ve been doing? Got any more lined up?”

She frowned. “I’ve done most of my mates, now. They won’t need me again for another few weeks, so I’ve told them to spread the word to anyone else who might want me.”

“Can’t you get some of the clients from work? Tell them you’ll do it cheaper than they have to pay in the salon.”

“No chance. If I got caught doing that I’d be out on my arse, and I can’t risk losing my job.”

Adam nodded and picked up his drink again. “Yeah, you’re right.” He checked his watch. “Shall we get off? It’ll take us a while to get home.”

Janine finished her drink and they left.

Once home, Janine needed to iron herself something to wear next day. Adam headed off to bed and was reading something on his phone when she came through ten minutes later. He closed down his phone, leaned over to connect the charger cord, then turned and watched her undress. She left on her panties and took a vest top from a drawer, slipping it over her head.

Getting into bed, Janine turned to face him. “Please don’t ask for sex tonight, Adam. Not so soon after, you know...”

He didn’t bother hiding his disappointment, just nodded his understanding and turned off the bedside lamp.

Janine lay for ages in the dark thinking about what had happened on this bed twelve hours earlier, and also what she’d done afterwards. She wriggled on the wrinkly sheets, unable to get comfortable. Instead of playing with herself in the shower, perhaps she should have spent the time washing the bedclothes before she and Adam had to sleep in them.

* * * *

The following week, Adam did the evening shifts in the taxi on Wednesday and Friday. Janine hadn't got any bookings from private clients, but volunteered to cover for Eloise for the late shift on Thursday.

On Saturday Adam had prepared a casserole while Janine had been at work, and they'd chatted while they ate in the evening. Afterwards they watched TV and opened a bottle of wine. She suspected this was his not-too-subtle attempt at wooing her. They hadn't had sex all week, and Janine felt a stab of guilt because she'd pleased herself with her vibrator on both evenings he'd been driving the taxi. Tonight, she decided, she'd let him have what he wanted—providing he didn't do something idiotic to put her off.

After the programme finished, Janine suggested an early night. By the time she'd finished in the bathroom, Adam had got into bed; evidently his teeth didn't need brushing.

She stripped naked and slid into bed, then turned off the light. Adam ran his hand over her stomach, and she reached out for him. Instantly he moved closer, pushing the quilt down and fondling her breasts. He bent his head and took one of her nipples into his mouth. She sighed and arched her back, trying to get in the mood.

Adam started to move further down the bed, but she pulled him back up.

“No, not that.” She reached down to his cock, stroked it. “I want this. Just fuck me.”

Adam hesitated for less than a second, then climbed on top and fed himself inside her. He fucked her slowly, and Janine held his hips and let out quiet sighs with each thrust. The speed and force of his thrusts soon increased, and with a final grunt he pushed deep and held still.

Janine clenched and rocked her hips as his cock twitched and pulsed inside her. She heard him let out a grateful sigh, then he rolled off onto his side of the bed.

They lay in silence for a few seconds, then he reached over and stroked her arm. “You didn't come.”

Unsure of how to answer, she squeezed his hand.

“Do you want me to—?”

“No, I’m fine. I enjoyed it, and I don’t need to come every time.”
She tried to keep her voice light and casual.

“Is it because of what happened with Bromley?”

“No. Why should that have anything to do with it?”

He stroked her stomach. “I don’t know. But you usually come when we...you know.”

“Yeah, well you usually last a lot longer than you did tonight.”

“Oh.”

“Adam, we’ve just made love and it was nice. Let’s not spoil it by analysing all the ins and outs.”

He chuckled. “Ins and outs—yeah, I like it.”

She pushed him onto his back and rested her head on his shoulder.
“Let’s get some sleep.”

* * * *

Over the following weeks, Janine’s friends recommended her to several more private clients and Adam continued with the taxi driving. By the end of the month, they had saved £940. Adam announced that Bromley had been in touch to say he’d call round on Saturday at 12.

Janine’s heart began to race, but she kept her expression neutral and looked down at the floor.

He reached out for her hand. “Just three more times after this one.”

She nodded.

Adam worked the late shift on the Friday evening before Bromley’s visit, so Janine took the opportunity to have a bath and shave her legs. She also painted her toenails with the colour she affectionately thought of as slut red. She kept telling herself these things weren’t for Bromley’s benefit, but her own. She wanted to feel nice, and he probably wouldn’t even notice. She went to bed early and even though she had butterflies in her stomach and a warm glow further down, she resisted the temptation to touch herself.

In the morning she and Adam chatted in bed for a while, then Janine decided she’d go to the gym rather than sit around the flat. She dressed in

black cycling shorts, a reinforced pink crop-top, sports socks and trainers. She pulled on a loose-fitting t-shirt and tied her hair back.

When she came out of the bedroom, Adam was making himself breakfast. She filled her water-bottle and picked up the car keys. "Right, I'll get off."

He looked up from buttering toast. "Okay."

"I'll shower when I get home, then get dressed before..."

Adam just nodded.

Janine left the flat and drove the three miles to the gym. She did a few stretches then started her workout with twenty minutes on the exercise bike. She spent a similar amount of time on the rowing machine before doing three sets of ten reps of leg presses and lateral pull-downs. She paused while she took a drink, then finished her session with twenty minutes on the treadmill. By the time she'd finished, her t-shirt had become soaked with sweat and clung to her back.

She checked her watch; she had fifty minutes to drive home, shower and dress. As she made her way through the busy Saturday morning traffic, her mind ran through the options for what to wear. Another skirt and top would be easiest, as Bromley seemed happy for her to just hoist up her skirt and spread her legs. The traffic was worse than she'd expected, and by the time she parked in her space at the back of their apartment building, she had less than twenty-five minutes to get ready.

After taking her phone from the glovebox, Janine ran up the stairs as fast as her tired legs could manage. She flung open their apartment door and stopped dead in her tracks.

Bromley sat next to Adam on their couch.

She stood stock-still, very conscious of her appearance. "I thought..." She looked at her watch, then at Adam. "You said twelve o'clock."

Bromley answered. "It's my fault. I got told at short notice about a meeting I have to attend this afternoon, so I texted to say I'd be here an hour early."

Janine looked back at Adam, trying desperately not to cry.

He shrugged. "I texted and left a voicemail for you."

She shook her head. “I left my phone in the car.” She turned it over in her hand and touched the screen for the first time since she’d left the gym; there were numerous messages and alerts about missed calls.

She looked at Bromley, then down at herself. “I’m sorry, I’ll—”

“You look fine.” He got to his feet.

“But...I need a shower.”

Bromley walked towards the bedroom. “The shower can wait, but my meeting can’t.”

Adam stood and passed her a condom from his pocket.

She sighed, took a breath and followed Bromley into the bedroom, closing the door behind her. She caught a glimpse of her reflection in the mirrored door of the wardrobe. Her t-shirt had dark sweat patches all over it, her face was flushed and her damp hair stuck to her forehead.

She turned to Bromley. “I’m sorry I didn’t get back sooner. I’m...” She held out her hands to emphasise what a mess she looked.

“Take off your t-shirt.” His voice was quiet but carried authority.

Janine obeyed him, dropping the damp garment on the floor. She looked down at herself and closed her eyes with embarrassment when she saw the wet sweat-marks around the waistband of her shorts.

“Lie on the bed, Janine.”

She looked at him, then did as told.

Bromley bent and gripped the waistband of her shorts and panties, pulling both garments all the way down her legs to her ankles and over her feet. She couldn’t believe he’d left her trainers on—so much for painting her toenails.

Janine lay fully exposed from her navel to her ankles, her discomfort heightened because she could smell her own body odour. She took a deep breath and tried to calm herself, exhaling slowly. This wasn’t how she’d imaged the second time would be.

He held out his hand and it took her a couple of seconds to realise he was requesting the condom clutched between her finger and thumb. Passing it to him, she glanced down at her body. Even in sports socks and trainers

her legs and hips looked good, with well-defined muscle-tone and a healthy glow to her skin. She parted her legs.

Standing at the foot of the bed, Bromley glanced down at her body, his expression one of hunger.

The sound of his zipper being pulled down focused Janine's mind. She stopped worrying about how she looked and smelled, and instead thought about what was about to happen. She watched as he took out his cock—already swollen and hard—and rolled the gossamer-thin sheath of rubber down its length.

He knelt on the bed, and she opened her legs wider for him. As he reached down to guide his cock to her entrance, she raised her bum off the bed. He hesitated and held eye contact for a second before pushing into her.

She gritted her teeth and sucked in a breath as she felt herself stretch around the dome, then she let out a long slow breath as he pushed all the way in. Luckily she'd become wet enough, despite the less-than-perfect preparation.

Bromley pulled almost all the way out then pushed back in, over and over with a slow, gentle rhythm. He fucked her like he wanted to make it last. Last time it felt like he'd just used her hole to get himself off, which was okay with her. Tender, considerate sex hadn't been part of the deal and wasn't what she wanted. Not from a stranger who paid for her body.

Janine closed her eyes and tried to find somewhere inside her mind to hide, but all she could concentrate on was the thick chunk of meat sliding in and out of her. She could feel her inner walls sheathing his shaft, stretched to their limit by its girth. Her labia clung tight when he pulled back, as if reluctant to let him go, only to have him push back through their slickness and sink into the depths of her body. She realised that if he didn't come soon, she probably would.

“Janine.”

She opened her eyes and looked up at him. Bromley supported himself on straight arms while slowly pumping his hips.

He nodded at her crop top. “Lift that up.”

She swallowed and, while holding eye contact, used both hands to slowly pull up the Lycra top and reveal her breasts.

His hungry gaze took them in.

She'd always been happy with her boobs. They weren't particularly big but they were pert and firm, with small areolas around the nipples.

Bromley lowered himself down onto his forearms. Janine looked down to see him moving his hand over her breast. He cupped it gently for a couple of seconds before moving his finger and thumb to her nipple. When he pinched, Janine let out an involuntary whimper.

"You're allowed to enjoy this too, you know." He had a half-smile on his face.

Janine stared into his eyes, shook her head.

He pushed a little harder, grinding his pubic bone against her clit.

She frowned, angry at her body for betraying her. Her orgasm built with each thrust, until she was on the crest of a wave with no way to prevent it from breaking. She didn't want him to make her come, didn't want him to see her at her most vulnerable.

He narrowed his eyes as if negotiating a deal. "I'll come if you will."

She shook her head again, but every message her brain sent south was being ignored; her body was in control. While her mind demanded detachment and indifference, her flesh craved release and fulfilment.

Janine slipped over the edge and the climax surged through her. She stifled a moan, thinking of Adam in the next room. Gazing into Bromley's eyes, she felt the contractions ripple through her body.

Bromley let out a low groan and his eyes rolled back in his head. His cock swelled and twitched, and he took a series of short, sharp breaths.

She gripped his buttocks and writhed beneath him, rocking herself on his cock, milking him. He grunted his appreciation and pushed in harder with each spasm, but it hadn't been solely for his benefit; she was building up to her second orgasm. She screwed her eyes shut and gritted her teeth, willing herself not to cry out as she came again. Fireworks exploded behind her eyelids and jolts like electric shocks raced through her limbs. She dug her fingernails into the flesh of his buttocks and held her breath as the final spasms reverberated through her body.

Bromley withdrew and knelt up between her legs, taking deep gulps of air, his shirt twisted and creased. The cum-filled rubber hung from his flaccid cock. Climbing off the bed, he helped himself to a tissue and disposed of the condom in the same bin as before.

While he fastened his trousers and straightened his shirt, Janine moved her top back down over her boobs and sat up on the bed. Her legs were still shaking as she stood and got one of Adam's shirts from the wardrobe.

"Are you alright?" He sounded concerned.

Janine looked up at him and her eyes filled. She nodded, then shrugged. "I didn't want..." She couldn't explain how she felt, even to herself. She blinked the tears away and forced a smile. "I'm fine."

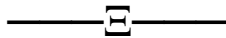
He watched her face for a few seconds then nodded. "Good. I'll see you in a month." He turned and left the bedroom.

This time she didn't follow him. She heard a brief exchange and then the apartment door open and close.

Adam walked into the bedroom a few seconds later. He smirked when he saw her feet. "You fucked him in your trainers?"

Her anger flared at his insensitivity and his stupid smirk. "Yes Adam, I fucked him in my trainers." She pushed past him but turned before leaving the room. "He's not interested in my feet, just my cunt." She stomped to the bathroom, slamming and locking the door behind her.

Ψ



Chapter Five

Janine stayed in the bath for over an hour, adding extra hot water every fifteen minutes or so. Adam's stupid remark about her trainers annoyed her, but it'd also had an upside: she no longer felt guilty about reaching climax while having sex with Bromley.

A sharp knock on the door made her jump.

"Are you going to be in there all afternoon? I need a piss."

Twat! She let out a frustrated sigh and climbed out of the bath. Still dripping-wet, she walked naked to the bedroom and grabbed a fresh, clean towel.

Adam used the loo then came to find her as she dressed. "I didn't mean to upset you."

"Well, you did."

"I was just trying to make light of—"

"Make light of what, Adam?" She glared at him. "The fact that I'd had to reveal my perspiring body to a stranger? To lie on my back knowing the room stank of my sweaty crotch while he looked down at me?"

Adam paused, open-mouthed.

Janine wasn't letting it go just yet. "And there's something else you might want to think about." She hopped on one foot, pulling on a pair of jeans. "Do you really think Bromley's happy to pay that amount of money for a woman whose body smells?"

Adam walked to the bin, picked up the knotted condom and dangled it from his thumb and finger, swinging the cum-filled rubber slowly from side to side. "He still managed to shoot his load with you, sweaty or not." Adam raised his arm until the condom was at eye level, examining it. "In fact, I think he produced more this time than he did last month."

Janine was too stunned to answer. She'd forgotten to empty the bin after the first time, and Adam had obviously found the other condom. She buttoned her jeans, then pulled on a t-shirt. "I felt awful, and didn't need you making fun of me."

He dropped the condom back in the bin. "It was him who changed the time. I think you're worrying unnecessarily. Bromley seemed very happy when he left."

"It's about how I felt, can't you see that?"

He nodded, his expression becoming friendlier. "Yeah, sorry."

"It was embarrassing being seen like that."

Adam raised his eyebrows. "Well, you're clean now..."

She scowled. "I hope you're not suggesting what I think you are."

He shrugged, the corners of his mouth twitching into a hopeful smile. "I'm a bit horny."

"Fuck off!" Janine pushed past him and stomped into the living room. "You are so fucking selfish."

"What? What have I done now?"

She hesitated, suddenly puzzled. "How can you be in the mood for sex?"

"Huh?"

"Doesn't it bother you at all that I've just had sex with somebody else?"

He shrugged. "We decided to do it a while ago. It was a joint decision."

Janine shook her head. "You're missing the point. I expect most men would feel wounded, and maybe a little embarrassed that it'd come to this. But no... You get turned on."

Adam looked down at the floor. Mumbled something inaudible.

"Pardon?"

He raised his head, met her gaze. "I said, I thought it'd cheer you up."

Janine laughed sarcastically. "What would cheer me up," she used finger-quotes just to piss him off, "would be to have a partner who didn't pimp me out and then expect me to spread my legs for him an hour later."

"Fine. I was only trying to help."

"Yeah, thanks for that." She grabbed her coat and walked to the apartment door. "I'm going to get some fresh air, because this place stinks of my sweaty twat and Bromley's aftershave. Feel free to jerk yourself off if those smells turn you on." Slamming the door behind her, she walked down the stairs and out of the building.

Janine walked the towpath route she'd become so familiar with over the last couple of months. The day was cool and there were few people walking around, or sitting outside the various cafés and bars along the route. Even though she hadn't eaten all day, she was too wound up to contemplate food. She marched on past the eateries, thinking about her latest row with Adam, and what had triggered it.

If he'd annoyed her with his comment about her trainers, it was nothing compared to him expecting sex straight after Bromley had left. How could he possibly be turned on at a time like that? Was there more to him agreeing to Bromley's suggestion than just money?

She stopped walking; what effect would it have on Adam if he knew she came with Bromley? Would it hurt him, or turn him on? It might actually turn him on. why else would he insist on hanging around the flat while the 'arrangement' was taking place? A shudder ran through her.

She looked around and, realising she'd never been this far before, turned to head back. By the time she got back to familiar territory she was

hungry, and decided to treat herself to a late lunch. Choosing a small Italian bistro with a green and white striped awning, she found a table inside and ordered vegetarian lasagne and a glass of wine.

Janine got back home over three hours after she'd stormed out. The apartment was dark and empty, and she saw a hand-scribbled note on the coffee table. She took three quick strides, snatched it up and quickly read it. As Adam's words sank in, Janine found herself unable to decide if she was relieved or disappointed. He'd been asked to fill in for another taxi-driver who'd phoned in sick.

She spent the evening watching TV and went to bed alone a little after eleven.

* * * *

Over the next week Janine and Adam spent very little time together. Janine had a private client on Monday and worked a late shift at the salon on Thursday. Adam drove taxi shifts on Tuesday and Friday evenings, and his day-release course began on Wednesday. When she'd asked about his course, he'd given short answers, rather than elaborate like usual. She'd expected him to tell her about the other students, the lecturers, and throw in jokes. Instead, he just said he was one of about twenty students and the lecturers seemed okay.

Janine wondered if his attitude toward her was because she'd shouted at him over the remark about her trainers, or because she'd refused him sex when she'd got out of the bath. Either way, she certainly had no intention of being the one to make all the effort to rebuild bridges. There was no cuddling on the couch, no touches or kisses as they worked in the kitchenette, and no contact whatsoever when they were in bed.

The following weeks were exactly the same. As the leaves started falling from the trees and the nights drew in, Janine couldn't help thinking that her relationship with Adam had also moved into a kind of autumn. What had once felt bright and vibrant was now dull and faded. Branches once full of her hopes and dreams, now stood bare in the cold grey

surroundings of their life. She could probably rekindle the flame if she tried, but wasn't sure she wanted to bother.

As had become their habit, on the last Friday evening of the month they counted the money they'd saved up.

He looked up at her as he added the last ten pound note to the little pile on the counter in the kitchenette. "Nine-hundred and ninety pounds."

Janine walked to her purse and took out ten pounds. "Add this to make it a nice round thousand."

He added it to the pile, then put all the cash into an envelope. "I'll take it over in the morning while you're at work."

She nodded, knowing Bromley would tell Adam when he'd call round for the interest payment. A shiver ran through her.

When Janine arrived home from work the following day, she found a note from Adam explaining three taxis had been booked to pick up a group of men from a race meeting at Haydock Park. After he'd dropped the men off, it'd be time to start his regular late Saturday night shift. He'd added a postscript to the note: Bromley would be round in the morning, at eleven.

Soon after she'd eaten, Janine lay in the bath with a glass of wine in her hand and the bottle within reach. She luxuriated in the hot scented water for more than hour, then shaved her legs and underarms. Wearing just her robe, she headed back to the lounge, painted her toenails and finished the wine while watching TV.

On Sunday morning Janine crept out of bed without waking Adam. She sipped orange juice and read the news on her phone. Bromley would arrive in a little over two hours, and there was a tingle of anticipation in her stomach, and a warm pool of excitement between her legs.

Adam wandered through from the bedroom shortly before ten, looking tired and miserable.

Janine tried to be pleasant. "Morning."

He nodded.

"D'you want a coffee?"

“No thanks.” He opened the fridge and surveyed the contents, then closed it with a grunt.

“What are you looking for?”

He shrugged. “I’m hungry, but there’s not much in.”

“Why don’t you go out for breakfast?”

He checked his watch. “I doubt I’ll have time before... you know.” He shrugged his shoulders and nodded his head in the direction of the bedroom.

Janine tilted her head to one side. “Adam, you don’t need to be here when Bromley visits.”

He looked surprised. “I thought it’d make you feel—”

“No. It makes it even harder for me, knowing you’re sitting out here.”

He was silent for a few seconds.

“Adam, why don’t you go for a walk down by the canal and have a cooked breakfast in one of those little cafés? I’m sure you’d enjoy that more than sitting in here...”

He nodded, then went to get ready. A few minutes later he was washed and dressed, standing by the front door. “Right, I’ll see you after... later.”

“If you want, I could phone you when he’s gone and walk down to meet you. Maybe we could go for a walk and have a drink?”

“Yeah, okay.”

After he’d left the flat, Janine let out a long sigh of relief. She quickly tidied the bedroom and opened the window. Next she washed her face, brushed her teeth and hair, and applied a little lipstick and mascara, determined to look a damn sight better than last time Bromley had visited. She’d already decided to wear the denim dress she liked. It was soft and faded, knee-length with a fitted waist and buttons down the front. She didn’t bother putting on shoes.

When Bromley hit the intercom she buzzed him up and opened the flat door. A minute later he walked in, wearing a pale blue shirt and black jeans.

He smiled at Janine and looked around the flat, expectantly.

“Adam’s out.” She held his gaze for a second, closed the front door and walked into the bedroom.

As he followed her in, he closed the door behind him.

Janine turned and looked into his blue eyes. Without saying a word, she began to undo the buttons of her dress.

Bromley’s eyes swept down her body.

Without shoes, she felt tiny beside him—a foot shorter, and a fraction of his width. After undoing the final button, she pushed her dress back off her shoulders. She was naked beneath.

His mouth dropped open.

She took two slow steps until she stood right in front of him and reached for the top button of his shirt.

He took his phone out of his pocket.

Janine smiled. “Are you going to film me again?”

“No, I don’t think I need to do that. But I would like your mobile number, so I can contact you directly without having to go through your boyfriend.”

“Oh, I see. Well, it’s 0-7-7-5-3...” She recited the rest of her number as she opened the remaining buttons of his shirt.

When he’d added the number to his contacts he put his phone back into his pocket, slipped his shirt off and dropped it to the floor.

Janine ran her hands through the fair hair on his wide chest. Then she sat on the bed and reached out for his belt. He watched as she undid the buckle and the buttons of his trousers.

She pulled his trousers down to his knees and ran her hand slowly up his leg until it reached his boxers. She stroked her hand over the huge bulge in the cotton, tracing her fingers slowly along the length of his erection. When she pulled the shorts down his cock sprung out, released in all its glory. Janine wrapped her hand around it, marvelling at its girth as she pumped her hand, moving his skin up and down the shaft. A tear of clear precum appeared at the slit on his cockhead.

“When I first saw this...” She wanked him slowly, keeping her eyes fixed on his cock as she spoke. “I didn’t think it was going to fit.”

He chuckled.

Looking up into his face, she licked her lips. “I guess I’m bigger down there than I thought.”

Bromley shook his head. “You’re not big, just... expandable.”

“Expandable.” She nodded as she considered the description, using the forefinger of her other hand to smear the precum all over his cockhead. She heard him take a sharp breath.

He cleared his throat. “Janine, I’m going to fuck you now, so you’d better pass me a condom.”

She kept her finger moving in circles on his cockhead and held his gaze for a few seconds. “Hmm, a condom...” Releasing his cock and holding eye contact, she brought her hand to her mouth and sucked her finger. “Not this time.” She wanted to feel his cock without the rubber, feel his warm flesh pushing tightly into her own.

He grinned. “Well, I suppose now that we’re going steady...”

Janine lay back, propping herself up on her elbows, her bent knees hanging over the edge of the bed.

Bromley quickly stripped and leaned his knees against the bed between her legs, his feet still on the floor.

She watched as he moved his cock towards her sex. Her heart raced and her juices pooled inside her.

His hand gripped his shaft and he slipped the cockhead between her slick outer lips, coating the glans with her juices. He pushed his hips forward but allowed his cock to slide up through her folds and over her mons, the lower side of his shaft sliding over her clit.

Janine let out a groan, half-disappointment and half-anticipation. She looked down and watched as he repeated the sequence; saw him nestle the dome between her lips then slide up and over, the big purple head of his cock appearing over the curve of her pubis like a whale breaching out of the water. She bit her bottom lip and began pumping her hips, impatient for him to enter her.

A grin creased his face and he lifted his cock up, slapped it down like a truncheon onto her pubic mound. He did it again, the impact making a dull, wet thud. Tingles rippled outwards from her clit, filling her with warmth.

Janine placed her hands on the sides of her breasts and pushed them together, squeezing her nipples as she did so. "Well if you're going to play with yourself, I suppose I may as well do the same..."

Bromley chuckled and shook his head. Positioning his cock at her entrance, he pushed all the way in with a single lunge.

"Ohhhh..." She dropped her head back and released her breasts, her fists gripping the sheet beneath her.

His second thrust made her cry out again, even louder.

She wrapped her legs around his, her heels pulling the back of his thighs towards her as he pushed into her again. She reached up for him, scratching her nails down his upper arms as he slowly fucked her.

He lifted her legs and held them upright so they rested on his shoulders, then pulled her to the edge of the bed to give himself better access.

Janine stared up into his face. He was going so deep that she could feel his balls slapping against her. She arched her back, willing him to push in further, to hurt her.

Bromley rested his hand flat on her stomach and pushed down, forcing her insides down onto his cock. He smiled at her reaction, moved his hand lower and slid his thumb over her clit.

An orgasm shot through her and she screamed with the release, digging her nails into his forearms as she writhed and quivered beneath his onslaught. Suddenly, she became too sensitive to be touched down there and placed her palms on his stomach and pushed him out of her, taking in huge gulps of air as she slowly opened her eyes.

He looked down at her with a confident grin. "I see I didn't have to coax that one out of you."

She took another couple of deep breaths and pushed her hair from her face. "Shut up and lie on your back."

His eyebrows shot up, but the amusement remained in his eyes.

Janine moved to one side while he positioned himself in the middle of the bed. This was the first time they'd both been completely naked together. She straddled his legs and bent forward, her hair hanging down and dragging against his stomach. She wrapped her hand around his shaft. Her fingers looked tiny. She began to slowly pump her hand with a twisting motion. She watched his cock for a few seconds, then looked up into his eyes while continuing to pump her hand. Slowly, with her eyes still locked on his, she lowered her head and took the end of his cock into her mouth.

He let out a long sigh and reached down to move her hair to one side.

Janine closed her eyes and concentrated on sucking him, moving her tongue around the tip and under the ridge. She released it and ran her mouth down the shaft, licking and kissing the entire length to the base. There was no way she could get him all into her mouth, and she didn't want to embarrass herself by trying. Besides, she had other plans...

She held his cock upright as she knee-walked further up his body until she straddled his hips. Raising herself up, she positioned him at her entrance and slowly lowered onto him, impaling herself. She felt more filled than she'd ever been; it was bordering on being too painful. She reached forward, gripped the wooden frame of the headboard and began to slowly lift herself up and down, riding his cock.

Bromley pushed his hips up and she squealed in surprise.

She opened her eyes and frowned at him. "You're too big..."

Placing his hands on her hips, he pulled her down onto him. "It feels like a perfect fit to me."

With her eyes half-closed, Janine gripped the headboard and rocked her hips, savouring the feelings. It felt so much better without the rubber sheath: hotter, and easier to slide up and down. He was going to flood her, and she wanted it; having a man come inside her was the ultimate intimacy.

Bromley raised his head off the pillow and put his mouth to her breast, sucking and nibbling at the hardened flesh of her nipple.

Letting out another groan, Janine bucked her hips faster; a second orgasm was building. Her breathing became ragged and she squeezed her eyes shut. Fireworks exploded in her lower belly and she cried out. She

pushed herself upright and ground her hips against him, her chin on her chest and her hair hanging down.

When the spasms finally receded, she opened her eyes.

He had perspiration on his forehead, which seemed strange because she'd been doing all the hard work. He didn't need to speak—his expression told her that he needed to come.

She lay down so her breasts crushed against his chest, her nose touching his. "Okay, now it's your turn. Do you want to get back on top?"

He gripped her waist and pushed her down his body as he thrust up into her.

"Ow."

"You like that?" He did it again.

She frowned, took a breath and nodded. "Yeah."

He gritted his teeth and started to push up into her while forcing her body down to meet his thrusts, moving her as if she were a ragdoll. "You like that?"

Janine struggled to speak, the onslaught almost too much to bear. If there was a line between pleasure and pain, she wasn't sure which side she was on. Maybe she had one foot either side... "Fuck me."

His lips pulled back, making it appear like he was snarling. "I'm going to come."

"Good."

He moved her body roughly, pushed himself into her harder. "You want that?"

She smiled. "Yeah, I want that. I want to feel you to come in me."

"Oh, you dirty little—"

Janine bit down into his shoulder and he cried out.

His fingers dug into her hips and he held her still. He grunted and sighed.

She felt his cock swell and throb, knew he was coming. Wriggling and clenching, she welcomed his gift, receiving more from him with each muscle contraction. She released her teeth from his shoulder and nuzzled his ear, whispered, "Yeah, that's it, let it all go."

“Oh, fuck...” His eyes were squeezed shut and he was taking deep breaths through clenched teeth. He pushed his hips up three, four more times as he emptied into her.

Janine continued to rotate her hips, reaching down to scrape her nails up the outsides of his thighs. “Mmm, better now?”

Opening his eyes, he chuckled and shook his head. “Jesus! I can’t remember the last time I was fucked like that.”

Janine felt both embarrassed and flattered. Had she gone too far? “Well, I...I thought...” She shrugged. “I’m sorry.”

He stroked her back. “No, don’t be sorry. Don’t you dare be sorry.”

She lay her head down onto his chest and thought about what had just happened. Bromley was right. This hadn’t been a case of her allowing a man to take what he wanted, she’d fucked him. Janine had taken what she wanted; she’d used his body.

“Are you okay?” He sounded concerned.

She sat up, his cock now depleted but still inside her. She shrugged. “I thought I should try and give you value for your money.”

“Well, you certainly did that.”

Looking around her bedroom, she sighed. “It’d be easier if we weren’t here.”

He raised his eyebrows. “If you’re being so... ‘forthcoming’ because your boyfriend’s not around, next time we’ll go to a hotel.”

Janine smiled. “I’d like that.”

When his cum started to escape from her, she climbed off him and took a tissue from the box at the side of the bed. Bromley stood and began to get dressed. Janine pulled on a pair of panties and pushed a tissue down into the gusset and slipped on her robe.

He opened the door and stood back to allow her to go first. She walked out of the bedroom and stopped in her tracks, her heart banging in her chest.

Adam scowled at her from the couch, his eyes cold.

Bromley hesitated for a few seconds before letting himself out of the flat.

Janine returned his cold stare. “I thought you were still having breakfast.”

“Obviously.”

She didn’t answer. Bromley’s cum was still leaking out of her, soaking into the tissue inside her panties. The thought of it made her feel good. She wasn’t about to apologise for what she’d just done.

“It sounded like you did a little more than stare at the wall this time.” It wasn’t a casual observation, but an accusation.

“If you want to take my place next time, that’s fine with me.”

He scoffed. “Well, at least I’d get to have sex.”

She narrowed her eyes as her anger boiled over. “Yeah, well you’d better buy yourself some lube because his cock is enormous.”

Adam stood up. “Maybe I should save up and buy a session with you myself.”

Janine’s mouth dropped open and she glowered at him, her eyes watering with hurt. “I cannot believe you just said that.” She couldn’t prevent the tears brimming and running down her cheeks. “Get out.”

“Jani—”

“Get fucking out!”

He jumped, startled by the shouted final word. Moving slowly towards the door, he paused.

Janine wiped her cheeks with the back of her hand. “I told you that you could never use this against me, and you’ve just done exactly that.”

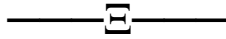
He took a breath but she cut him off by raising her palm.

“Adam, just go. I need some space, okay?”

He nodded and left the flat, his head bowed.

Janine put the dead-lock on from inside and let out a long exhale. Then she walked to the bathroom and started to fill the bath.

Ψ



Chapter Six

Adam texted in the late afternoon to ask permission to return to their flat. Janine replied with a simple Yes, and waited on the sofa with the TV on for background noise. Her anger had faded to the dull acceptance of a relationship damaged beyond repair.

As soon as their debt was cleared, she would leave Adam.

They'd sell the flat and pay back the money her parents had given them toward the deposit. She'd try to find a bedsit, or maybe a room in a shared house.

When Adam walked in ten minutes later, he looked suitably contrite. He dropped into the armchair and let out a heavy sigh. "I'm sorry."

Janine glowered at him. "So you should be. It was an awful thing to say, and the fact you said it shows what a complete twat you've become."

He nodded, then shrugged. "I was just a bit hurt because I—"

"Because you what, Adam? Because you agreed to let somebody else fuck me in order to settle your debt?"

His mouth opened as if to reply, then he shrugged and shook his head.

"What?" Janine could tell he had more to say.

He shook his head. "Nothing."

"There's obviously something, so why not say what's on your mind?" Evidently she hadn't calmed down as much as she'd thought; she

was still in the mood for a fight.

Adam lowered his head and stared at the floor. “I didn’t expect to hear you moaning and groaning like you were making a porn-film.”

She scoffed. “I thought that would be exactly what you wanted to hear. Why else would you sneak back in to listen?”

“I didn’t sneak back—”

“Of course you did. You wanted to hear us fucking. Why else would you come back early? We both know it gives you some kind of thrill and turns you on.”

He shook his head. “I didn’t say it turned—”

“Last month, you expected sex straight after he’d left.”

Adam sat back and sighed in resignation. “Maybe I just want to have sex once in a while.”

“Yeah, well like I’ve said before, you’re welcome to take my place when Bromley comes round next time.”

He sneered. “I don’t think that arrangement would suit me, Bromley or you.”

She wanted to slap him. “No, you’re probably right. Maybe we’ll leave the door open next time, then you can have a wank while you watch us.”

This time it was Adam who was lost for words. His eyebrows shot up and his jaw dropped.

Janine smiled. “See, I can be just as hurtful as you can. That’s what happens when your boyfriend convinces you to become a whore.”

He took a breath. “Okay, whatever. Now, can we please stop arguing?”

Although still angry, she nodded. Her mind was already made up, so there was nothing else to fight for.

Adam stood up. “Do you want anything to eat or drink?”

“No thanks.”

Adam walked to the kitchenette and filled the kettle.

Closing her eyes, Janine lay back and wondered where she’d be this time next year.

* * * *

At work on Wednesday, Janine's phone beeped with the arrival of a text. When she saw the unknown number, her stomach tightened; she had a good idea who it was from.

She quickly finished washing her client's hair and passed the lady a towel. "Wrap this round your head and go and sit there." She pointed to the styling chair facing the mirrored wall. "I'll be back in a sec." Janine took her phone to the small room in the back and opened the text.

'Fancy a night out at the casino one evening this weekend? Let me know if you can make Friday or Saturday. SB'

It took her a while to remember Bromley's first name was Stephen. She wondered if his friends called him Stephen or Steve. Stevie, maybe...? No, none of those seemed to fit—she'd always think of him as Bromley.

She took a moment to remember which night Adam was due to work the late shift, then replied, 'How about Friday?'

His reply was immediate: 'Great. A car will pick you up at 9'

She read his text and squeezed her thighs together. As Janine went back through to the salon, her mind ran through the options of what to wear for her night out.

* * * *

As Adam prepared to leave for his taxi-driving stint, Janine sat on the sofa in leggings and a t-shirt. Her dirty plate from dinner was still on the rug by the side of the sofa.

He picked up his keys. "Right, I'll see you later."

"Okay. Any idea what time you'll be back?" She tried to sound as casual as she could.

"Not really. Probably be after two, I should think."

Janine offered a sympathetic smile. "Okay."

As soon as he'd walked out of the door she tidied away her plate away and took a shower. She dried her hair, put on a black silk thong and matching bra, then sat at the dressing table and applied her makeup. She'd decided to wear another short black dress and black high-heeled sandals with a wrap-around ankle strap. Even though it was a cold evening, she didn't want to wear nylons.

Checking her reflection in the mirror, she felt a warm glow of confidence seep through her. She hoped Bromley would appreciate her outfit. Janine certainly felt a lot more attractive than she had on any of the occasions when he'd fucked her.

Glass of wine in hand, she waited by the living room window. A dark BMW pulled up outside the front door at three minutes to nine. Janine didn't bother taking a coat. She grabbed her handbag and left the flat.

The driver was waiting at the kerb when she opened the front door. "Miss McNab?"

The formality surprised her but she smiled. "Yes."

He opened the rear door and held it. She slid inside and noticed his eyes wander down to her thighs as she lifted her feet into the car.

The car smelled of new leather and carpets—nothing like their eight-year-old Nissan. She looked out through the tinted glass windows as they drove through the busy city, wondering if Adam's taxi was on the same streets.

The driver approached the casino via a narrow alley and parked in a small lot at the back of the building. He led her to a large metal door with no handle and entered a code into a keypad set in the wall. The door swung open with an electronic buzzing sound.

"After you, Miss."

Janine stepped inside. Once the driver had pulled the door shut, she followed him into the building until she recognised the corridor she'd walked through to Bromley's office the night Adam got himself into trouble. Shaking her head of that memory, she waited behind the driver as he popped his head round Bromley's door.

"Miss McNab's here, boss."

Janine didn't hear a reply from inside, but the driver stepped back and motioned for her to go in.

Bromley sat behind his desk. He spoke briefly into his mobile phone and ended the call, then stood and smiled. "Janine, good to see you."

As he stepped round his desk, she wasn't sure if she should greet him with a hug.

He stepped close and kissed her cheek. "You look fabulous."

"Thank you."

"Come on, let's get you a drink." Bromley led the way up the corridor to the bar where she'd shamelessly flirted with the barman four months earlier.

"Janine, great to see you back." Davy smiled broadly, revealing the dimples she remembered so well.

"Thank you. I can't believe you remembered my name."

He leaned over the bar to whisper. "I only remember the sexy customers."

She laughed. "I'm the same with barmen... Davy."

His eyes seemed to twinkle as they flirted, then he looked up at Bromley and turned serious. "What can I do for you, boss?"

"You can put your tongue away and pour the lady a drink." His tone was sarcastic but friendly.

Davy turned his gaze to Janine. "I'm not even going to guess because as I recall, you like to mix your drinks."

"Gin and tonic, please."

Glass in hand, Janine walked with Bromley into the centre of the casino. It wasn't as busy as the last time she was here, but there were a few groups of people standing around most of the tables.

Bromley leaned down and put his mouth to her ear. "I'm afraid I have to do a couple of things in the office, so why don't you have a wander around and enjoy yourself?"

"I wouldn't have a clue what to do."

He took something from his pocket, holding his fist out for her.

She held open her hand, puzzled, and he dropped a pile of betting chips into her palm.

Janine frowned. "What do you want me to do with these?"

"Whatever you like. Go and have fun."

She batted her eyelashes. "What if I try to smuggle them out with me when I leave?"

His eyes roamed over her body in the tight dress. "It doesn't look like you could hide much in there."

"Will you frisk me anyway?" She couldn't resist flirting with him; the last time they'd been together was still fresh in her mind.

He laughed. "Anything you win, you can keep. I won't need to frisk you." He glanced down at her body. "But I might do it, anyway..."

She narrowed her eyes and leaned close to whisper in his ear. "Good." A warmth spread through her stomach.

"When you need another drink, Davy will sort you out. I'll come and find you as soon as I can." He nodded at the chips in her hand. "Try roulette, it's easy to play."

With that, he headed back towards his office and Janine made her way towards the table with the roulette wheel.

The pretty blonde croupier smiled as Janine approached. "Are you going to try your luck?"

"Yes. What number should I bet on?"

The croupier laughed. "Well, contrary to what some of the guys here believe, I really don't know where the ball will end up."

An older guy standing next to Janine at the table shook his head. "Don't listen to her. She makes sure the ball never lands on the numbers I bet on."

Janine looked at the board and decided to try lucky number seven. She placed a chip in the square.

The croupier looked a little surprised. "Do you want me to split that for you?"

"Sorry?" Janine hadn't a clue what she was talking about.

"I can swap the black chip for blues or greens if you like."

Janine frowned, feeling like an idiot.

The guy next to her leaned closer. “She’s saying if you don’t wish to bet a hundred pounds at a time, you can start off with smaller bets.”

“That’s worth a hundred pounds?”

The croupier gave her a sympathetic smile, took away the black and white chip and passed her a stack of blue and white ones. “They’re worth a tenner each.”

Janine nodded and put one blue chip on number seven, but her mind was in a spin. She looked down at the pile of chips in her hand, counted them. She still had nine black and white chips left. Bromley had given her a thousand pounds to ‘go and have fun’ with.

She watched as the croupier said ‘No more bets’ and spun the wheel.

It seemed to take an age, but when the ball finally dropped into a pocket on the wheel it was number 16. A few of the men groaned, but a couple smiled as the croupier slid some chips their way. Janine didn’t understand how they’d won, because there’d been no chips on that number.

She shook her head and for the next spin she chose three separate numbers, using £30 of Bromley’s money. She lost again.

After another twenty minutes of betting and not understanding, Janine decided to go and get another drink. Davy was his usual charming self and talked her into having a glass of champagne.

He leaned an elbow on the bar. “How’s the gambling going?”

“Terribly. I haven’t a clue what I’m doing.”

“What are you playing?”

“Roulette. I never guess the right number.”

He scratched his chin, looked thoughtful and then nodded.

She couldn’t help smiling. “What?”

“I’ve got the answer.” He looked smug.

“Okay... What should I do?”

“Don’t gamble at all—it’s for losers. Save your money and spend it on me.”

Janine burst out laughing. “Spend my money on you; that’s your masterplan?”

He nodded. "You could start by buying me breakfast."

"Breakfast?"

He nodded again. "I work so late, we'll miss dinner."

"Ah, I see." Janine slinked closer to the bar, wiggling her body suggestively. "And what are we going to do between you finishing work and us eating breakfast?"

He shrugged, his cute face a picture of innocence. "I'll try and think of something."

"Hmm, I'm sure you will."

Another customer arrived at the bar, so Janine picked up her glass and returned to the roulette wheel. She watched for a few minutes and soon realised that she didn't have to bet on a single number. She saw people placing their chips over two adjoining numbers, or in the middle of a block of four numbers. Also, people could bet on even numbers, odd numbers, red, black, and a series of numbers in a column.

Two new men joined the crowd round the table and openly flirted with the croupier. Janine played for another thirty minutes and had some success, but lost more often than she won.

A waiter delivered another glass of champagne, explaining the barman had sent it over. She thanked him, then continued playing until she sensed someone step close at her side.

"How's the luck holding out?"

She looked up into his blue eyes. "I really have no idea."

He smiled, a relaxed look on his face. "Come on, let's go somewhere private."

A warm tingle developed in her stomach.

When they reached his office, he closed the door and smiled approvingly. "You look really good in that dress."

She narrowed her eyes and took a step closer. "And you look very dashing in your suit and tie."

"Thanks. So, show me how much you won."

Janine opened her palm to reveal her remaining chips.

After counting them, he frowned. "Oh dear..."

She wriggled her hips suggestively. “Maybe I’m hiding some about my person?”

“Maybe you are.” He reached out, placed his hands on her breasts and squeezed gently. He frowned before sliding his palms down to her waist, over her hips and finally cupping a buttock in each hand. “No, I don’t think you’re hiding any chips, which is bad news for you.”

Janine bit her lower lip. “Am I in trouble?”

He nodded. “You’ve lost over four hundred pounds.”

“Oops. Silly me.”

“You could have used the thousand I gave you as a payment towards your debt.”

She didn’t believe him. “But if I’d done that, there’d be no interest for me to pay. And you know how much I enjoy making the interest payments...” Janine ran her finger down his chest. “You make those payments very...interesting.”

“Good, because the extra four hundred you’ve lost tonight means you’re going to need to pay double interest this month.”

She loosened his tie. “Hmm, double interest. I like the sound of that. Do you think you can manage it twice?”

“The way you look in that dress...maybe.” He stroked her hair, looking amused. “Are you saying you want it twice?”

She giggled, the tingling in her stomach now accompanied by a warm wetness lower down. “Well I could definitely manage it twice, but I’m not sure if you could.”

He held her gaze for a few seconds, his face suddenly serious. “I won’t need to.” He took out his phone and touched the screen a few times, then slid it back into his pocket.

A coldness spread through Janine’s stomach.

The office door opened and a man with close-cropped greying hair walked in. He closed the door behind him and locked it.

“Tony, come and say hello.” Bromley kept his eyes locked on Janine’s. “Janine, I’d like to introduce my business partner.”

Bromley and Janine were still standing toe-to-toe, his tie hanging open.

The newcomer regarded them. “I hope I’m not interrupting anything.” His eyes wandered down Janine’s body.

Bromley shook his head. “Not at all. We were just discussing how I may need some help tonight.”

“Oh? That sounds interesting...”

She looked pleadingly into Bromley’s eyes, but he just smiled down at her.

The room was silent.

Janine hadn’t spoken a single word since Tony had entered the office. Her legs were shaking slightly, so she tried to calm herself.

Bromley slipped his hands around her back. He stared into her eyes as his fingers slowly pulled down the zip at the back of her dress.

Janine held her breath, eyes fixed on Bromley’s. The excitement she’d felt two minutes earlier had disappeared. She knew what was expected of her. With that knowledge came the realisation that Bromley saw her only as a commodity; something he could use and offer to others.

So be it.

When the zip was fully undone, she dipped her shoulders and pulled the dress down to her waist then slipped it over her hips and down to the floor. Refusing to be intimidated, Janine stood still while the men surveyed her body as she stepped out of the puddle of material and around behind the large desk. The only item on top was a silver laptop, which she collapsed and placed on Bromley’s office chair.

The men still hadn’t moved. They watched her in silence.

With her heart crashing in her chest, Janine struggled to maintain her composure. She’d accepted that the only way to get through this was by becoming what Bromley saw her as—a whore.

She stepped round to the front of the desk and faced the men. Reaching behind, she unclipped her bra and dropped it onto the floor by her feet.

The men stared at her breasts.

Raising herself up, Janine pushed herself back until she was sitting on the edge of the desk. She looked from one man to the other.

Tony seemed to be unable to keep from glancing down at her body but Bromley looked straight into her eyes.

Janine rested her hands on the desk behind her and leaned back on straight arms, shaking her hair away from her face. She parted her legs. "So, who wants to go first?"

This seemed to break the spell. Both men slipped off their jackets and approached the desk. Bromley gripped the waistband of her thong and Janine raised herself up to allow him to pull it down her legs and over her shoes.

Tony walked round behind and encouraged her to lie back on the desk. When she was flat on her back, he leaned over her head and caressed her breasts, kneading the flesh and tugging at her nipples.

She caught a glimpse of Bromley dropping to his knees before feeling his breath on her sex. The soft warm wetness of his tongue swept up along her outer lips, making her tremble.

Bromley repeated the action, this time slipping his tongue between her folds. Then he pushed his tongue deep inside her hole, making her groan.

Tony's hands left her breasts and she heard a zipper being pulled down. As he turned her head to the right, she instinctively opened her mouth in readiness for his cock. She closed her lips around him and he sighed.

Bromley moved his tongue up to her clit and slipped two fingers into Janine's sex, curling them up to press against her G-spot.

Janine writhed, bucking her hips against his fingers and tongue. At the same time, she bobbed her head back and forward on Tony's cock. She'd stopped worrying about the situation and was acting purely on instinct. Her mind revelled in the sordidness of giving herself to two men, and her body delighted in what they were doing to her.

Bromley's fingers and tongue had been about to send her tumbling into orgasm when he moved away.

Out of the corner of her eye, she saw him stand up and position himself between her legs. She arched her back as he entered her sopping cunt, her groans muffled by the cock filling her mouth. Bromley slammed into her with force, his huge cock sending ripples through her entire body. Tony cradled the back of her head as he fucked her face, his free hand pulling and twisting each of her nipples in turn.

Janine shook from their onslaught, her hands gripping the edge of the desk. When the orgasm shuddered through her, she screamed her release. With eyes squeezed shut and legs locked straight, she was momentarily lost in a whirlpool of pleasure.

Once the sensations had subsided, she wrapped her legs around Bromley's back and resumed pleasuring Tony with her mouth.

Tony mumbled his appreciation. "Oh, baby—that feels so fucking good."

Janine opened her eyes and looked up into his face. She wrapped her fingers around the base of his shaft and started pumping her hand.

"Whoa... Slow down, or you'll have me spilling it down your throat."

She pulled her head back and placed the flat of her tongue against his glans, moving his cock from side to side against her. She licked her lips and narrowed her eyes, now acting in full slut mode. "I thought that was the idea."

Tony chuckled and shook his head. "No, I'm going to fuck that tight little body of yours. When I blow my load, it's going to be deep inside your hot little hole."

Janine was usually turned off and offended by this sort of talk. But tonight was different. Tonight, she was different.

Bromley slowed his movements then pulled out of her.

She sat up on the desk, sweating. Strands of her hair stuck to her face. She looked from one man to the other. "Do you two want to swap places?"

Tony shook his head. "Let's change it up; get off the desk."

She lowered herself to the floor, her legs a little unsteady.

Nodding at Bromley, Tony pointed at the desk. “You lie on there.”

Bromley sat on the edge of the desk and reclined, his erection sticking out of his trousers.

Janine stood by the side of the desk and stared down at Bromley, amazed at the size of the balls hanging out of his shorts. Bending at the waist, she gripped Bromley’s cock and lowered her mouth onto as much of it as she could manage. She could taste her own juices on his cock, which added to her excitement.

Tony moved close behind her, nudging her feet further apart with his shoe. He ran the tip of his cock through her sex lips for a few seconds then, with a violent thrust of his hips, he buried himself deep inside.

Janine groaned as he gripped her hips and fucked her hard from behind, his groin slapping against her backside. She was glad his cock wasn’t as big as Bromley’s—she wouldn’t be able to withstand being pounded with something that big in this position.

Janine sensed both men were getting ready to come. Bromley was using his hands to move her head up and down on his cock, while Tony’s thrusting had become more urgent. She ran her hand over Bromley’s balls and kept her tongue moving around his cockhead.

He let out a grunt and flooded her mouth.

Janine gagged, swallowed, and gagged again. She couldn’t cope with the volume and opened her mouth slightly, allowing his cum to escape and run down his shaft. She pumped her hand and another spurt hit the back of her throat. That too ran down the outside of his cock, soaking the bush of hair around the base.

“Oh baby, here it comes...” Tony pushed hard into her and held still. “Ahhh...”

She felt his cock swell and twitch as he erupted inside her. She closed her eyes and enjoyed the moment, relishing the sensation of having two men come in her at the same time. This was beyond anything she’d fantasised about, even since meeting Bromley, but now it had become a reality.

Janine raised her head and looked down at Bromley’s cock. As she gave the base a light squeeze, a drop of cum appeared at the slit. She dipped

her head, lapped it up with her tongue and smiled up at him.

Tony withdrew from her and stepped back.

Both men pulled up their trousers and were fully decent in a matter of seconds, whereas Janine was naked except for her shoes. She bent and picked up her clothes.

Bromley nodded at a door in the rear wall of the office. "Get dressed and freshen up in there, then join us for a drink at the bar."

Janine walked unsteadily to the small bathroom and the men left the office. She regarded herself in the mirror. She had one man's cum on her chin and another man's cum seeping out of her cunt. She'd been a whore for two men tonight, and she'd enjoyed every single minute.

She glared at herself in the mirror, wondering what Adam would say. Or simply what her friends would say.

Have you no self-respect? Why would you whore yourself like that?

She waited for the guilt and self-loathing to begin, but the only thing she felt was gratification. She stopped glaring at herself and leant forward to tidy her makeup.

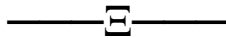
Maybe the guilt and self-loathing would appear later...

Once she'd cleaned up, she found the two men at the bar. Bromley passed her a glass of champagne.

Bromley's driver took Janine home shortly before midnight. After putting her dress and shoes in the wardrobe and her underwear in the laundry basket, Janine showered and pulled on a t-shirt and panties.

She was fast asleep long before her unsuspecting boyfriend returned home.

Ψ



Chapter Seven

Janine left for work on Saturday morning without waking Adam. At the salon, recurring images from the previous night kept flashing through her mind, providing her with a warm buzz for her entire shift. She felt no remorse over meeting Bromley privately, or making herself available to Bromley and his friend. Meanwhile, Bromley evidently had no qualms about sharing her. That was just fine for a woman discovering the pleasures of sex with no strings attached—a win-win situation. Her relationship with Adam was as good as over. Where he was concerned, it was a matter of keeping things amicable until they could go their separate ways.

She arrived home a little before half-three in the afternoon to find Adam sprawled out on the sofa.

Sitting up, he smiled at her. “Hiya. Sorry I slept through you leaving this morning.”

Dropping her coat onto the armchair, she headed to the kitchenette. “I crept out quietly on purpose. I thought you’d need the rest.”

He nodded and shrugged at the same time. “Thanks, but... I think it’s important we also make time for each other.”

Janine was taken aback, but tried not to show it. “I’m making a coffee—do you want one?”

“Cheers.” He made his way over to stand next to her.

Janine felt uneasy, wondering if he knew something had happened last night. She busied herself getting the cups out to avoid looking at him.

“I got a twenty-five quid tip last night for running a couple back to Buxton after they’d missed the last train. I thought we could go and have something to eat at that trendy new tapas place in Didsbury, then come home and watch a film.”

Was this an attempt to make up for acting like a dick for the past three months, or did he just want to get laid? She had to admit the idea of going out for tea appealed. Perhaps being with him outside the flat would force them to actually talk to each other about anything other than the whole Bromley arrangement. “Yeah, that’d be nice.”

His smile looked genuine. “Great. You go and relax in the bath for a while, then put on something nice, and we’ll go out at about five.”

He definitely wants to get laid. “A bath sounds good—I’ve been on my feet since half-eight.”

Adam took his coffee back to the sofa. “If you ask me nicely, I may even bring you a glass of wine.”

Janine had only just settled in the suds when Adam appeared at the bathroom door with a glass of red.

“Here you go.”

As she sat up to take it from him, she saw his eyes wander down to her breasts, which were covered in bubbles from the bath foam.

Once he’d left, Janine popped the glass onto the bath ledge and lay back in the hot water, closing her eyes. She hadn’t actually minded that Adam had peeked at her body. In fairness, he’d gone a couple of months without sex, so was probably climbing the walls with frustration by now.

If he manages to get through the evening without acting like a twat, he might just get laid later.

A wicked thought occurred as she sank deeper into the hot water. If she fucked him before ten, she’d have had three different men within

twenty-four hours.

* * * *

Janine sat in the tapas bar dressed in a white blouse, black skirt and black heels. She'd pinned her hair up and wore dangly earrings. Adam couldn't keep his eyes off her, and she felt a warmth for him that she hadn't felt in ages.

She took a sip of her wine. "So, tell me how the day-release course is going."

Looking happier than she'd seen him in a long time, Adam described the course, the other students and the lecturers. He told her how his boss had arranged for him to visit another branch of their company to help him research something for one of his assignments.

She was impressed by his enthusiasm. He was making a real go of this chance, and the fact his boss was helping was encouraging.

Adam held his hand against the small of her back as they walked out of the restaurant. Apart from the unintentional touching of legs in bed every now and then, this was the first physical contact they'd had in weeks.

Janine didn't mind this show of affection, nor did she object when he suggested they buy a good bottle of red wine to take home.

While Adam poured the wine, Janine sat in the armchair so that he would have to sit facing her on the sofa. She was going to tease him by flashing her legs, and had kept her shoes on to make him even hornier.

As Adam approached with her wine, he glanced down at her crossed legs. "Here you go."

"Thanks." Smiling to herself, she took the glass and inhaled the aroma. As Adam sat down opposite, she regarded him over the rim of her glass. He looked very handsome in his dark blue shirt and black jeans. His hair was a little longer than he usually wore it, which made him look younger, more vulnerable.

"Do you want to watch a film?" He seemed a little unsure of himself, which amused her. He seemed to be trying desperately hard to be

nice.

“I’m not that bothered about a film, unless you are?”

“No. I just thought if you wanted one...”

She took a sip of wine. “Can I ask you something?”

He sat forward “Yeah.”

“It’s about me being with Bromley...”

“Oh.” He looked deflated, as if resigned to the fact he wouldn’t be getting any after all.

“I’m just curious about your feelings. What goes through your mind when you’re out here and I’m in the bedroom with Bromley?”

He cast his eyes to the floor. “I try not to think—”

“Come on, don’t hold back. For the first time in ages, we’re actually talking to each other like we used to. We’ve had a lovely evening.” She adjusted herself in her chair, moving her legs to reveal more of her thighs. “I’ve even dressed up for you...”

He glanced at her legs, then held her gaze. “I think about how you must look on the bed.”

“How do you mean?”

“You know, your face, your body.”

Janine was puzzled. “I’m not sure I—”

“I think about your expressions, your body language. I imagine you lying down on the bed and looking up at him.” He shrugged, embarrassed.

“You mean when I’m lying on the bed and watching him undress?”

Adam nodded.

“What about when I pass him the condom and watch him roll the rubber down onto his cock?”

“Do you help get him hard?” His voice was little more than a whisper.

She shook her head. “No. By the time he unzips his trousers, he’s got a hard-on.” She saw him swallow, bite his lip.

“And what about you? Does he need to...?” He pushed a shoulder forward in a childish shrug, as if ashamed to use the word *foreplay*.

“No.”

“Why not?”

“I’m always wet enough.”

He nodded, took a gulp of wine.

Janine was enjoying herself. She was wet now, just talking about it. “He dribbles, too. I can see precum all over the head of his cock. It glistens until he rolls the condom on.”

Adam was silent, his eyes a little glazed.

Janine uncrossed her legs, placing both feet on the floor. “When he kneels on the bed, I open my legs for him, like this.” She allowed her knees to fall open. “Do you like me opening my legs for another man?”

He frowned, nodded his head slightly.

She smiled. “At last, you’re being honest. Good.”

Adam put his wine down and slid off the sofa, crawled on his hands and knees across the rug until he was by her feet.

She raised her bum high enough off the chair for him to remove her panties. “Can you imagine my expression when he runs the head of his cock through the wetness of my slit?”

He stared into her face. “Show me.”

She fluttered her eyes and dropped her mouth open, taking in a sharp breath before looking down at Adam. “Is that how you imagined my expression?”

He nodded.

Janine could see the bulge of his cock through his jeans. It wasn’t as big as Bromley’s, but she wanted it inside her.

He took a ragged breath. “What about your body?”

“What about it?”

“How does it react when he does that?”

Janine smiled, leaning forwards until their eyes were only inches apart. “My nipples get hard and I tremble. And I get even wetter.”

“And what about when he shoves it into you?”

“I bite my lip and screw my face up. But when he’s all the way in, I close my eyes and open my mouth like this—” Janine sighed for effect.

When she re-opened her eyes, Adam was shaking.

He swallowed. “And your body?”

“I arch my back to meet his thrust, then I wrap my legs around him and pull him deeper.” Janine could feel the juices dripping from her sex.

“Are you going to fuck me, Adam?”

He shook his head. “Not yet.” With that, he pushed her skirt up round her waist and plunged his face between her legs.

Janine fell against the backrest as he attacked her with his mouth. His tongue pushed roughly into her cunt, lapped all around and pushed into her again. She cried out, surprised but not about to complain. Closing her eyes, she twirled her fingers into his hair and moved his head up a little until his mouth was on her clit.

His hands gripped her legs, pulling her onto his face.

Janine rocked her hips, grinding her clit against his mouth. She wondered briefly if he could tell she’d had two cocks in her last night. Would there still be a trace of Tony’s cum inside? Maybe it was coating Adam’s tongue right now, mixing with his saliva and her juices, running down his throat...

“Ahhh...” The orgasm washed through her and she arched her back, pressing herself against his face for more friction.

He pushed his fingers in—at least three, possibly all four—and finger-fucked her hard, making her cry out again.

“Adam, put your fuckin’ cock inside me.”

He withdrew his fingers and ripped open his jeans. She barely had time to catch her breath before he plunged into her. Gripping his shoulders, she rocked herself against him. She raised herself up in the chair to try and get him deeper, wanting him to push as far into her as Bromley could.

Adam dropped his head back and groaned. He came about thirty seconds after he’d entered her.

On any other night, Janine would have considered this a big disappointment, but tonight she didn’t care; she’d had her third man in

twenty-four hours.

When she opened her eyes, Adam looked crestfallen.

He pulled out of her and sank back on his haunches, his shoulders slumped. “I’m sorry—I can’t believe I came so quickly.”

“It’s okay. It’s been a while, and I think we were both turned on.”

He looked up at her, eyes wide. “You’re not mad?”

She smiled. “Of course not.”

“But you’re used to longer...” He faltered. “Longer cocks spending longer fucking you.”

She sat forward. “Adam, please don’t spoil what we’ve just shared.”

He nodded, looked down at her feet and scratched his face. “Were you lying, when you said you hadn’t come after the first time?”

She could see the post-orgasmic melancholy engulfing him. “No, I wasn’t lying. I didn’t come during the first time.”

He nodded, kept his gaze focused on her shoes. “I know you came the third time, I heard you.”

She watched him, waited for his question. When he remained silent, she answered it anyway. “I came during the second time, too.”

Adam simply nodded.

“Adam, suppose the roles were reversed. Suppose we owed money to a woman, and she told you that you’d have to pay the interest by fucking her.”

He looked up, a sardonic smile on his face. “If she was ugly, I wouldn’t be able to get it up.”

She wondered if this was a dig at her for admitting she was always wet for Bromley. “Fancying her doesn’t come into it. You don’t get to choose who you fuck, but you have to make it work.”

He reached back to pick up his wine, took a sip and looked up at her. “So, what do I do?”

“You put a sexy thought in your head and pretend it’s somebody else.”

Adam’s eyes widened.

In truth, Janine hadn't actually needed to use this ploy. This was partly because she'd come to find Bromley attractive, but mostly because she liked the idea of giving herself to somebody who just wanted to fuck her. She hadn't found Tony attractive, but she'd still enjoyed sucking and fucking him.

Adam cleared his throat. "So, you're saying if the roles were reversed, all I'd have to do is think of something sexy to get it up?"

She shook her head. "No, it's easy for men—you could just take Viagra. But the point I'm making is, once you're fucking her, would you be able to prevent yourself from coming?"

He frowned, started to answer, but hesitated. "Are you saying you couldn't prevent yourself from coming with Bromley?"

She shrugged. "It's pretty difficult not to feel anything when there's a man shagging you."

This was obviously something he hadn't considered.

Janine picked up her glass and took a sip. "So, in our example of reversed roles, you're lying on a bed with the woman you owe money to."

Adam's eyes were focused on hers.

"You don't really fancy her, but you have your cock buried deep inside her. You remind yourself you're only doing it for the money. You don't want to fuck her, but it's a warm, wet hole you're sliding in and out of. She's lying there, watching you, enjoying your cock. You see her pant, see her eyes flutter, hear her groan. You feel her tighten around you when she comes..."

Adam waited, his mouth open.

Janine took another sip of wine and smiled. "I think you'd blow your load. You might not fancy her. You may even resent her for what she's making you do, but at the end of the day, your cock feels good inside her."

"Bromley's cock feels good inside you?" There was no accusation in his tone.

"Yeah, it feels really good. When he pushes it into me over and over, I close my eyes and I ride his cock. I take whatever pleasure I can get from it."

Adam nodded slowly. "Is it as good as you'd hoped?" His voice was quieter.

"Is what as good as I'd hoped?"

"Letting a stranger use your body."

She considered lying but decided against it. "Yes."

He was silent for a few seconds, then took another gulp of wine.

"What about for you?" She leaned forwards to look into his face. "Is it as good for you as you'd hoped?"

The question had obviously made him uncomfortable. "I don't know. Sometimes I like the thought of parts of it."

"What parts do you like to think about?" She smiled flirtatiously, coaxing him to reveal his secrets.

"I like the idea of his cock entering you, and that's when I try to imagine your expression."

"Do you like to imagine my expression when I come?"

He frowned, bit his lip. "Maybe..."

"What about my expression when he comes. Do you like to think about me staring into his eyes as he climaxes?"

Adam grimaced. "I don't think about that part."

"Think about it now. Think about everything that happens when Bromley's fucking me. Does it turn you on?"

Adam looked down at her feet again.

She smiled. "Come on, let's go to bed."

They left their wine unfinished.

Standing on her side of the bed, Janine stared at Adam as she removed her blouse, bra and skirt. Her panties were still on the living room floor.

Adam climbed into bed naked; Janine kicked off her shoes and joined him. She smiled at him for a second, then ducked her head under the covers and wrapped her fingers around his cock. She scooted her body down so her head was level with his groin.

Adam sighed as he lay back on his pillow.

She could just imagine the satisfied grin he was probably wearing now, but she wasn't fooling herself that anything had changed. Although she'd enjoyed the evening, she was only going to suck his cock because she was still horny. She needed him hard enough to fuck her again. As she parted her lips and took him into her mouth, she thought of another reason for doing this: now she'd fucked *and* sucked three cocks in the space of twenty-four hours.

Adam's cock was soon nice and hard—though, disappointingly, not as thick as Bromley's—so she sat up and positioned herself kneeling above him, her hand holding his cock at her entrance.

Janine looked into his eyes and dragged his tip through her wet folds. She was soaking, though most of the wetness was probably from his cum.

“So, do you want to continue with the confessions?” She smiled when he twitched with each swipe of his cock between her labia.

“Do you?”

She nodded. “I think there are things we still need to discuss.”

“Can we talk about them with my dick inside you?” His eagerness excited her.

“That depends if you can manage to last longer than the last couple of times you've been in there.” Although she was only teasing, she was ready for more than another *wham-bam-thank you-ma'am* session.

“I'll try...”

“Maybe I should make *you* wear a condom, see if that makes you last a bit longer...”

He seemed to like that idea, which surprised her. “Will you put it on for me?”

She reached over to the cabinet on his side and grabbed the last condom from the pack.

“Oh. I didn't think there'd be any left.”

His mock surprise didn't fool her; he was too paranoid and curious. He'd have checked the packet after Bromley's last visit, like he checked the bin for the used condoms.

She smiled sweetly at Adam. "Bromley decided to treat me with a ribbed one last time. Lucky me."

Janine ripped the foil, took out the condom and placed it on the end of his dick. She glanced over at his face, then back down as she rolled the rubber down to the base of his cock. Lifting herself back into position, she watched his face. Then, keeping her eyes locked on his, she slowly lowered herself down onto him.

Adam let out a sigh and placed his hands on her hips. He raised his bum off the bed, gritting his teeth as he pushed into her.

She slowly gyrated her hips, liking the feeling of him. "So, do you imagine me riding Bromley like this?"

He frowned, shook his head. "No, I always see him on top."

Janine shrugged. "Maybe next time I'll ride him like a cowgirl." She bucked her hips. "What about oral? Do you imagine me giving him a blowjob? Or him going down on me?"

"No."

"Well, maybe I should give you more images to think about."

Adam frowned and she stopped that line of conversation, not wanting him to come off the boil.

"Adam..."

"Yeah?"

She bent forward until their faces were only inches apart. "When you're imagining me with Bromley..."

"Yeah?"

"Do you make yourself come?"

His embarrassed expression gave her the answer.

She smiled. "I like the idea of you jerking off while thinking about me with another man."

"I'm thinking about you, not the other man."

"Yeah, but you're thinking about me with another cock inside me. Another man's cock filling your little girlfriend, making her moan. Making her squeal. Making her come."

“Janine...” He was breathless. “Maybe we shouldn’t talk about this right now.”

She bucked her hips faster. “Oh, is all the talk of me screaming on a big cock making you excited?” Mocking him wasn’t something she’d planned, but she couldn’t seem to stop.

He sneered. “Is this where you tell me how much you like it?”

Her breathing had become ragged, too; he wasn’t the only one turned on by her talk. “No, this is where I tell you I’m going to come on your cock, just like I come on the other cocks. Like the good little whore I am.”

He looked puzzled. “Other cocks?” He’d picked up on her slip.

She gritted her teeth and struggled to keep her eyes open as she came. “Are you going to come with me?”

His fingers dug into her hips; he pulled and pushed her on his cock.

As she screamed her release she felt him push up, knew he was coming. Suddenly, keeping himself inside her, he rolled her until he was on top. Raising himself up on straight arms, he banged her hard and fast.

She screamed, gripped his buttocks and pushed up against him.

He pulled out of her, ripped the condom off and pushed back into her. His thrusts continued, his cock still hard.

Janine came a second time and Adam squeezed her nipples painfully. He hadn’t fucked her like this in years.

“I think I’ll be able to come again.” He sounded more surprised than she was.

She opened her eyes and looked up into his face. “Are you thinking about fucking your girlfriend or fucking a whore?”

“Does it matter?”

“Not to me; I’m just thinking about the cock filling me.”

“Bitch.”

“Yeah, probably. But I prefer slut or whore.”

He gritted his teeth and fucked her harder.

Janine licked her lips. “So, where’s the spunk you promised me?”

He grinned, banged harder.

“Don’t promise me something you can’t deliver. Don’t say I’m going to get—”

“Ahh!” Adam pushed deep and held still, thrust twice more and held still again.

Janine could feel him coming, convinced she could feel the warmth of his fresh cum flooding into her.

They held onto each other until he finally dropped on his side of the bed, exhausted.

“Jesus.” He took a breath, laughed, and folded his arm over his head.

Janine went to clean up in the loo. When she got back to the bedroom, Adam was breathing evenly. He’d fallen asleep within a couple of minutes, but in fairness, he’d just managed to come three times in less than half an hour. He’d obviously had a lot of pent-up frustration to work off.

She went back into the lounge, added the remains of his wine to her glass and sat in the armchair to drink it.

* * * *

Janine did two hair-colourings during the following week, and also worked a full day Saturday. The following month would be busier; many of her private clients had already booked to have their hair done in time for the Christmas festivities.

As the end of November approached, Janine wondered if she’d miss her sessions with Bromley. By the end of December, their debt would be cleared and she’d be leaving Adam. Although they’d been more civil to each other since their shag-fest, nothing had changed as far as she was concerned. She no longer loved or respected him.

She’d also lost a lot of respect for herself, but that wasn’t a factor in her decision.

After closing up on Wednesday evening, she was tidying the salon alone when her phone beeped. It was a message from Bromley:

Phone me when you get a minute. SB

She rang and he picked up straight away.

“Hi, it’s Janine.”

“Thanks for phoning. Can you talk?”

She smiled. “Yes.”

“Great. Listen, I’ve booked a hotel for this weekend’s meeting.”

“What meeting’s that?” She was facing the mirror in the deserted salon, and could see herself smiling.

“You know, you and me. You said you’d prefer a hotel.”

“But I thought I’d already paid the interest this month?” There was a pause, and she could hear him breathing. “You know, the time you tricked me by giving me all those chips so you could invite your friend to join in.”

“Er, no. That was something else. Listen, Janine, about that—”

“About sharing me with your business acquaintance?”

“Yeah. I can explain—”

“Explain about letting me think you’d given me a thousand pounds?”

“It was a loan. I did say that, and I told you that you’d be allowed to keep anything you won.”

“But you didn’t explain *how* I’d have to make up for anything I lost.”

“No? Well, maybe I expected you to win.”

“I don’t believe that, otherwise you wouldn’t have invited your friend along.” Although she was smiling, Janine realised she was still a little upset about the way she’d been manipulated into the threesome. “How many colleagues are you going to bring to the hotel meeting? Maybe you should have booked the conference suite...”

“Janine, I ran into a problem. Tony had been going over the figures and had asked me why there were no interest payments being added to your loan. I gave him some bullshit about the interest being added later, but he kept badgering me until I admitted we’d got an arrangement. He had me over a barrel.”

She thought about Bromley being put in that position. It had never occurred to her that the decision to take the interest as sex was not solely his

to make. Maybe he'd get into trouble if the truth was discovered, and maybe she and Adam could still be forced to pay the whole amount of interest due.

She felt a little guilty for her teasing, now. "So, Tony won't be at the hotel on Saturday?"

"No, it'll be just us two."

"I work until three on Saturdays. What time were you thinking?"

"I've got the room from two, so come over straight after work."

"I'll be covered in hair-clippings."

He laughed. "That's okay, the room has a shower. And a whirlpool bath."

Her heart raced. "That sounds tempting."

"Right, I need to go. Text me the address of the salon and I'll send the car for you at three. The room's booked in your name."

He cut the call and Janine felt a tingle between her legs.

* * * *

Adam was late coming home on Friday evening. It had become their ritual to count out all the money they'd saved ready for him to take over to Bromley at the end of each month, so Janine decided to start counting it without him.

Adam hadn't got a taxi-driving shift tonight, so she assumed he'd stayed late at the factory, working on one of his assignments for his course. She went to the drawer where they added all the extra earnings during the month, but discovered the envelope was missing.

She stared at the drawer, wondering if Bromley had told Adam to take it over today so they'd have more time in the hotel tomorrow.

Just then, she heard Adam's key in the lock. She looked up and waited for him to come in, her hand still on the drawer handle in the kitchenette.

When Adam opened the door and he saw where she was standing, his face fell.

Her stomach tightened. “What is it?”

He closed the door but stayed on the other side of the room. “I... I... I’ve done something...”

“Adam, what have you done?”

“I decided I didn’t want you seeing Bromley anymore.”

“Oh?” Puzzled, she walked towards him “But I thought you liked it?” She raised her eyebrows, remembering their passion while discussing it less than two weeks ago.

He shook his head. “It was a mistake. I kept thinking about what you’d said...”

She didn’t understand what had happened, why he’d change his mind. “What did I say?”

“You know... About how I should imagine you riding him like a cowgirl and sucking him off.”

Janine shook her head in disbelief. “Adam, we were fucking. I thought it’d turn you on. In fact, it *did* turn you on. You came three times in about half an hour.”

His eyes filled with tears. “I think you like him.”

“What?” Janine couldn’t believe his childish behaviour.

“You’ve already told me you like fucking him. I heard for myself how hard he makes you come.”

“Oh for God’s sake...”

“Are you falling in love with him?”

“*What?* Of course I’m not.” She scoffed, leaned close until her face was inches from his. “Adam, the guy is using the fact that we owe him money to fuck me.” She shook her head in disbelief. “What makes you think I could ever fall for a man who does that?”

He looked down at the floor. “I’m sorry.”

“So you should be. You’re acting like a dick.”

He nodded and his shoulders slumped.

“So, have you told him we’ll be paying the rest of the interest in cash from now on?”

Janine experienced a twinge of disappointment, wondering if she should still meet Bromley at the hotel tomorrow anyway.

Adam ran his hand through his hair, and only when he looked up at her again did she see the tears running down his face.

“Adam, what have you done?” Her imagination ran wild. Images of him waiting outside the casino for Bromley with a knife flashed through her mind.

“I worked out how much money we still owed him.” He was trying to compose himself, taking deep breaths.

“Okay...”

“And I counted how much we’d got in the envelope.”

She glanced over at the drawer where they’d kept the money, then stared back at Adam. “And?”

“And I thought if we could make it up somehow, you know, there’d be no reason for you to see him again.”

A sense of dread leached into her stomach. Her heart seemed to miss a couple of beats. She felt sick. “Adam, please don’t tell me you’ve gambled away everything we’ve earned this month.”

“I thought if I could just—”

“Have you lost it? Have you lost our *fucking money*?” She’d gotten louder with each word.

He nodded once.

Janine clenched her fist and swung at Adam’s head. She caught him on the cheek and side of the nose. He squealed and stumbled backwards. When he steadied himself, he looked at her with wide, surprised eyes. Blood oozed from his nostril. A pink swelling had already begun to rise under his eye.

Janine hadn’t even meant to hit him, but she’d never felt such anger, such frustration. “You stupid twat.”

“Jan—”

“That’s it. That’s *fucking* it.” She took a step towards him and he cowered, covering his face with his hands in case she hit him again. “Get out.”

He looked puzzled, shook his head.

“That’s it, I’ve had enough.”

“But—”

“We’re through, Adam. I should have left you when you first got us into this mess, but like a prat, I stayed. I even let you talk me into doing something that no boyfriend should ever suggest or agree to.”

“But you—”

“You promised me that you would never gamble again. You sat on that sofa and cried like a baby, and swore to me that you would never gamble again.”

“I did this for *us*.”

His bleating made her want to punch him again. “Get out. You can collect your stuff tomorrow while I’m at work.”

“Where will I go?”

“I don’t care. Sleep in your fucking taxi, but you’re not staying here. I’ll put the flat on the market on Monday. As soon as we sell, we’ll pay my mum and dad what we owe them and split whatever’s left.”

Adam’s face was as white as the tissue he held to his bleeding nose.

“You can use your half to pay off the rest of your debt, because as of now, I’m not helping with it at all.” She shook her head in disgust. “I worked god knows how many extra hours this month, and you’ve blown it all on... What did you lose it on?”

“Sorry?”

“How did you gamble away all our money? Did you go back to the casino?”

He shook his head. “Horses.”

“You bet on horses?”

He nodded.

“Get out, Adam, I’m sick of looking at your face.”

He reached out for her but she slapped his hand away.

“Don’t you fucking dare touch me.” She glared at him. “Go.”

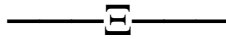
Adam walked to the door with his head down. He turned and looked back at Janine with cold eyes. “You’re a bitch and a whore.”

“Yeah, and you’re a pimp and a wanker. Now fuck off out of my life.”

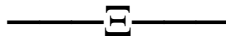
After he’d left, Janine clicked the dead lock.

Gazing around her home of three years, she would have expected sorrow and regret, but instead all she felt was an overwhelming sense of relief.

She sighed, then headed to the kitchenette to find the wine bottle.



Ψ



Chapter Eight

Janine woke without a hangover, despite the fact she'd finished an open bottle of Chardonnay from the fridge, then drunk a full bottle of Australian Shiraz. She showered and left the flat without bothering with breakfast, deciding she'd pick up a coffee on the walk to work. At the salon she tried to be her usual self, but Eloise and one of her clients actually commented on the fact she seemed to be in a particularly good mood. Maybe living with Adam these last few months had been more of a burden than she'd realised.

She'd decided she'd still meet Bromley at the hotel. This time she'd be fucking him for her own pleasure, nothing more. Would that make the sex better or worse?

Just before three, she checked in the mirror to make sure she hadn't got hair-clippings on her face, grabbed her coat and bag, and shouted her goodbyes to Eloise and Tina. As soon as she stepped through the door, she saw the BMW pull out of its parking space fifty metres away and join the traffic. It pulled in next to her and the driver stepped out.

“Miss McNab.” He smiled as he held her door, then slid back behind the wheel and drove them into the Saturday afternoon traffic.

Janine wondered if Adam had cleared his stuff from the flat while she was at work. Earlier, mid-perm, she’d been struck by the thought of him scrawling ‘whore’ across the walls of the flat, or ripping up every garment in her wardrobe. She shook herself out of her paranoia. Even Adam wouldn’t do something that childish and vindictive—if only because he’d need all the money he could get from the flat sale to pay off his debt.

The driver stopped at the kerb outside the hotel, a grand, redbrick building in the city centre. The uniformed doorman walked down the two stone steps and opened her car door. As Janine walked into the marble-floored lobby carrying just her handbag, she felt extremely under-dressed.

She approached the smiling receptionist. “Hi, I have a room reserved in the name of McNab.”

“Yes, welcome. Room two-one-four.” She handed over the key-card in a small paper wallet. Something about her smile made Janine uneasy. “Your guest went up to the room a little while ago.”

“Thank you.” Janine walked towards the elevators, certain that the receptionist knew exactly what she was up to.

From the elevator, she made her way down the corridor, enjoying the feeling of the plush carpet beneath her feet. She paused for a second at the door before inserting the card and opening the door.

Bromley got up from the armchair as she walked in and closed the door behind her. He smiled and stepped close, kissing her on the cheek. “Hi.”

Janine smiled up at him, then looked round the room. “Wow, this is fabulous.”

“Yeah.”

She turned to him and shook her head. “When I said it’d be easier in a hotel, I just meant anywhere but the flat. I’d have been happy in a Travelodge.”

“I wish you’d told me that before I’d spent a fortune on this place.”

“Cheapskate!” She dropped her handbag on the chair and removed her leather jacket. “If I’d known we were meeting somewhere this posh, I’d

have worn something nicer. I felt scruffy when I walked in the lobby.”

He looked down at her attire; she wore a grey blouse, knee-length black skirt and black opaque tights with flat ankle boots. “You look fine to me, but then I’m hoping you won’t be keeping your clothes on for long.”

She stepped close and stared up into his eyes. With flat shoes on, she was a foot shorter than him. “After deceiving me with the chips, I’ve a good mind to keep my clothes on. Maybe I’ll limit your pleasures to just a handjob today...”

He laughed, then bounced his eyebrows. “I think I might enjoy that—though I’d prefer you to be naked while you did it.”

She slapped his arm playfully. “I need a shower—I’m itching from hair-clippings.”

Bromley pointed to the bathroom door. “Everything you’ll need is in there.”

Janine walked in to the bathroom and her jaw dropped. It was at least five times as big as the one in her flat. Grey marble-effect tiles covered the walls, and all the fittings were white and chrome. The walk-in shower was as big as a car-wash, but dominating the room was a massive, free-standing roll-top bath with clawed feet.

Janine locked the door, took a pee and then turned on the shower and stripped naked. Before getting into the shower, she unlocked the door and opened it a couple of inches, hoping Bromley would take the hint.

She stepped under the rainfall shower head, enjoying the power of the cascading water. It felt more like a massage than a shower. She closed her eyes and tipped her head back. It was only a minute or so before she felt him step in behind her. She leaned back into Bromley, enjoying the feel of his wet skin against hers. He wrapped his arms around her waist, slid his big hands up to cup her breasts.

Janine dropped her head back onto his chest and let out a groan as he teased her nipples with his fingers. She wriggled against the hard cock pressed against her bum.

He turned her round to face him. Standing on tiptoes, she pulled his head down and kissed him for the first time, enjoying the feel of his lips on hers. She pushed her tongue forward and his was there to greet it. His

fingers stroked the small of her back and her buttocks while she ran her hands over his back and shoulders.

Finally, Bromley broke the kiss and squeezed some shower gel into his hands. He gently washed her arms, shoulders and back, then added more soap to his hand and washed her breasts. His lathered fingers ran down the crease between her buttocks, a tip finding the opening of her anus and probing gently.

Janine lathered a big dollop of liquid soap in her hand and went straight for his cock. Holding the base of the shaft with one hand, she ran the other over his cockhead, occasionally giving the top half of his shaft a few strokes before moving up to caress the tip again.

Bromley groaned and pulled her hand away, then smiled at her. They let the clean water wash all the soap away, then stepped out of the shower and used the big soft towels to dry each other.

Wordlessly, they moved into the bedroom and climbed into the big bed. The mattress was firm, the goose-down pillows soft, and the Egyptian-cotton sheets smooth and cool. There were blankets and a counterpane, rather than a quilt. As they lay side by side, Janine leaned over and resumed their kissing.

He pulled her body tight against him, his tongue sliding against hers.

Janine loved the feeling of his strength and power. Bromley rolled her onto her back and she spread her legs. He placed his knees between hers and crushed her breasts with his chest, his hard cock pressing against her tummy.

She was breathless, desperate for him to enter her as he positioned himself at her entrance.

Janine raised her head off the pillow and pulled him into another kiss. He sank down, his cock sliding easily inside her. She moaned into his mouth, running her fingers through his hair.

They fell into a slow, lazy rhythm.

Janine moved her body with his, riding him from below. The kissing continued, making it so much more intimate. She ran her hands over his sides and up around his shoulders. He was so much bigger than Adam:

taller, wider chest, thicker arms and legs, not to mention the main difference, which was urging her slowly towards the inevitable climax.

She broke the kiss and rested her head on his shoulder, eyes squeezed shut as she concentrated on the ecstasy of being slowly brought to boil. Her heart beat faster in her chest. Her stomach muscles tingled as she climbed the last few rungs towards the top of the pleasure-ladder.

Janine held his head in her hands and put her mouth to his ear. "I'm going to come."

He pushed a little harder but didn't change rhythm.

"Oh, I'm going to..."

Bromley raised his head and stared into her face, watching her expression.

"I'm... I'm... Oh god—"

She couldn't keep her eyes open. Fireworks exploded behind her eyelids and a flush of liquid heat surged through her body. Each contraction was like a pulse of electricity, an energy that shook her to the core.

Bromley let out a series of short groans, followed by a long sigh. His release sent Janine back up the ladder and into a second climax.

Her body seemed to vibrate, each nerve-ending buzzing as if possessed by a swarm of bees. She couldn't recall ever having a more gratifying orgasm.

It was a couple of minutes before they slowly peeled their bodies apart. Janine lay on her back and immediately felt his cum seeping out of her. She didn't care and had no intention of preventing the sheets getting stained. The receptionist's knowing smile from earlier was justified. Sex *was* the only reason Janine was in the hotel.

Bromley lay on his side, watching her. "Penny for your thoughts?"

"No chance. Knowing you, you'll probably tell me the penny was a loan and that I now need to pay back the interest by sleeping with your gardener while you watch."

He chuckled. "Are you hoping my gardener's a big strong man with rippling muscles?"

“Well, I’m certainly not hoping for another man who’s old enough to be my dad and smells of cigarettes.”

She saw him flinch.

“I’ve explained about Tony. There was nothing I could do.”

“Hmm.” She made her tone deliberately sceptical.

He pushed his knee against her. “I don’t think you’re really in any position to complain—I saw how much you enjoyed him.”

“I did not.” Even as she said it, she began to giggle.

Bromley laughed with her. “I seem to remember you stripping naked, sitting on my desk, and asking who was going first.”

Janine still couldn’t believe she’d behaved in such a way. “I didn’t have any other choice.”

“I also saw the way you opened your mouth for him, and the way you bent over the desk for him.”

She smiled. “I suppose I did indulge myself. It was my first threesome—thought I’d make the most of the experience.”

“Well, I think it’s safe to say you made everybody happy.”

She looked at him. “Does he get to have a go at every woman who owes you money?”

He frowned. “What do you mean?”

“I mean, when you arrange to sleep with women as part of the repayment deal, does Tony get his share?”

“Nobody else pays their debts in this way.”

“Really?” She was surprised, but couldn’t deny feeling a little flattered as well. “So, why me?”

He shrugged. “Nobody else has ever suggested it.”

“What?” A hollowness developed in her stomach.

“You’re the only person to come up with the offer of paying the interest this way.”

Janine was speechless.

Bromley must have seen something in her expression because he reached out and stroked her shoulder. “What is it?”

“I...” She shook her head and took a slow breath. “I’m such an idiot.”

“What do you mean?”

“Adam told me that you’d suggested it, but he’d refused.”

It was Bromley’s turn to gape. “I could get arrested for suggesting something like that.” He pointed at himself and Janine, lying naked in bed together. “Like *this*.”

Janine knew immediately that he was telling the truth. She’d been played, but had been too trusting to see it.

“I think you’d better have a word with your boyfriend. Let him know that if he doesn’t tell you the truth, then I’ll beat it out of him.”

She rested her hand on his arm. “Oh, I believe you. What I can’t believe is my own stupidity. But for the record, he’s not my boyfriend anymore.”

“Oh?” He sat up. “Since when?”

“Since last night. We had a fight and I ended it. He’s picking his stuff up today, and I’ll put the flat on the market on Monday.”

“Wow. I’m sorry. Didn’t know. Definitely his loss though, the stupid twat.”

Janine sat up, combed her hair with her fingers. “Shall we try out the whirlpool bath while we talk?”

He smiled. “Good idea. How about I order up a bottle of champagne for us to drink while we’re in there?”

“Perfect.”

* * * *

Janine lowered herself into the water while Bromley placed the ice-bucket within reach of the bath. He poured their drinks and handed one to her, then pressed the button to start the Jacuzzi.

They sat in silence for a couple of minutes, then Bromley stroked her knee. “Was splitting with your boyfriend because of what’s happened between you and me?”

She shook her head. “We’ve both been doing extra hours at work for the last three months to get the debt paid off as quickly as we can. Yesterday, Adam took our month’s combined earnings to the bookies and lost it all on horses.”

Bromley frowned and shook his head. “I’m sorry.”

“Every single time he acted like a dick, I kept thinking ‘I’m going to leave him if he does it again’. But he kept fucking up, and I stayed. It’s my own fault—I should have dumped him after the first night at your casino.”

“I have to admit, after seeing your mood in my office that night, I was surprised you didn’t.”

She shrugged. “It was complicated. We have a joint mortgage which my parents helped us get—we still owe them the money they gave us for the deposit. And I’d been with him for so long... He wasn’t always like this, he used to be really nice, caring and...” She could no longer think of Adam as the witty, charming man she’d first fallen in love with all those years ago.

“So, how did he fool us both into thinking the other had come up with this plan?”

Janine closed her eyes and sighed. “God... The more I think about it, the more I realise how easy it must have been for him to control me.” She sat forward, looked at Bromley. “We’d agreed to come and see you together to sort out how we should pay. He went on his own.”

“Yeah, I remember. He was a nervous wreck.”

“When he got back, he told me you’d suggested an arrangement where you’d overlook the interest part of the debt if you could spend an hour with me every couple of weeks.”

“If I’d suggested that, he could have left and gone straight to the police.”

Janine nodded. “I have to admit, I’d never thought of that. I just assumed it was something you could get away with, because...” She shrugged. “I’d never been in debt to anyone like you before. I was worried you’d break our legs if we didn’t pay you.”

His face broke into a smile. “I’m just a businessman, not a crook.”

“Yeah, I can see that now.” She took another gulp of her drink.

“But how did he talk you into letting me...you know?”

“I think I talked myself into that.” Embarrassment seized her, but she wasn’t about to lie. “When Adam told me about it, I suppose I liked the idea. I’m sure many women fantasise about sex with strangers, just letting a man do whatever he wants to them...”

He sighed up to the ceiling and chuckled. “I wish I’d known I could have done anything I wanted.”

She smiled. “Adam obviously picked up on it, and he used it to his advantage. For someone who’s stupid enough to gamble money he can’t afford to lose, he’s quite smart in other ways. He saw my reaction and sowed the seeds.” She remembered their talking about it during sex, how she’d even driven up the price.

“Well, he fooled me, too.” Bromley shook his head, looked puzzled. “I couldn’t understand how he’d let you do it.”

“It turned him on. He got off on the fact I was being fucked by somebody else.”

“I never had him down as a cuckold.”

“A what?”

“Cuckold. It’s where husbands invite other men to use their wives, but usually while they watch.”

Janine was amazed. “People do that?”

“It’s pretty common, I’m told.”

“You’re told?”

He shrugged. “Porn sites are dedicated to that sort of thing.”

“And you think that’s what Adam is?”

“Sounds like it. I’m just not sure how he managed to trick us both into thinking it was the other’s suggestion.”

Janine thought back. “He told me you’d remembered me from the night in your office—said I’d made an impression on you.”

“Well you were showing a lot of leg that night. He probably noticed I kept glancing down.”

Janine emptied her glass. “It doesn’t matter now, I suppose.” She held her glass out for a refill.

“You don’t regret it?” His smile suggested that he had no regrets.

“No, but I won’t be doing it again on his behalf. I’ve told him the debt is now his, and that he either pays the interest in cash, or he lubes up and lets you do the same to him.”

Bromley guffawed. “I’ll have to insist on cash.” He returned the bottle to the ice-bucket and sat back. “So, why did you come here today?”

“Because I wanted to have sex with you. Adam still owes you the interest for this month—what I just did was for me.”

He nodded. “Today was different.”

“What d’you mean?”

“You acted different. You kissed me...”

“Like I said, today was for me.”

The bubbles stopped as the motor went into rest mode.

He went quiet for a few moments, obviously thinking about something. “So, what’ll you do now?”

“Once the flat is sold, I’ll have to look into renting somewhere smaller or get a room in a shared house.”

“How many days do you work?”

“Six, but Thursday and Saturday are short days.”

“How much do you earn?”

“About nineteen grand a year.” She shrugged, a little ashamed. “I didn’t do very well at school, and I’m not—”

“How would you like to work for me?”

“I hope you’re not suggesting you pay me to do this sort of—”

“What? No!” He shook his head vigorously. “Nothing like that. I got some interesting feedback after your trip to the casino the other night. People liked you being there.”

“Who, Tony?”

He laughed. “Tony *loved* you being there, but that’s not what I mean. You need to realise that a high percentage of my customers are sad men with more money than friends. They come to gamble, but also to enjoy themselves. Having someone like you—pretty, and polite—to look at and chat to makes their evenings more enjoyable.”

Janine couldn't help but think there was more to this than he was admitting. "I wouldn't be expected to give blowjobs under the roulette table?"

"Certainly not. If you work four nights a week, I'll pay you twenty-five grand a year. You can keep any tips you make, and since your hours will be from nine until about two in the morning, you can still work part-time as a hairdresser if you want to."

It sounded good. Maybe if she built up her private clients, she could do one or two each afternoon and make enough money to rent a nice flat and save up for a deposit to buy one of her own.

"Why would you do that for me?"

He shrugged, smiling. "Maybe I'm just a nice guy."

She laughed. "That may take me a while to accept—I thought you were using the fact I owed you money to have sex with me."

"And I thought you were using the fact that I fancied you to avoid paying the money you owe me."

Janine let his words sink in for a few seconds. "So, what now?"

"How d'you mean?"

"What time do we have to leave here?"

"The room's booked for the entire night." He raised his glass. "You can stay all night and have breakfast here."

"Will you be able to come back after work?"

He frowned. "I wish I could, but no."

"Shame." Janine bit her lip, smiled. "What time do you have to leave?"

"Not for a while yet. Why?"

"I'm just wondering if you're going to do me in the bath..."

He laughed. "What if I'm still thinking about the hand-job you offered earlier?"

She nodded. "Okay, let me use you in here until I come, then go lie on the bed and I'll finish you off with my hand." She leaned close and kissed him gently. "If you ask nicely, I may even let you come all over my boobs."

He emptied his glass and put it on the floor next to the bath. Then he lifted her effortlessly up onto his lap.

She was pleasantly surprised to discover he was already hard.

He slid down in the bath and held his erection straight up, then pressed the button to restart the Jacuzzi. "Okay, use me."

She laughed, adjusted her position until she was kneeling over him, and did exactly that.

* * * *

Janine chose a knee-length, dark red dress for her first night at her new job. When she arrived at the casino, she was escorted to Bromley's office and waited there a couple of minutes until he finally joined her.

"Hi." He smiled at her as he sat behind his desk. His eyes swept down her body, taking in the black nylons and black shoes. "You look great."

"Thank you."

"Okay, quick recap on your role. Walk around the casino and use that smile of yours to charm people. If the men talk to you, be polite."

"I can do that." She flashed him her brightest smile, making him laugh.

"I know you can. If they offer to buy you a drink, tell them it's not necessary because you get all your drinks for free. I don't intend having you sting the customers for a fifteen-pound cocktail."

Janine nodded.

"If the men are rude or make improper suggestions, walk away and tell one of the bouncers. You're not being paid to take any crap from the customers, and anyone who misbehaves will be ejected from the casino and told not to come back."

She frowned. "You're beginning to worry me, now."

"I honestly don't think you'll have any problems, but alcohol and beautiful women in the same vicinity seems to bring out the worst in some men." He stood up and came round the desk, leaning against the edge.

Janine's mind flitted back to the last time she'd been in this office, leaning over that desk with Bromley's cock in her mouth and Tony fucking her from behind.

"So, how are things at home?"

She smiled. "Great, thanks. Adam moved his stuff out without peeing on all my clothes. I phoned an estate agent and they sent a photographer round on Tuesday. They already have a couple of interested parties, so I don't think selling it will be a problem."

"That's good. Where will you live?"

"I'm looking around now."

"What about your job?"

"I have to work two weeks' notice, but my boss asked if I'll stay until after Christmas because she has a lot of bookings. She said I can just work afternoons if I'm too tired to get up in the morning." She couldn't help grinning. "Everything seems to be working out really well."

"And your boyfriend?"

"I've haven't seen or heard from him. Has he contacted you about the debt?"

"He came in last week and signed the papers. I told him it'd be better if he steered clear of the casino from now on, so he'll be paying monthly by direct debit."

Janine nodded, wondering if she could get away with admitting that she'd miss paying the interest part of the loan now that Bromley was her boss.

He stood and inclined his head toward the door. "Shall we go out and show the customers our latest member of staff?"

She got up, taking a deep breath. "Okay, I'm ready."

* * * *

The first few nights at the casino were pleasant enough. By the end of the second week, a few of the regulars knew her by name and made a point of including her in their betting. One old guy called Robert took a

particular shine to her, explaining that she reminded him of how his late wife had looked when she was younger.

As they stood by the roulette wheel, Robert leaned close to whisper. "I think you're my lucky charm tonight. What month were you born?"

"April."

Robert smiled, placed two black and white chips on number four.

Janine's eyes widened. The guy had just bet £200 based on her birth month.

The croupier spun the wheel one way, rolled the ball in the opposite direction. Everyone waited.

The ball landed in number 27 and Robert's chips were dragged away.

He shrugged. "How old are you?"

"Twenty-four."

He bet another £200 and lost again.

He leaned close enough to whisper. "Okay, we need to dig deeper. How old were you when you lost your virginity?"

Janine giggled at this question coming from a guy who must be well over seventy. "I can't tell you that."

"Don't you remember?"

"Of course I do, but I don't seem to be bringing you much luck."

He smiled. "Indulge me."

Janine shook her head in disbelief, thinking back to a summer's night in the back seat of her boyfriend's Ford Sierra. "I was sixteen."

Another £200 was placed with the same result. Robert had now lost £600 in the last few minutes.

She gripped his frail arm. "Why don't we go and try a different game. Or sit and have a coffee?"

He smiled and patted her hand. "One more go." He looked round to make sure nobody could hear him. "How many lovers have you had since that first time?"

Janine held his gaze. Was he getting off on this information, or was he really just using her to generate random numbers? She thought about her

answer. Her first serious boyfriend, the guy she met straight after she'd been dumped, the one-night stands when she'd first started going to clubs, Adam, Bromley, Tony... "Eight."

"Thank you." Robert leaned over and placed £200 on the eight square.

She was just about to tell him not to bet so much when the croupier said, 'no more bets, please' and spun the wheel.

Janine bit her lip as she waited what seemed an endless time for the ball to finally land in...

...pocket eight.

She squealed and threw her arms around him, almost knocking him over. "Sorry."

He laughed, and everyone round the table applauded.

Janine watched as the croupier passed his chips; it was a big pile. "How much have you won?"

"Seven thousand, plus my initial bet." He smiled, then passed her some chips. "For you."

She frowned and shook her head. "I couldn't possibly take—"

"Of course you can. I knew you held the answer, I just needed to find the right question." He closed her fingers over them and patted her hand. "Thank you, and I hope to see you in here again soon."

Janine watched him walk towards the exit, then looked down into her palm. He'd given her £500. In a state of shock, she made her way to the bar.

Davy had his usual smile for her. "Hiya, what's it going to be?"

"Just a tonic water, please."

"Coming up. How's it going tonight?"

She looked down at the chips in her hand, then back at Davy. "It's going really well, thanks."

He put her drink on the bar and leaned closer. "Have you thought anymore about my offer of joining me for breakfast?"

"Oh, I think about it every single day."

He studied her. "You're just fooling with me, right?"

She laughed. “No. One day, I’m going to build up the courage to accept.” She felt a flutter in her stomach as she imagined dropping to her knees and slowly undoing those tight pants of his.

His mouth dropped open until he saw someone approaching and snapped back into professional barman mode again. “Good evening, Mrs B. What can I get you?”

“Bloody Mary please, lovey.”

Janine felt the hairs on the back of her neck stand up. *Mrs B?*

She cast a discreet sideward glance. The woman was about forty, with short blonde hair. She was bigger all over than Janine—five or six inches taller, with a more voluptuous figure. She wasn’t fat, but she had ample boobs, a thick waist and wide hips. She looked like a woman who’d have no problems accommodating Bromley’s cock.

Mrs B looked over at Janine and smiled.

Davy did the introductions. “This is Janine, the latest member of our staff. Janine, this is Judy Bromley.”

Janine attempted a smile. “Hi.”

“Hello, and welcome to the fold.” Judy tasted her drink and smiled at Davy. “Perfect.”

Davy bowed slightly.

“I’ll see you later for a refill.” She turned. “Nice to meet you, Jean.”

Too stunned to correct her, Janine watched Bromley’s wife walk towards his office. She turned to Davy. “I didn’t realise Bromley was married.”

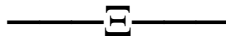
“Yeah, that’s Judy.” He grinned. “She’s not very good with names.”

“So I see.” Janine couldn’t decide how she felt about Bromley being married. He should have told her. Could’ve told her, even. Although she wasn’t devastated, she couldn’t deny it upset her a little. Then she scolded herself for thinking this way—she knew full well it wouldn’t have changed things.

It was just one more lie in their short, sinful history.



Ψ



Chapter Nine

The week before Christmas was manic for Janine. She had private clients every morning and the afternoons at the salon were incredibly busy. On top of that, Bromley had asked her to work six nights instead of the usual four, because there were several workplace party bookings throughout the week at the casino.

Janine was grateful for the extra hours. She'd accepted an offer on the flat, with the sale expected to be completed by the end of January. Her life was definitely moving in the right direction.

Thursday night in the casino was as busy as Janine had ever seen it, with people crowding three rows deep around all the gambling tables. The atmosphere was much more jovial than usual, friendly banter being shouted from one table to another. It reminded Janine of her first-ever trip there with Adam all those months ago, when the guys in the stag party had flirted with her.

As Janine walked towards the craps table, she passed through a group of men in sharp suits.

One of them opened his arms. “Hey, looks like Father Christmas has sent my present early.”

She laughed. “Aren’t you a little too old to believe in Santa Claus?”

“Possibly.” He gazed down at her body. “But you are undoubtedly a Christmas cracker.”

He was actually quite handsome—though a little too pretty-boy for Janine’s taste. His self-assured manner suggested a private school education, as did his clipped upper-class accent.

Janine offered another smile—she wasn’t paid to be rude to people, even if she didn’t like the class they represented.

He bowed slightly. “Let me buy you a drink.”

“Why thank you, but that’s not necessary. I work here, so I get my drinks for free.”

One of the other guys joined the conversation. “Oh, interesting. What exactly does your role entail?”

The rest of the group gathered around her. She could smell aftershave and alcohol. “I’m a hostess. I try to help make your visit a pleasant experience.”

The first guy nodded and grinned. “I’m sure you will.” He hailed a passing waiter. “Could we have a couple of bottles of champagne, and also whatever the lady’s drinking?”

The waiter looked at Janine and raised his eyebrows.

“Sparkling water please, Jerry.”

After the waiter had disappeared, the first man did the introductions. “I’m Hugo. My colleagues,” he said, pointing to each man in turn, “are Russell, Adrian and Toby.”

The men looked to be in their late twenties or early thirties. They were all slim and relatively good-looking. They wore expensive suits and big flashy watches, and had too much gel in their hair. A couple of them had close-trimmed beards. Toby’s tie was patterned with a hideous montage of vivid colours.

Janine nodded at them. “Hi, I’m Janine.”

“Gorgeous name—it certainly suits you.”

She thought he was a little too sure of himself, but tried to be polite. “So, are you guys here for a staff party?”

“Indirectly. We’re up here to attend a meeting and decided to come out to play rather than spend all night in the hotel bar.” Hugo was doing all the talking.

“So, where are you normally based?”

“London. We’re city bankers.”

Janine couldn’t help smiling. “Is that rhyming slang?”

“Very droll. I can’t imagine what you think *bankers* rhymes with...”

Just then, Jerry arrived with the drinks. One of the men passed Janine her water, and they poured their own champagne.

“Righto, on to the gambling. Janine, perhaps you could show us where we can fritter away our money?”

She laughed. “That’s not the best attitude to have at the start of your evening.”

Hugo shrugged. “We spend our days predicting financial futures, and I think we’re all in agreement that the possibility of us making a substantial short-term profit is minimal.”

The guy called Adrian gave a pretentious laugh. “But it’s only money.”

Janine led them to the least crowded blackjack table. The men gathered around and, after a ten-minute wait, two spaces opened up. Hugo and Russell stood at the table and joined in, while Adrian and Toby pressed close to Janine.

She noticed the bankers were betting large amounts. The previous week when Robert had won a lot of money, she’d been so pleased for him. Tonight was different. Janine would be perfectly happy if these men lost every penny they had in their moleskin wallets.

After a short while, more spaces opened up around the table so all four men could play. They seemed to be betting against each other rather than the dealer, egging each other on while trying to impress Janine with their casual disregard for money. Maybe this was an attitude that usually impressed women who went for men in the financial sector.

Although she hadn't seen any evidence that they were winning, the men from the bank seemed to be in high spirits. They ordered more champagne. Russell suggested they try roulette, and Janine led the four of them over.

Janine was aware that Hugo had his hand on her lower back. She didn't mind; he probably thought he was being charming.

Roulette was kinder to them, and Hugo and Toby both collected piles of chips during the first twenty minutes. The more they drank, the louder and funnier the bankers got. Janine found herself enjoying their company. She laughed at their jokes, even ones which weren't really that funny. She was overtired—the busy week catching up with her. The rest over Christmas would be a very welcome break.

One of the guys asked her to suggest a number for him to bet on. Her mind wandered back to Robert asking her all sorts of personal questions.

She closed her eyes and tried to remember what each question had been. “Twenty-four, sixteen... eight... four.”

Hugo chuckled. “I'm not sure we should bet on all even numbers. Is there nothing odd in your mind?”

Janine laughed.

“Are you okay?” Hugo's face was suddenly very close.

“Just a bit tired.” Janine noticed his eyes were unusual—a pale hazel with a dark rim around the edge of the iris. She could imagine him being very popular with female investors—he could probably talk them into anything.

“Is there somewhere quiet where we can have a drink and a chat for a while?” Adrian had another two bottles of champagne in his hands and a smile on his face.

“Yeah, there's a chill-out room at the back with a few tables.” Janine nodded toward an arched doorway beyond the bar. Sitting down in a quiet room sounded like a good idea.

“Wonderful. Let's take a break and all have a chin-wag while we work out what to squander our money on next.”

They made their way towards the arch. Janine looked for Davy but the bar was as busy as the rest of the casino, and she couldn't see him for the people queuing for a drink.

The room was fairly small, with only a handful of tables. Janine was surprised when Adrian led them to the small table tucked away in the corner. There were other options, including a large table, because the room was empty apart from another couple.

Janine sat down and the men crowded round her. They chatted about their upcoming Christmas plans; Hugo was spending Christmas with his mother in Kent, and New Year with his father in Zurich. Adrian and Russell were both staying in London, and Toby said he was planning on booking a ski-trip.

Their plans sounded more exciting than her own. She had no intention of telling them she'd recently split from her long-term partner, so simply told them she was going to spend Christmas Day with her parents.

"I'm sure you'll have a lovely time," Adrian said.

As they chatted, the men consumed more champagne and became a little more adventurous. Janine found them sitting closer, whispering in her ear, leaning against her. Their legs pushed against hers under the table. She flirted openly with them, enjoying their attentions.

They kept trying to get her to have some champagne, but she declined. Russell announced he'd bought tickets to the Formula One race in Monaco for next May, and that sparked a conversation about the French Riviera.

Hearing them talk about places like Nice and Monte Carlo, Janine remembered her first night at the casino, and Adam's plans for their winnings. "My ex-boyfriend wanted to take me in Monte Carlo."

Hugo laughed. "Do you mean take you *to* Monte Carlo?"

"No..." Janine flashed her eyes. "He promised to cover the bed in his winnings and fuck me on top of a pile of cash."

The men all murmured their approval.

Janine shrugged. "But he was useless at gambling, so I never got to go."

"Or come." Toby's joke made everyone laugh, even Janine.

Russell placed his hand on her arm. “Well if you want to join me in Monaco next May, I’ll be happy to cover the bed in cash—”

She laughed. “Ooh, now there’s an offer...”

The banter continued and there was a subtle increase in contact between them. One man’s leg rested against her calf under the table, another’s thigh pushed into her hip. Hugo ran his fingers down her arm, making her shiver. Janine smiled at him. A flutter developed in her stomach, and she noticed their group was now alone in the room.

Hugo laid his hand on her knee as he leaned forward to speak to Adrian. When he sat back, he left his hand there.

While Toby told some story about a previous ski trip, Janine glanced at Hugo. He held eye-contact with her for a second, then moved his hand a little further up her leg.

Janine licked her lips and narrowed her eyes. Hugo’s hand inched under her skirt. She felt his fingers touch the bare skin of her thigh above the stocking-top and shuddered.

The others noticed. The drinks were quickly removed from the table and Janine was helped up out of her seat. She looked at their faces, took her bottom lip between her teeth and then sat on the table.

Hugo stood between her knees and kissed her on the forehead. She allowed him to gently lay her down on the table. He eased the hem of her dress up over her hips; the wooden table-top was cold against her buttocks. Russell undid the buttons down the front of her dress and Hugo’s hands stroked over her buttocks and thighs.

He caressed her through the thin gusset of her thong as Russell unhooked her front-fastening bra and freed her breasts. Hugo pulled her thong aside and his fingers dipped inside her.

“Ahhh...” Janine closed her eyes and dropped her head back over the edge of the table. His fingers pulled out and she felt the head of his cock slide through the flooded folds of her sex.

With a single lunge, he sank all the way in. Janine’s eyes fluttered and her mouth opened as she let out a long, grateful sigh. This was the first time she’d had sex since her meeting with Bromley at the end of November.

Oh yeah, just keep doing it like that...

Janine imagined Adam sitting on the other side of the room, masturbating as he watched her being fucked by even more men. She was building up to her orgasm when Hugo suddenly withdrew. She let out a cry of disappointment and opened her eyes.

His cock was right in front of her face. A spurt of semen shot out and she instinctively opened her mouth. The cum splattered onto her cheek. She tried to lick it with her tongue, but couldn't reach. Another spurt erupted and landed in her open mouth. Janine moaned appreciatively, raised her head and took him into her mouth, sucking and tonguing the domed head. But she needed it back inside her so she could come.

Another cock pushed into her, and when she looked up Toby smiled, his gaudy tie hanging onto her bare breasts. His cock felt thicker than Hugo's, and she knew she'd get the orgasm that had eluded her moments ago. He fucked her hard, making the table rock. Janine dropped her head back, ground herself against his pubic bone, and came. She grunted and gritted her teeth.

"Ahh..." Toby obviously enjoyed her contractions and fucked her harder, then pulled out and moved quickly to the side of the table, aiming his cock at her face. His load landed on her forehead and over her right eye.

"Okay, you hold this while I go."

Looking over towards the voice, Janine saw Russell pass his phone to Hugo and undo his own trousers. The men were filming while they all took turns at her. She was going to take them all. A thrill ran through her. Maybe she could send the video to Adam for Christmas...

Russell pulled her legs up and rested her feet on his shoulders, leering at her body.

Janine looked down herself—black hold-up stockings with lacy tops, her dress up round her waist, the front of her dress undone and her nipples dark and erect against the soft white of her breasts.

She watched Russell's cock disappear between her legs, felt the warm invasion of another man using her body.

Russell lasted only a couple of minutes. As soon as he withdrew, Janine turned her head towards him. By the time he was level with her face,

she'd already opened her mouth. His aim was good. As she closed her mouth to swallow, another spurt hit her on the lips and chin.

Another cock pushed into her. She wondered if Adrian would last long enough for her to come again...

Suddenly there was a loud commotion. A chair was thrown across the room, and Russell was pushed away. He stumbled over a chair. Adrian was wrenched back and thrown across the room.

Janine was pulled up off the table. Intense blue eyes looked into hers.

It was Bromley. "Are you alright?"

She nodded, surprised by his actions.

Bromley glared at the bankers, then spoke to the bouncers by the archway. "Keep them here. If anyone tries to leave, break their fucking arm."

He turned away while she fastened her bra, then steered her through a door which led to the back corridor.

He stopped and looked into her face. "How did that happen?"

Was he jealous? She shrugged, tried to smile. "Maybe I miss you..."

He shook his head and dragged her toward his office. Opening the door, he pulled her in behind him.

Janine was just about to ask if Tony would be joining them when she stopped and stared. Bromley's wife was sitting behind his desk, staring in shock at Janine's face.

"What the—?" She stood up and pushed the chair back.

"Judy, can you help her get cleaned up?" Bromley nodded towards the small bathroom. "I'll be back in a few minutes."

Judy Bromley led Janine to the small bathroom, flicked on the light and turned Janine to face the mirror over the small sink.

Janine stared at her reflection. There was semen all over her face, and also in her hair. Her makeup had been messed, with lip-gloss smeared around her mouth and mascara smudged down her cheek. Her dress hung open.

“There’s a lot of stuff on your face. Too much for one guy.” Judy stood next to her, regarding Janine’s face in the mirror.

Their eyes met in the reflection.

“Did you get gang-banged?”

Janine opened her mouth to answer, but no words would come.

“How many cocks did you get this time?”

Janine didn’t know what to say. It was surreal.

Judy stepped behind Janine, their eyes still locked in the mirror.

“How many?”

“Four.” Her voice echoed in her head, as if she was lying in a bath with her ears under the water.

“Ooh, lucky girl.” Judy stepped round her and picked up a wad of tissues. “Let’s get you cleaned up.”

As Janine stood still, Judy wiped the mess from her face. She returned briefly to the office and returned with her handbag, from which she took a pack of wet-wipes. The cum had dried sticky and crusty, and Judy meticulously cleaned it all off.

Janine looked into the other woman’s face. “You know, don’t you?”

“Of course I do.”

“I didn’t know he was married.”

Judy nodded. “It doesn’t matter. I let him have fun sometimes. But he only gets to play when I say so.”

“I’m sorry.”

“Don’t be. When I was your age, I was a lap-dancer. I lived with two men for over a year, sharing a bed with them both every night. I also gave blowjobs to some of my punters, including one who’s now my husband. You’ve done nothing to be sorry for.”

Janine couldn’t think of anything to say.

She heard the office door open and close, and a couple of seconds later Bromley leaned his head around the bathroom door. “Can I come in?”

Judy laughed. “You’re already in.”

He stepped forward and looked at Janine. “Have you been drinking?”

She frowned. "Of course not."

"So what happened? Did you just decide to forget where you were and pull a train?"

"No, I... I was just tired."

"Tired?"

"Yes. I was tired, and—"

"And what? You thought you'd just have a little lie down on the table?"

She could tell from his face that he wasn't making a joke. "No, I... I..."

"Did they force themselves on you?"

"What? No, of course not."

Bromley shrugged. "If you were tired, maybe you didn't know what was happening."

"Of course I knew what was happening. I wanted it. I sucked their cocks and swallowed their cum. I also came while they were fucking me."

Bromley glanced at his wife and laughed. "Unbelievable."

Judy stroked Janine's arm. "You go, girl."

Bromley shook his head again. "Don't let yourself get into that position again. Never go anywhere in the casino that isn't in the line of sight of at least one member of staff. If you get the urge to fuck the punters, invite them back to your place. Don't do it in the casino, or I could lose my licence."

She nodded. "Right, sorry."

Bromley obviously wasn't happy. "They can't come in here and get away with that."

Judy sighed. "Oh, I think someone might be a little bit jealous."

Janine turned to see Judy smiling playfully at her husband.

"It's not about being jealous, it's more a matter of respect. Respect for where they are, and what they're doing."

"Hmm." Judy didn't sound convinced.

"I'll make the twats pay, you watch."

Janine looked at Judy, who simply shrugged.

Bromley opened the bathroom door and paused to switch the light off. "Stay in here." He pulled the bathroom door almost closed, leaving a small gap before stalking out of his office.

He returned less than a minute later, followed by the guys she'd allowed to fuck her.

Bromley spoke. "Would you gents care to explain exactly what you were doing in the quiet room?"

Janine moved closer to the gap at the door and peered into the office. The bankers had their backs to her, and she could see two bouncers blocking the door back to the corridor.

The four guys looked at each other, then back at Bromley.

Hugo replied for them. "We were just enjoying the hospitality of your hostess."

Bromley wasn't impressed by the flippant answer. "Are you here with one of the party bookings?"

"No, we paid on the door. We're only visiting Manchester for a couple of days."

"And where are you visiting from?" Bromley lowered himself into his chair and sat back, staring at the four of them.

"London. We're in banking. We're here meeting up with some investors."

Bromley pursed his lips. "Right, I want all your wallets on the desk."

There were mumbled sounds of reluctance.

Bromley slapped the desk. "You either get your wallets out, or these men," he said, pointing towards the bouncers, "will cut your pockets open and do it for you."

All four men produced their wallets.

Bromley removed the driver's licence from each one and walked over to the printer to open the lid. Placing them face down, he walked back to his desk and tapped some keys on his laptop. The printer came to life, taking a scan of all four licences.

After he'd retrieved the cards from the scanner, Bromley dropped them back onto the desk. He turned to Russell. "Right, Spielberg, pass me your phone."

"What do you want—?"

"Give me your fucking phone."

Russell wordlessly handed it over.

Bromley tapped at the screen impatiently then slid it back towards Russell. "Unlock it."

He held his thumb to the screen for recognition, then handed it back.

Bromley spent almost a minute tapping through the menu. When he'd finished, he carelessly dropped the phone onto the desk with a clatter. "Right. I've just deleted the film you made but, before I did, I forwarded it to my own email address. That means I now have evidence of what you lot did tonight."

Janine saw the bankers glance at each other.

Hugo cleared his throat. "I don't know why you—"

"Because," Bromley leaned forward, "I think you forced yourselves on my hostess."

All four bankers started talking at once, Hugo being the loudest. "That is *not* what happened. Just ask Jan—"

Bromley cut him off mid-flow. "How do you think your employers are going to react when I contact them?"

There was a pause, then Toby said, "I don't imagine they'd care one way or the other."

Bromley smiled humourlessly. "I doubt that very much. You've just admitted you're up here meeting investors, which means you're effectively on company business. I'd bet my left testicle that your hotel rooms and travel arrangements have been paid for by your employers, likewise all the champagne you quaffed."

The four men exchanged glances, and Janine could tell they were less sure of themselves.

"Now, what do you think your employers will say when I phone them and report your behaviour here tonight? How *four* of you isolated a

single hostess in a quiet room and abused her? She's tiny—she stood no chance of fending off four men.”

Adrian shook his head. “That’s not what happened. She was up for it. She loved it.”

Bromley shrugged. “That’s your version. Are you claiming you’d drank so much champagne that you didn’t know what you were doing?”

“Nothing we did was against her will.” Hugo sounded indignant. “She enjoyed every minute. Encouraged it.”

“We only have your word for that. Maybe I should phone the police and get them involved. They can take blood samples to see how much alcohol you’ve consumed. You may even want to use that as part of your defence—diminished responsibility, or whatever.”

Hugo put his hand into his pocket. “I’m going to phone my lawyer.”

“You’d better phone your orthodontist first, because if you open your pompous mouth again, I’ll knock your fucking teeth out.”

Hugo stood perfectly still.

Bromley glowered at the men. “I suppose you like to call yourselves financiers, brokers, or some fancy title, but I call you twats. You earn six-figure salaries for gambling with other people’s money. You probably think you’re untouchable, but I’ll tell you this...” He pointed at them. “You’re going to pay for what you’ve done tonight.”

There was silence.

Bromley’s voice was low and menacing. “You might not care that I think you’re twats, but just about everyone else in the country agrees with me. We all know how bankers pay themselves a fortune in bonuses when they have a good year, but what happens when it’s a bad year? All the ordinary people lose their savings and their pensions, but you still keep your jobs. The government bails you out, so the tax-payers are fucked over again.”

Janine wondered if Bromley was speaking from experience. Maybe a bank had screwed him over in the past. Whatever his reason, she felt guilty—and sorry for the bankers. Like they’d said, she’d been up for it.

Bromley sat back in his chair and took a breath. “Maybe your employers will stick their neck out for you, but I suspect they’ll want to

distance themselves from this sort of exposure. The media will be all over this story. How do you think Joe Public will react when they hear about a bunch of Hooray Henriess doing what you did tonight? The four of you isolating a young single woman in a room..."

He got up and walked around the desk to stand toe-to-toe with Hugo. Bromley was a couple of inches taller and much wider. He sneered.

"I'm sure there'll be plenty of hard men in prison who'll be more than happy to show you pretty boys exactly how it feels to be taken by four men, one after the other."

Janine could see a definite change in the bankers' body language. Even though she couldn't see their faces, she'd seen their shoulders slump.

After letting his words sink in for a minute, Bromley walked back to his chair and took out a pen and pad of paper from a drawer. He wrote something on the paper, then slid it to the middle of the desk. None of the bankers moved.

Bromley looked at the pad, then up at the men. "As much as I love the idea of you four losing your jobs then getting bullied and buggered in prison, I actually don't want my hostess to have to go through the ordeal of a trial. That is the *only* reason that I'm going to give you scumbags the chance to save your own slimy skins." He sat forwards, the menace in his expression palpable. "But you need to understand this: I will not be making this offer again. If you don't accept it now, you won't get a second chance."

The bankers glanced at each other, then at Bromley. Hugo cleared his throat. "What's your offer?"

"On that notepad is a bank account number and sort code. You're all going to have to pay ten grand into that account."

"Ten thousand pounds?" Adrian sounded incredulous.

"Each?" Hugo's tone was as disbelieving as Adrian's.

"Yes, *each*. Exactly how you pay for it is up to you. As I said, I'd prefer you lost your job, your Porsche and your freedom."

Janine couldn't believe what she was hearing.

Russell shook his head. "That's extortion."

“Think of it as compensation. You either all do it now, or I call the police.”

Hugo looked pleadingly at Bromley. “It’s too much.”

“Fuck off, it’s a fraction of what you earn.” He looked at his watch. “Now, I’ve got a very busy casino to manage and haven’t got time to listen to you twats bleating. You either transfer the money now, or I walk out of this office and those two men will keep you here until the police arrive.”

“We don’t have that sort of money hanging around. It’s all invested in—”

“Not my problem. Put it on a credit card and then sell some stocks on Monday.”

The bankers exchanged glances and muttered to one another, then Hugo picked up his wallet and turned the pad of paper so he could read the details. He took out his phone and began tapping the screen. The other bankers crowded behind him and picked up their own wallets. Russell also retrieved his phone.

Bromley hit some keys on his laptop and sat back, watching the screen.

Nothing was said for over five minutes, and throughout this time Janine stared open-mouthed from inside the darkened bathroom.

“Right.” Bromley closed the lid of the laptop. “Your payments have all reached the account. You can leave. Needless to say, I don’t want to hear from any of you in the future. If you ever show your faces in this casino again, my bouncers will evict you immediately.”

The bankers hesitated, as if unsure of what to do.

“Go on, fuck off.” Bromley nodded at the bouncers, who stood aside and opened the office door.

The bankers filed out and the bouncers left with them.

After a few seconds, Bromley sat back in his chair and looked towards the bathroom door. “You can come out now.”

Janine and Judy walked into the office.

Bromley grinned, proud of his performance. “I assume you heard everything?”

“Yeah. I felt sorry for them...”

Bromley scoffed. “They deserved the bollocking. They come up here, think they own the place and can get away with anything they want.”

Janine looked down at the floor, a little embarrassed. “You know full-well that they didn’t force me.”

“Yeah, I know—but they don’t know I know.” He hit some keys on his laptop.

She looked over at Judy, who smiled back at her. Janine tried to imagine a younger Judy being a lap-dancer and sharing a bed with two men every night. And sucking Bromley’s big cock...

“Okay.” Bromley pushed his laptop away and looked up at Janine. “I’ve just transferred their forty grand. It should show up in the account where we pay your salary by tomorrow. I suggest you put it into a high-interest account as soon as you can.”

Janine stared at him. “You’re giving the money to me?”

“Of course I am.”

“I don’t want it. I allowed them to do what they did. I wanted it. So I don’t want their money.”

“You’re taking the money. I’m not going to say you earned it, because that’d mean you’d be liable to pay tax on it. The money is compensation for what they did, and it’s all yours.”

She shook her head.

“Janine, if you don’t take the money, I’ll have to sack you. You can only keep your job here by accepting the compensation.”

Janine was speechless. She’d assumed Bromley was making the bankers pay because he didn’t like them, and had never imagined that the money would be given to her. “I don’t know what to say...”

Bromley smiled. “I’ll get someone to drive you home. Get some sleep. If you don’t want to work tomorrow night, that’s okay. “

“No, I’ll be fine for tomorrow. I’ve got no clients in the morning so I can sleep in. Thank you.” She wanted to hug him, but with Judy standing there it didn’t seem appropriate.

Bromley used his mobile to summon the driver, and Janine left through the back door. Twenty minutes later, she'd showered and climbed into bed. She closed her eyes and fell asleep almost immediately.

* * * *

When Janine arrived at the casino the following night, she went straight to the bar as usual. "Hi Davy, could I have a black coffee, please?"

"Of course." He smiled and walked over to grab the coffee pot. Placing a cup in front of her, he kept his eyes on his task as he poured. "How're you feeling?"

He sounded concerned, and she realised he was aware of what had happened the previous night. As it was so early, there was nobody else at the bar and they could have a private chat.

"I'm fine, thanks." She wondered if he'd stop flirting with her now. "So, are you looking forward to Christmas?"

He frowned. "Not really. I usually go back to my mum and dad's for Christmas Day—you know, turkey, roasties and sprouts."

Janine smiled. "Me too."

Davy shrugged. "My dad died in March, so this'll be the first Christmas without him."

"Oh, I'm sorry."

He smiled. "Thanks. My sister's invited me and mum round to her house this year. She's got a couple of kids, so hopefully being around her grandchildren will help cheer my mum up."

"I hope so. Does your sister live close by?"

"Yeah, she's over in Altrincham."

"What about Boxing Day?" She bit her lip.

Davy looked surprised. "I've nothing planned for Boxing Day."

"Me neither..."

When he smiled, his dimples were as cute as ever.

* * * *

Janine enjoyed Christmas Day much more than she'd expected to. Her parents were very supportive over her split from Adam, even though she knew they'd always liked him.

She'd helped her mum prepare the veg like she used to as a teenager, and as they sat in the dining room eating their roast dinner, she was determined to show them she could support herself. "We got a good price for the flat, and should complete in about four weeks' time."

"Where will you live?" Her mum looked worried.

"I'll be staying with Eloise until I find somewhere."

Her dad put down his fork. "Why not just stay where you are and buy Adam out? We could give you the money."

Janine smiled. "Although I like the flat, it'd remind me of Adam too much. I'd rather get somewhere of my own."

He nodded. "I can understand that. Will you buy?"

"Hopefully." She thought about the money in her account. "With the sale of the flat, me and Adam should have over eight thousand pounds each, after we've paid you back."

Her dad frowned. "You don't have to pay us back."

"Of course I do. We borrowed ten thousand pounds for the deposit."

He smiled. "That wasn't a loan, it was a gift. Keep it and use it as a deposit for your new place."

"I can't do that."

Her mother laughed. "Of course you can. We don't need the money, and we certainly can't take it with us."

Janine was stunned. Just a few weeks ago, she'd been convinced she'd be forced to live in a shared house with a bunch of students. Now, she was going to have almost sixty thousand pounds to use as a deposit on a place of her own. She'd agreed to stay on at the salon for three afternoons a week, and would still do private clients on some mornings. With four nights at the casino, she'd be earning twice as much as she was getting three months ago.

After lunch, she cuddled with her dad on the couch and watched Toy Story. It took her back to being a child again, and she knew in advance what parts he would laugh at. Later, after sharing a bottle of wine, her dad fell asleep and Janine helped her mum tidy the kitchen.

“So, you’ve not seen Adam at all?”

Janine shook her head. “No. Our solicitor is contacting him about the sale, so there’s nothing I need to say to him.”

“What about anybody else?” There was a glint in her mum’s eye.

Janine thought about Davy and smiled. “There’s a guy at work that I quite like. I’m actually seeing him for breakfast tomorrow.”

“You’re going out for breakfast?”

Janine laughed. “Yeah, don’t ask.”

“You could have invited him round today, you know.”

“I know, but he couldn’t have come.” Janine explained about this being the first Christmas without his dad.

“Oh well, you’ll have to cheer him up tomorrow.”

Janine laughed and went back to the living room. Her dad was snoring quietly on the couch, and the coal fire was glowing cosily in the grate. Janine sat down and smiled, feeling full, relaxed and happy.

She went to bed in her old room shortly after ten, and slept like a log. The following morning she showered, dressed in a pair of tight jeans and black sweater, then said her goodbyes to her parents.

She’d arranged to meet Davy in a trendy city-centre bistro at eleven, and she was surprised by how busy the roads were. She’d never imagined the sales would be so popular.

Janine got to the bistro early, ordered fresh orange juice and took a seat near the window. She recognised him from a hundred yards away and watched him as he walked up the street. She felt a warm glow.

He saw her from outside and his smile made her stomach tingle. He came in, his cheeks pink from the cold. “Hiya.”

“Hi.” She stood up and kissed his cheek.

He looked sheepish for a second, then smiled broadly. “Merry Christmas.”

Janine leaned close and kissed his lips very gently. “Merry Christmas to you, too.”

Davy held her gaze for a couple of seconds, and she felt herself grow wet. Then he looked around and frowned. “You’ve got to promise not to laugh.”

“I’ll try...”

He removed his coat and she burst out laughing. He was wearing a hideous Christmas jumper.

“Which part of ‘promise not to laugh’ didn’t you understand?”

“I’m sorry, it’s just I wasn’t expecting anything so...”

“I know. My niece insisted I wear it for my date.”

“How old is she?”

“Four.”

They both sat down at the table.

Janine rubbed his arm. “How was yesterday? Was your mum okay?”

“She was fine, thanks. How about yours?”

“Really nice. I watched Toy Story with my dad for what was probably the fiftieth time.”

The waitress came and took their order, then they chatted about their families. Janine didn’t really know anything about Davy except that he worked behind a bar, and that he had a sexy smile and a wonderful bum. Then she realised there were a lot of things he didn’t know about her...

She turned serious. “Listen, there are some things I think I need to tell you about me.”

“Why?”

“Because I think you should know about certain—”

“I know enough.” He leaned over the table and looked into her face. “You have big brown eyes like a baby deer. You have a smile that makes me melt. You have great legs and some really sexy shoes. And, you like Toy Story. What more do I need to know?”

I’m a whore.

Her eyes filled and she shook her head. “I just thought...”

He took her hand and smiled. “I know enough to hope this isn’t the only time we have breakfast together.”

She held his gaze and felt a warmth spread inside her.

Just then, their breakfast arrived: full English for Davy, and Eggs Benedict for her. They chatted freely as they ate, then spent an hour walking around the city centre in the cold, holding hands as they got to know each other better.

They passed a new development of luxury flats just off Deansgate and Janine stopped to read the spec on the advertising board.

Davy read the information with her. “These sound really nice—two bedrooms, two bathrooms, lounge, kitchen-diner, balcony *and* underground parking. They’ll be well out of my price range.”

Janine bit her lip, then took out her phone and snapped a picture of the contact number. She’d phone them tomorrow and try to reserve one, then go and sort out a mortgage. She smiled at Davy. “If you’re good, I may let you come and visit me when I live here.”

“You’re going to buy one?”

She shrugged. “If there’s any available, I think I might.”

“Wow—I’m impressed.”

They walked on, the light fading even though it was only early afternoon. In St Peter’s Square, they stopped to admire the Christmas lights. Janine turned to face him and leaned close for a kiss. He kissed her back, and they clung to each other through their coats.

She looked into his eyes. “Take me home and take me to bed.”

He grinned. “Do you want me to keep my jumper on?”

“Definitely not.”

Davy kissed her again, then looked around. “Shall I try and find a taxi?”

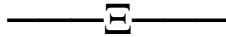
Though she appreciated his eagerness, Janine didn’t want to run the risk of seeing Adam at the taxi rank. She shook her head. “No, let’s walk.”

As they made their way through the city streets, Janine squeezed his arm and smiled to herself. Maybe it was time to put a stop to the sex-with-

no-strings and concentrate on trying to keep herself attached to her new boyfriend.

THE END

About the Author



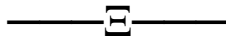
Delores Swallows has many dirty thoughts, and during his free time he writes them down in the form of stories. Born and bred in the northwest of England, he has a commoner's accent and a bit of a crush on his future queen (Kate, not Camilla!).

His stories often feature petite brunettes, high-heeled shoes and voyeurism. He claims he didn't realise these were obsessions until someone pointed out how often they appear in his work.

Find out more about Delores on his [web site](#), chat on [Twitter](#), or follow his new stories on [Amazon](#). And don't forget to sign up to his [mailing list](#) for a **free story**.

Don't forget your dirty story exclusively available to members of [Delores' mailing list](#).

Also by Delores Swallows



Take My Wife

After about fifteen minutes, Sophie leaned up on her elbow and started to kiss Joel, ready to continue with her night of passion. As she pushed the quilt down the bed with her foot, Jim saw that her hand was gripping Joel's dick, slowly masturbating him. Joel was already hard. Evidently, he was ready for more, too. Jim wondered how long Sophie had been playing with him. Sophie climbed on top of him, feeding his thick dick inside her.

Jim knelt on the bed next to their legs and watched as his wife slowly made love to the other man. Her head was buried against Joel's shoulder, her long tousled hair a dark fan over the pillow, hiding both their faces. Their bodies moved together in a slow, sensual dance. From his position on the bed, Jim had a perfect view of their union. With each slow, upward movement of Sophie's hips he could see Joel's slippery hardness, partially exposed for a second or two before it disappeared again inside the dark pinkness. Joel was holding Sophie's hips in his hands, moving her on him. Jim stretched his hand out and gently stroked the back of Sophie's leg, aroused to feel her thigh muscles working as she rode his friend.

There was a layer of perspiration on Sophie's back, giving her a sultry, exotic look in the dim yellow light. Their lovemaking seemed to go on for a long time before Sophie reached her climax. She was very vocal as she came – muffled moans and sighs as the current built up, urgent grunts as the waves swelled inside her, then screams and shouts as the waves broke into an explosion of pleasure. Finally, she let out grateful cries and

whimpers as she rode the final ripples of her orgasm. Jim was in a cold sweat and felt like his stomach was in a vice.



The epic saga of how a really dirty fantasy becomes a fantastically dirty reality. All three books under one sweaty cover.

Bon Voyeur

Another man in their bed? Madness! Sophie and Jim had never done it before—heck, it was only supposed to be a fantasy to get them in the mood for each other. What if Sophie likes it too much? What if Jim has second

thoughts when he sees his beautiful wife taken by another man? What if she enjoys the other man more because he has more to offer?

When the perfect opportunity presents, though, they both jump at the chance.

Joel is tall, handsome, and so much bigger than even Sophie expected! Best of all, he's moving to the other side of the world, so they need never see him again. If Jim plays this right, Joel won't even suspect the stranger they're sharing is his loving wife.

Watching his beautiful Sophie—so vulnerable, so unprotected, so utterly owned—Jim experiences a powerful revelation. It's sure been fun having a gorgeous wife all to himself, but it's much more fun to share.

Abuse of Power

Jim's learning things about himself that he never knew. Surprising things. Like how much he enjoys watching his wife lose herself with another man. Sophie's learning as well, like how when it comes to male attention, for her it's a case of the more the merrier.

And Sophie loves getting merry. You might say she's becoming addicted. Sometimes she needs it so bad she'll take the initiative herself, even when Jim is not around. For most men, that might be a problem, but Jim is not most men. Just knowing what his loving wife is doing without him, giving herself to those men, letting them have her in every way they can... Yes, he gets jealous, but if Sophie tells him everything, how she becomes so needy that she simply relinquishes her will, it can be almost as good as being there.

Drunk on the seemingly inexhaustible depth of his wife's libido, Jim oversteps at a swinging party and starts directing Sophie's lovers, telling them where they should finish. Finally, Sophie cracks. Sticky, degraded, angry, she strikes back and gives her cuckold husband a taste of his own medicine... or at least, her lovers' medicine.

Global Playground

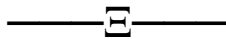
Jim is a simple man with simple needs. He's lives in a nice house on a nice street, he's got a good job, and he plays tennis to wind down. And on

weekends he kisses his wife Sophie goodbye when she goes off to swingers' parties to service her ever-escalating needs. Billionaires, porn stars, dancers—one at a time or all at once, it doesn't matter to Sophie. She'll take it every way she can get it and relay all the juicy details to Jim when she gets home.

Life is good. Too good, you might say. For a voyeur like Jim, his open marriage is damn near perfect. Little bit of wife-watching, little bit of playing around... what more could a man want? Well there's only one answer to the eternal question, and that's the eternal truth. He wants what he can't have—romantic dates, curling up in front of a fire, sweet togetherness—and while Sophie is off jet-setting with wealthy men to service her needs, Jim falls into a comfortable friendship with Naomi, a stunning older woman and self-described cougar.

For a man who's known nothing but chocolate-chip, where's the harm in trying vanilla for once? Just a little taste... maybe a scoop...

[Take My Wife](#) is available from Amazon



A Hotwife's Journey

Her key in the door made his heart race. He listened as she came up the stairs, then held his breath when she walked into the bedroom. He couldn't help staring. Her clothes were twisted, her makeup was smudged, and her hair was dishevelled.

She's fucked someone.

Karen walked to the foot of the bed and looked into his face. "I did it."

He swallowed.

She pulled her top over her head and dropped it on the floor, then pushed her skirt down over her hips and kicked it away. Slowly, she unclipped her bra at the front. As the cups came away, he saw a love bite on one of her breasts. Karen held his gaze as she pushed her thong down her legs and then bent to pick it up, holding it open so he could see the gooey mess soaked into the crotch.

It was another man's cum, and it'd dribbled out of her during the drive home. The guy had deposited it deep in her cunt, and she'd returned home to her pervert husband to show him the evidence.

Nigel ached for her.



A Hotwife's Journey

After her husband's open invitation to become a hotwife, Karen enjoys a variety of surprises and adventures that are hotter than any wife could wish for.

This collection covers her entire journey...

Karen's Open Invitation

Nigel is a lucky man. He has everything a man could want: a successful and beautiful wife, a happy marriage, two wonderful daughters, a nice home and his own business.

So why risk it all just to satisfy his dirty fantasy?

When Karen's throwaway comment about a hot colleague in the Sweden office unlocks the door to his secret desires, he offers her the chance to have a little fun; to mix business with pleasure.

Nigel has fantasised about sharing his wife for a long time. And from the way Karen's been behaving lately, he suspects the idea appeals to her, too.

But there's a big difference between fantasy and reality.

Will she take up his suggestion and have a passionate tryst with a virtual stranger while attending an overseas meeting? Neither know the answer when she leaves for the airport, but she doesn't have to make her decision straight away. She can see how the meeting pans out. After all, it's an open invitation...

Karen's Party Surprise

Nigel is amazed by how Karen's taken to her new role as a hotwife. Not only does she give herself freely to strangers, but she also thrills her husband by giving him all the juicy details he craves when she gets home.

Their sex-life is better than ever.

Nigel realises that an upcoming company get together will mean that they'll be staying in the same hotel as Sean, the first man he ever shared her with. He offers Karen the chance to enjoy another night of passion, and they hatch a plan that could work. But Sean comes up with a counteroffer that's just too good to refuse.

For a wife-sharing couple like Nigel and Karen, it's the ultimate party surprise...

Karen's Holiday Adventures

Life keeps getting better and better for Nigel. His long-held wife-sharing fantasy is now his reality, and he couldn't be happier.

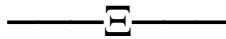
Or at least that's what he thinks until his wife reveals her plans for a break.

Their daughters are going away with their cousin's family, so Karen books a holiday for the two of them—on a Caribbean island. What's more, she promises to make it a fun-filled week where nothing is off-limits.

Under the hot tropical sun of St Lucia, Nigel learns just how hot his hotwife can be.

He's shocked by the diversity of her sexual appetite, but then she did promise him an 'anything goes' holiday adventure...

[A Hotwife's Journey](#) is available from Amazon



Operation: Cuckold

“Come on, Sissy. Get up here now.”

Harry obeyed.

Roy held his huge cock in his hand. “Right, now jerk me off into your wife's pretty face.”

Harry's mouth dropped open. “What?” He turned to look at Michelle, who stared back at him with unfocussed eyes. Her hair was clinging to her face.

Roy grabbed Harry's arm and pushed it towards his huge cock. “I said beat my fucking meat. Your wife wants to feel my hot cum all over her face.”

Harry hesitated for a split second too long.

Roy slapped him round the head. “Come on, Sissy, I'm itching to blow, here.”

Stunned, he reached out and wrapped his hand around the dick. It was hot, wet and slippery. And bigger than anything he'd ever held before. He gripped tighter.

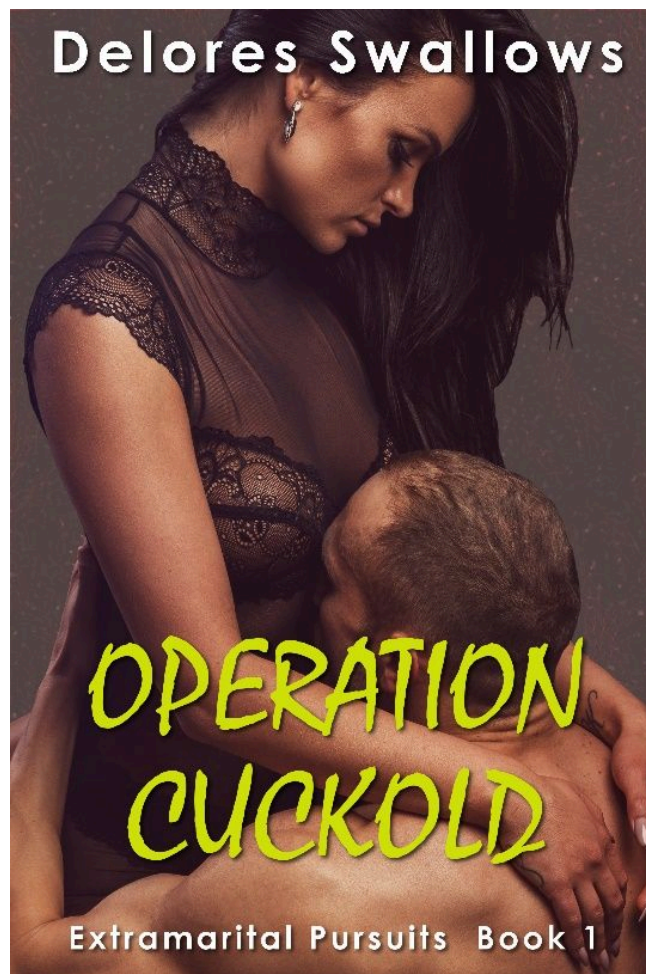
“That's it. Now, wank me off.”

Harry started to slide his hand up and down on Roy's cock. It felt surreal.

"Yeah, that's it. Work it like that, but faster."

Without taking his eyes off the cock in his hand, Harry started to pump his wrist faster. He'd had lots of practice at this over the years, but only ever on his own small cock. He looked up to his wife's face. She was watching him, smiling. He moved his hand faster, gripped a little tighter.

Michelle shook her hair back from her face, licked her lips. "Come on, drench me." She leaned closer and held her tongue out.



Harry's having problems rising to the occasion and discovers Michelle's been using porn to help take care of things herself.

He suggests she lives out her fantasy of a one-night stand, but is shocked by how much he gets out of it. As they repeat the experience with other men, pretty soon neither can stand the idea of going back to what they had before, even though Michelle pushes Harry right out of his comfort zone.

A cuck and bull story about a very happy hotwife.

[Operation: Cuckold](#) is available at Amazon.



Stag Nights

Michelle climbed up off the lounge and turned to face Harry. Lucas's sunglasses still hid her eyes, and his cum still covered her chest and stomach.

She tilted her head to one side and smiled. "Take my picture."

Harry did so, taking at least ten shots.

"And now shoot a video," she ordered.

Harry obeyed, selecting the correct option and pressing the red button.

Michelle smeared the cum all over her stomach and breasts while looking directly into the lens. "I have a confession—this isn't my husband's cum. My husband has just watched another man fuck me, and I know he enjoyed it almost as much as I did." She licked her lips. "And when we get home, my husband is going to use me for his pleasure, and then he's going to come all over me as well." Michelle gave her most beautiful smile. "I love my life."

There were butterflies in Harry's stomach, and he stopped filming. He stared at Michelle, who removed the sunglasses and looked down at her body.



Harry and Michelle are now fully entrenched in their new wife-sharing lifestyle. Michelle is proving to be one of the hottest hotwives around, with bulls waiting in line to take turns. Literally.

As Michelle gets more of what she craves, she pushes Harry further into the role of the cuckold and he's presented with situations he finds hard to accept.

Things look like they might be going awry until he discovers that not all wife-sharing husbands need to be cucks...

[Stag Nights](#) is available from Amazon

